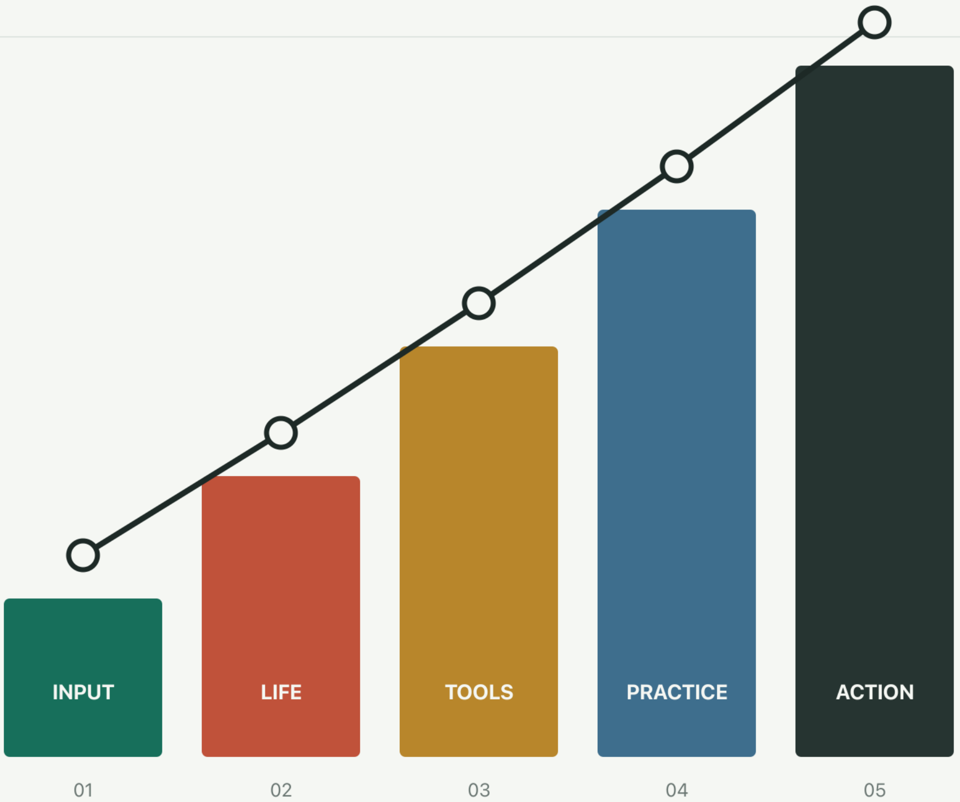
A LIFELONG LEARNING GUIDE FOR THE AI ERA

LIFE LEVEL-UP GUIDE

Begin with language. Move through life, AI, practice, and the work of changing over time.



QUESTION → LEARN → DELIVER → PRESERVE EVIDENCE → TRANSFER

HAN XIANKAI

byoungd.github.io/up/en

Life Level-up Guide

Lifelong Learning Guide for the AI Era

Han Xiankai

A lifelong-learning system for English, AI, real projects, difficult seasons, evidence, transfer, recovery, and responsibility.

https://byoungd.github.io/up/

Contents

Reader's Guide: Put the Book Back into Life

This is not a textbook to memorise from first page to last, or a checklist waiting for you to complete. Think of it as a studio you can return to: bring a real problem, take away a smaller action, and carry the result back into life.

If this is your first visit, do not begin by asking how much you should finish. Ask: **what do I most need to see clearly, complete, or stop today?** That question chooses your entry point.

Choose Today's Entry Point

I only want to begin again

Read the Prologue: Do Not Rush to Change Your Life, then open the Learning State. Do not design a three-year plan. Record the real context, current baseline, and one action you can finish in 25–45 minutes.

I want to improve one concrete skill

Use CEFR Goals and Self-check to name the context and baseline, then enter the listening, reading, speaking, or writing chapters. Choose one main line at a time and use the relevant evidence cards to preserve a first sample, feedback, and a retest. More study is not necessarily deeper study; completing the action in a new situation is where ability starts to show.

I have many resources but no artifact

Read Learning Anything with AI, then record the problem, sources, privacy boundary, and human judgment in the AI Task Brief. Use the Artifact Brief and Delivery Card to name the audience, completion standard, acceptance owner, and rollback. A chat log can help you begin. It cannot deliver for you.

I have many records but cannot tell whether I really changed

Open the Evidence Chain Template. Put baseline, immediate performance, delayed retention, and transfer on one page, then return to Evidence: How Change Becomes Visible to separate conclusions supported by evidence from interpretations that still need testing. Do not replace one independent retest with a longer table.

I do not know which worksheet to choose

Open the Toolkit Overview and choose an entry point by the block in front of you. It names the next worksheet and what that tool cannot prove for you. Once you have chosen, leave the overview and complete one real action.

I am in a difficult season and my capacity is small

Read Recovery: Catch Yourself Before You Push Forward and Daily System. Reduce the target to safety, food, sleep, asking for help, and one minimum output. If low mood, sleeplessness, hopelessness, or thoughts of harm persist, contact someone you trust and seek qualified local medical or mental-health support. This book is not care.

Two Reading Modes, Used in Turn

One Complete Reading Arc

A complete read is not a race through page numbers. It lets the same question change four times: first see yourself, then open input, return to reality, and finally give the rhythm to time.

Stage	What to read	What to leave behind
See the starting point	Reader's Guide · Prologue	A one-page promise: real problem, baseline, minimum action, and boundary
Open input	CEFR Self-check and the listening, reading, speaking, and writing chapters	An English Diagnostic and one relevant evidence card
Return to reality	My Story, Narrative and Evidence, Echoes, Recovery, Decision-Making, plus AI Learning, Artifacts, and Evidence	One case review or real delivery, with change recorded in the Evidence Chain Template
Sustain and ship	First Week Practice, Daily System, Rhythm, 90-Day Action Plan, and the Afterword	A first-week baseline and retest, one Rhythm Ledger, one cycle plan, and a next review date

Read like a book

Follow the Prologue → Part I: Open Input → Part II: Return to Life → Part III: Amplify Ability → Evidence → Part IV: Practice and Recovery → Part V: Long-Term Action. This reveals how one question moves from language training into work, relationships, the body, and responsibility, then becomes a rhythm that can be tested and sustained.

Read like a studio

Jump from the Toolkit Overview, table of contents, or glossary to the obstacle in front of you. Pause after a section and write one judgment, do one exercise, or preserve a first sample. A week later, use the Evidence Chain Template and Weekly Review to check whether it transferred to a new task. You do not need to remember the whole book. You need the next action to become clearer.

These modes support one another. A complete read explains why the method is arranged this way; an on-demand read lets it do useful work today.

Leave Four Traces from Every Chapter

After a chapter, do not mark only “read.” Leave at least two of these four traces:

Trace	Question	Example
One judgment	What am I more certain about now?	“I will track one main question this week.”
One sample	What output proves I did the work?	A recording, an email, or an error list
One boundary	What must not be handed to a tool or an assumption?	Do not upload customer privacy; do not turn one story into a rule
One return point	When and under what condition will I retest?	Repeat the task with a new topic in seven days

If a chapter leaves only “that makes sense,” stop collecting. Rewrite it as an action that another person could see and you could inspect later.

What This Book Will Not Do for You

I will not choose a permanently correct career for you or package one personal story as a formula for success. I will not treat an AI answer as a fact, one smooth experience as proof of ability, or a beautiful schedule as a reason to hide the costs to your body, money, relationships, and privacy.

You may challenge any judgment here. First identify whether it is a research finding, personal experience, or hypothesis waiting for a test, then retest it in your own context. People have different resources, responsibilities, bodies, and risks. When a suggestion fails for you, that does not prove you did not work hard enough, and it does not automatically prove the suggestion was wrong.

When the Plan Is Interrupted, Return Here

Interruption is not an exception to this method. It is the reality the method must survive. Open the Learning State and mark what is complete, unconfirmed, costly, and next. If capacity has changed, return to the minimum viable day or the Rhythm Ledger instead of adding shame to the plan.

Add weight only after a repeatable rhythm returns. A reliable system is not one that never breaks. It is one that still knows how to come home after a break.

A One-Page Promise to the Reader

Before continuing, write four sentences:

1. The real problem I am handling now is:
2. The baseline evidence I already have is:
3. After this reading, I will complete this minimum action by:
4. The information, privacy, health, or relationship boundary I must keep is:

Those four sentences are enough to begin. Reading is not leaving life. It is giving life a direction that can be seen.

Prologue: Do Not Rush to Change Your Life

By Han Xiankai, pen name “Li Pu”.

In July 2017, a friend named `W.` was preparing for the TOEFL. She asked me: “How can I learn English efficiently?”

At the time, I thought it was a question about vocabulary, grammar, and study methods. I wrote down the detours I had taken: how to learn words, how to train listening, how to make an original English book feel less like a wall, and how to say the first imperfect sentence when you are afraid to speak.

Later I understood that she may have been asking a larger question: **How can an ordinary person keep moving a little forward when time is limited, setbacks repeat, and life is far from ideal?**

This guide grew from that question.

It begins with English because English is a concrete door. It can help you read an untranslated article, follow a work meeting, write to someone far away, and see the world through more than one information channel. But after the door opens, you still have to face yourself: how you use time, care for your body, carry failure, turn an idea into an artifact, and look after the people beside you.

I once imagined life as a game with an upgrade path. Finish one goal and receive the next piece of equipment; earn enough money and happiness will become stable; ship a product and your earlier choices will be justified. Then the company failed, my body stopped cooperating, and relationships and self-respect fell together. I learned that life is not a map waiting to be cleared.

Life is closer to a room that must be put back in order every day. Yesterday’s dust is still there. A broken piece of furniture cannot be repaired with a louder slogan. The weather outside does not follow our schedule. Progress often means sweeping the floor, saying the apology that is due, seeing a doctor, and finishing the next thing that can honestly be finished today.

This is not a book that promises to make you impressive. It offers four things:

1. An executable English path in which input, output, feedback, and review form a loop;
2. A way to work with AI that grows judgment instead of replacing thought;

3 A personal record that does not hide its mess, reminding us to place ability, work, relationships, and health on one timeline;

4 A 90-day action plan that gives what you read a chance to become work, feedback, and a new rhythm.

A Contract with the Reader

You do not have to read every page in order. Find the obstacle that is real today:

1 If you do not know why you are learning, start with Understanding.

1 If you keep forgetting, start with Vocabulary.

1 If you understand more than you can say, start with Speaking.

1 If you have many resources but no artifact, read Learning Anything with AI and the 90-Day Action Plan.

1 If you have many records but cannot tell whether anything changed, start with the Evidence Chain Template, then read Evidence.

1 If you do not know which worksheet to choose, open the Toolkit Overview and choose one entry point by the block in front of you.

1 If you are in a low season, read My Story, then sleep, eat, and decide what comes next.

Treat each chapter as a workbench, not an exam. Take one thing from it: a sentence, an exercise, a habit to stop, or a thought worth returning to. Knowledge that leaves no mark on life is still only a signpost.

A Reading Path You Can Revisit

Read through “problem → skill → tool → delivery → recovery”, or enter at the part that is most urgent today:

1 **Problem**: use Learning State to name the real context, baseline, and completion standard;

2 **Skill**: choose one of listening, reading, speaking, or writing and keep its evidence card;

3 **Tool**: if you use AI, read Learning Anything with AI and record sources, privacy, and human judgment in the task;

4. **Delivery and verification**: give the draft, recording, code, or report to a real person; use the Evidence Chain Template to compare the first version, feedback, delayed retention, and transfer; then schedule a retest in the 90-Day Cycle Map;
5. **Recovery and return**: when the plan breaks, return to Recovery and the Rhythm Ledger, restoring safety and minimum order before adding pressure.

This is not a required table of contents. It is a reminder that learning should return to life, and action should remain allowed to return to learning.

To the Person Opening This Page

You may be on a train with a phone full of saved links. You may have just lost a relationship and wonder whether you are stuck here forever. You may be pressed against a wall by work, debt, an exam, or illness, and even the word “effort” may sound exhausting.

I cannot promise that tomorrow will be better. I can say this: people are rarely rescued by one spectacular victory. We are more often held up by small, repeated actions that nobody applauds.

Learn five words today. Listen to real English for ten minutes tomorrow. Write an unpolished paragraph the day after. Finish a delayed task, send an overdue apology, eat on time, and turn off the light earlier. These actions look unrelated, but together they create evidence: **I still have some influence over my life.**

That influence need not be grand. It only needs to be real.

May you begin here not to become someone else, but to become more fully yourself.

Part I: Open Input

What matters about a door is not how impressive it looks. What matters is where it allows you to go.

English first appeared to me as a wall. On one side were tests, vocabulary lists, and repeated doubt. On the other were technical documents, courses, research, products, and people I had not yet met. I thought the wall would fall if I collected enough words. It took much longer to understand that a language is not stored knowledge. It is an ability built through use in real situations.

This part begins with English without using English to rank a person. It asks a practical question: when information no longer arrives already arranged in your familiar language, can you hear the main point, follow an argument, ask a question, explain a judgment, and complete work with another person?

Opening input does not mean letting more information flood your life. It means choosing what deserves to enter, learning how to understand and answer it, and keeping something of your own after the material closes.

Questions for This Part

1 What can I currently complete in listening, speaking, reading, and writing, rather than what is my average “level”?

1 How does a word, sound, or text move from something I have seen to something I can use under a new condition?

1 How does input pass through recall, expression, and feedback until it becomes independent ability?

1 Where can AI support practice, and where must it leave so that I complete the work myself?

Do not let the weakest skill deny everything you can do, and do not let the strongest skill hide a real gap. A baseline is not a verdict. It is a map that gives the next action a direction.

Reading Path

Path	Chapters	What to leave behind
Locate the starting point	CEFR Goals and Self-check	One unpolished baseline for each of listening, speaking, reading, and writing
Build the method	Learning Principles · Vocabulary	One real context, reusable chunks, and a retest date
Open understanding	Listening · Reading	A reconstruction of the main idea, difficulty categories, and source record
Enter expression	Speaking · Writing	First version, feedback, revision, and expression under a new condition
Use the tool	Learning English with AI	AI boundaries, an independent retest, and feedback from a real audience

Do not advance every chapter at once. Choose one task that will occur in life: a meeting, email, document, explanation, or conversation. Open the abilities required by that task and let the other chapters remain quiet for now.

What to Carry Forward

At the end of this part, leave at least three things:

1. A baseline sample you can repeat thirty days later;
2. One English output a real audience can understand, answer, or use;
3. An Evidence Chain with time, conditions, and the next variable.

If you have only saved links, playback time, and the feeling of having studied, this part is not complete. Close the material, change the task slightly, and try again alone. Ability is what remains when the prompt leaves.

Enter the Work

Do not begin by deciding whether you are “good at English”. Begin with a sheet of paper and preserve what you can do today.

The door does not wait for perfect preparation. Often you push first, and only then does light enter through the opening.

CEFR Goals and English Self-check

The CEFR describes **what a person can do with language in context**. It is not an app score or a fixed vocabulary count. This page simplifies the Council of Europe global scale to help you choose a starting point; it does not replace a formal assessment.

Quick Overview

1. save an unpolished baseline for listening, speaking, reading, and writing separately;
1. translate an A1–C2 direction into a context, task, quality threshold, and deadline;
1. use seven-day, thirty-day, and twelve-week rhythms instead of chasing one average level;
1. retest under comparable conditions with a parallel task and outside feedback before choosing the next variable.

A1-C2: What Can I Do?

Level	Observable overall performance
A1	Understand and use very common expressions; interact simply when the other person speaks slowly and helps.
A2	Handle direct exchanges about familiar matters such as personal information, shopping, places, and work.
B1	Understand the main points on familiar matters; handle most travel situations and briefly explain experiences, plans, and reasons.
B2	Understand main ideas in complex concrete or abstract texts; interact fairly naturally and explain a viewpoint clearly.
C1	Understand demanding, longer material and implicit meaning; use language flexibly in social, academic, and professional settings.
C2	Understand almost everything heard or read with ease; synthesize sources, reconstruct arguments, and express fine distinctions precisely.

Source: Council of Europe, CEFR 3.3 Global Scale, accessed 2026-08-16. These are action-oriented summaries, not the official wording.

Four-skill Evidence

Choose one topic connected to real life. Complete the first version without looking things up and keep the raw sample.

Skill	10–20 minute task	Check
Listening	Hear 2–4 minutes; record the main point, three details, and a retelling	Gist, detail, chunk boundaries, causes of misses
Reading	Read 600–1000 words; write five summary sentences and one challenge	Claim, evidence, inference, whether unknown words block meaning
Speaking	Record an unscripted two-minute explanation	Intelligibility, pauses, grammar, chunks, task completion
Writing	Write a 180–250 word email, explanation, or argument in 20 minutes	Purpose, structure, support, accuracy, revision

Save the samples in the English Diagnostic. Rate each skill separately when the profile is uneven.

Turn a Level into a Goal

A useful goal contains a **context, task, quality threshold, deadline, and evidence**.

> In 12 weeks, I can deliver a five-minute project update covering context, progress, and risk. Listeners can restate the key points without switching language. I will keep recordings and feedback from weeks 1, 4, 8, and 12.

“Move from B1 to B2” is a direction, not a complete training goal. Progress is rarely linear and cannot be guaranteed by hours alone.

Seven-day Start

1. Day 1: complete four baselines and save the unpolished samples.
1. Days 2–5: choose one skill daily for 25–45 minutes of input, retrieval, output, and feedback.
1. Day 6: repeat the weakest task and compare error categories.
1. Day 7: complete the Weekly Review and choose one focus.

Thirty-day System

1 Complete at least one inspectable task in each skill every week; repeat the priority skill more often.

1 Classify errors as comprehension, vocabulary/chunks, pronunciation, grammar, structure, strategy, or attention.

1 Repeat an old task or a parallel task weekly and compare performance rather than feeling.

1 On day 30, repeat the baseline conditions and keep both samples plus external feedback.

Twelve-week Transfer

1 Weeks 1–4: establish rhythm with tasks below the frustration threshold.

1 Weeks 5–8: increase complexity and time pressure; transfer across topics.

1 Weeks 9–11: simulate the real exam, meeting, presentation, reading, or writing deliverable.

1 Week 12: complete the final task, obtain a blind or real-audience review, and choose the next cycle.

Feedback Rubric

Score each `0=not completed`, `1=partly`, or `2=consistently`:

1 **Task completion**: did the intended information and purpose arrive?

2 **Comprehensibility**: could the audience understand without guessing?

3 **Accuracy and range**: did language choices support the task?

4 **Organisation and fluency**: was the message coherent without disruptive pauses?

5 **Revision and transfer**: could you improve from feedback and reuse it in a new task?

Use totals only for your own longitudinal comparison, never as a label for another person.

Carry the Self-check into the Next Cycle

This rubric describes performance in one task; it does not announce that you have “reached a level”. After the self-check, carry the result into Evidence: How Change Becomes Visible:

1. Save today's baseline instead of replacing it with the revised version;
2. record immediate performance after practice and what help you received;
3. remove the recent prompts and retest delayed retention after seven days;
4. change the topic, audience, or task after thirty or ninety days to check transfer.

When the four skills differ, track separate evidence chains. The value of a self-check is not a flattering label. It gives the next practice a point that can be compared.

Use the Evidence Chain Template to keep the four time points together instead of preserving only a final score.

Closing: A Level Is Only a Coordinate

A level can suggest how far away a task may be. It cannot tell you why the journey matters, and it cannot travel for you. A2, B1, or C1 describes performance under particular conditions. It is not the limit of a person, or a certificate of who deserves to be heard, trusted, or loved.

Real change is often quieter than a changed label: the first time you understand a stranger's request, finish explaining your reason in a meeting, or write an email the other person does not have to decipher. The label may remain where it was, while another usable road has already opened between you and the world.

Keep today's score, and keep today's awkwardness too. When you return, do not ask whether you finally deserve a letter. Ask which real task you can now complete more fully. A coordinate should help a person find a road, not pin them to the ground.

Learning Principles: Turn Effort into Evidence

Before choosing an app or textbook, decide why you are learning, what task you need to complete, how you will judge it, and how to train without sacrificing health.

Separate Three Kinds of Claim

1 **Research evidence** reports effects observed under stated conditions, not a guarantee for every learner.

1 **Personal experience** explains why I made a choice; it is a clue for your experiment, not a universal rule.

1 **Hypothesis** lacks enough evidence and should become a question to test.

When advice omits the population, conditions, outcome, and source, treat it as a hypothesis.

Why Learn English?

English connects you to technical documentation, research, courses, cultural work, and international collaboration. That importance is still not an actionable goal. Name the context:

1 an exam with a date, target score, and task types;

1 study that requires discussion, academic reading, or writing;

1 work that requires documentation, email, meetings, interviews, or presentations;

1 life that requires travel, reading, or communication with particular people.

> My primary context is ______. In 12 weeks I will complete ______ under ______ conditions. The evidence will be ______.

The context determines material and feedback. Do not distribute time evenly in pursuit of a vague wish to “improve English”.

Remove the Learning-pyramid Percentages

Earlier editions repeated claims such as “people retain 10% of reading and 90% of practice”. Those precise numbers have no reliable research basis and are not what Edgar Dale's Cone of Experience proposed. This edition removes the old diagram and percentages.

Keep a testable principle instead: **repeated exposure can create familiarity, while retrieving, explaining, applying, and receiving feedback reveals whether knowledge is usable.**

Two broadly supported strategies are:

1 **retrieval practice**: close the source, recall, answer, retell, write, or teach;

1 **distributed practice**: return at multiple points instead of cramming once.

Neither offers universal percentages or a universal calendar. Difficulty, prior knowledge, delay, and assessment method all matter.

A Complete Learning Loop

Each 25–45 minute session should contain:

1. **Task**: “retell a two-minute news clip”, not “practise listening”.
2. **First attempt**: produce a baseline without excessive lookup.
3. **Targeted input**: review only the information needed for current errors.
4. **Active output**: close the material and perform again.
5. **Feedback and record**: compare versions and update Learning State.

Finishing a video or feeling that it made sense is not the endpoint. Performance after the source is closed is stronger evidence.

Output Is Not Performance Theatre

Active output can be small:

1 write a three-sentence summary from memory;

1 list a main point and three details after listening;

1 explain a concept without notes;

1 use a new chunk in two settings;

1 record sixty seconds, replay it, and mark pauses.

Output exposes gaps. Its job is not to prove intelligence.

Let Performance Set the Interval

A schedule such as days 1, 2, 4, 7, and 15 can be a reminder, but it is not Ebbinghaus's universal prescription for you.

1 Easy and accurate recall: lengthen the interval or raise difficulty.

1 Effortful success: keep a similar interval.

1 Frequent failure: shorten the interval, reduce material, or repair prerequisites.

1 Recognition without use: add production and varied contexts.

Record performance and adjust. Missing an imagined “perfect review time” is not a reason to abandon the system.

Sleep and Recovery Are Inputs

Personal experience

At school I once confused visible effort with learning: waking at 5:20, skipping midday rest, and reading after lights-out. Time rose while performance fell. I interpreted this as insufficient effort and pushed harder.

That story does not prove all early rising is ineffective. It shows that **for me, chronic sleep loss, no error diagnosis, and mechanical hours combined badly**.

Evidence boundary

Sleep contributes to memory consolidation, while sustained sleep loss can affect attention and performance. Needs and health conditions differ. This guide gives no medical diagnosis; persistent sleep, mood, or physical problems deserve qualified professional care.

Budget sleep, movement, food, and unassigned time. Recovery is a condition for the next session, not a prize after it.

Do Not Match Fixed “Learning Styles”

People may prefer pictures, sound, or text, but evidence does not support classifying people as visual or auditory learners and improving outcomes by matching instruction to that label.

Choose representation by content and task:

1 pronunciation needs sound, articulation, and acoustic feedback;

1 spelling needs visual recognition and production;

1 spatial relationships often benefit from diagrams;

1 communication integrates listening, speaking, reading, and writing.

Multiple representations can help. A preference is not a fixed identity or ability ceiling.

Compare with Your Baseline

A useful goal includes a real context, observable task, quality threshold, deadline, and comparable evidence. Use the CEFR self-check for four separate baselines. An average label cannot describe B2 reading and A2 speaking.

Order Feedback by Impact

Treat only one to three high-impact problems at a time:

1. task completion and meaning;
2. organisation and logic;
3. recurring vocabulary, grammar, or pronunciation errors;
4. low-impact details last.

AI can classify errors and create parallel practice, but it can misjudge facts, pronunciation, and usage. Check important work against dictionaries, corpora, teachers, peers, or real audiences.

Seven Days, Thirty Days, Twelve Weeks

Seven days: baseline

1 save short samples in all four skills;

1 choose one real context;

1 complete three full learning loops;

1 change only one variable from the evidence on day seven.

Thirty days: rhythm

1 keep at least one comparable output each week;

1 classify errors instead of calling everything “careless”;

1 replace exercises gradually with authentic material;

1 repeat the baseline conditions on day thirty.

Place baseline, immediate performance, delayed retention, and transfer in the Evidence Chain Template to see what practice actually left behind.

Twelve weeks: transfer

1 save parallel samples in weeks 1, 4, 8, and 12;

1 add time pressure, unfamiliar topics, or a real audience;

1 complete an exam simulation, meeting, presentation, long reading, or writing deliverable;

1 let the result define the next cycle.

Action

1 Complete the English Diagnostic.

2 Create a Learning State.

3 Delete one task that produces effort but no evidence.

4 Schedule the first 25–45 minute learning loop.

Sources

1 Dunlosky et al. (2013), Improving Students' Learning With Effective Learning Techniques

1 Roediger & Karpicke (2006), Test-Enhanced Learning

1 Cepeda et al. (2006), Distributed Practice in Verbal Recall Tasks

1 Pashler et al. (2008), Learning Styles: Concepts and Evidence

Closing: Give the Method to the Next Attempt

The temptation of a learning method is that it looks like a shortcut. A method begins to belong to you only when the material is closed, the cue is gone, the task has changed, and it can still help you finish something.

You do not need to memorise every researcher's name or turn life into continuous measurement. One plain loop is enough: attempt the task alone and let difficulty appear; obtain specific feedback; return after an interval; change one condition and see whether the ability travels with you.

A good method does not make you better at explaining how hard you have worked. It makes you more able to complete something when no one is reminding you. What remains is not the name of the method, but the knowledge of how to begin the next unfamiliar problem.

Vocabulary: From Recognition to Contextual Use

Vocabulary is not a set of `English = translation` pairs. Knowing a word or chunk involves recognising its sound and form, understanding common senses, knowing collocation and register, and producing it in an appropriate setting.

Quick Overview

1 separate receptive vocabulary in listening/reading from productive vocabulary in speaking/writing;

1 select valuable chunks from a real task instead of using a total count as proof of progress;

1 turn familiarity into use through retrieval, collocation, real contexts, and performance-adjusted spacing;

1 use the Vocabulary Audit and delayed transfer to check whether understanding and production remain a week later.

Remove Two Misleading Equations

Earlier editions claimed that 1,000 words give 75% understanding and 7,000 nearly 90%. Such equations mix counting units, corpora, and definitions of comprehension, so this edition removes them.

Before discussing vocabulary size, ask:

1 Are we counting word forms, lemmas, or **word families**?

1 Is the material conversation, fiction, news, academic prose, or specialist documentation?

1 Are proper nouns and transparent compounds included?

1 Does “know” mean recognition or productive use across skills?

Research by Nation and others often discusses **95%** and **98%** lexical coverage as reading conditions. At 95%, roughly one running word in twenty remains unfamiliar; at 98%, about one in fifty. The higher figure generally supports more independent comprehension, but no fixed vocabulary count guarantees understanding. Background knowledge, text structure, language distance, and the task still matter.

Four Kinds of Vocabulary Evidence

Dimension	Question	Evidence
Receptive listening	Can I segment and understand it in speech?	Hear a sentence without captions and explain it
Receptive reading	Can I understand it from a new context?	Explain its function in a new article
Productive speaking	Can I retrieve it quickly with natural collocation?	Use it naturally in a recording
Productive writing	Can I spell it and choose the right register?	Use it accurately in a new task

Feeling familiar after seeing the answer is only a small part. Receptive knowledge often precedes productive knowledge, so choose the target from the real task.

Word Families Are a Research Tool

`help, helps, helped, helpful, helpless` may count as one family in some estimates, but learners do not automatically know every derived form. Families help estimate coverage; they do not replace learning morphology, part of speech, and use.

The useful unit is often larger than one word:

1. collocation: `pose a risk`, `meet a deadline`;
1. chunk: `What I mean is ...`, `It depends on whether ...`;
1. morphology: `analyse` → `analysis` → `analytical`;
1. register: `kids`, `children`, and `minors` differ by context.

Do Not Classify Visual and Auditory Learners

Evidence does not support improving learning by matching instruction to fixed visual or auditory labels. Vocabulary itself needs multiple kinds of evidence:

1. **hear** pronunciation and connected speech;
2. **see** spelling, morphology, and a real sentence;
3. **say** it, record it, and compare stress and sounds;
4. **write** an original sentence or short text;
5. **use** it in varied but related contexts.

Images suit concrete concepts; definitions and contexts suit abstract ones; pronunciation requires sound. Representation follows the content, not a learner identity.

Select What to Learn

Prioritise items that:

1. recur in current material or work;
2. block the main idea or task when unknown;
3. form useful collocations with known vocabulary;
4. have a clear use in the next two weeks;
5. are essential terms in a specialist task.

Temporarily skip one-off low-frequency detail that does not block meaning.

Technical Word Lists: Start from the Task

The word lists in this repository are lookup indexes, not daily quotas. Open a real task, choose 5–8 chunks from the closest list below, then return to current documentation, code, or meeting material to verify meaning and register:

List	Useful task entry
Common	Everyday communication, general work, and cross-topic language
Prompt	AI task instructions, constraints, and acceptance language
Vibe Coding	AI-assisted development, agent collaboration, and code review
JavaScript	Front-end scripts, browser APIs, and asynchronous flows
Python	Data work, automation, and scripting
Go	Server-side, concurrency, and deployment contexts
Java	JVM projects, types, and enterprise systems
PHP	Web back ends, templates, and legacy maintenance
Rust	Ownership, performance, and systems programming
Swift	Apple platforms, interfaces, and app development

Run every list through the same small loop: select terms from the current task, check sound, collocation, version, and source; speak or write a new sentence without the list;

retest in a parallel task a week later. Terms change with language versions, frameworks, and products. Return important decisions to official documentation instead of treating a list as a technical standard.

A High-quality Card

The front should demand retrieval, not recognition.

```
Context: how do I say that a dependency creates risk for a schedule?
Gap: The dependency may ____ a risk to the schedule.
```

The back includes:

1. `pose a risk to`;
1. one trustworthy source sentence and citation;
1. pronunciation or audio;
1. a short sense and register note;
1. your second example;
1. a contrast such as `cause` versus `pose`.

Long cards turn review into rereading. Test one decision per card when possible.

Performance-adjusted Spacing

Forgetting is real, but there is no universal review timetable. In Anki or another spaced-repetition tool, let performance control the interval:

1. fast, accurate recall plus new use: lengthen it;
1. effortful success: keep or slightly lengthen it;
1. repeated confusion: add contrast and a new context;
1. repeated failure: reduce new cards, split the card, or repair pronunciation/concept foundations;
1. correct cards but no real-world use: stop adding volume and switch to speaking or writing.

Anki is one tool, not the method. An old third-party “Macmillan 7000” deck shared here is no longer distributed because its link, maintenance, and redistribution rights cannot be kept current.

Practice in Real Context

For each group, complete at least two transfers:

1. alter the people, time, viewpoint, or domain in the source sentence;
1. contrast a natural use with a typical misuse;
1. give a 60–90 second retelling without the list;
1. find three collocations in independent real sources;
1. use the chunks in an email, explanation, log, or short essay.

Prefer learner dictionaries for pronunciation, collocation, and examples. AI can generate candidates, but verify definitions, collocations, and examples against dictionaries or real corpora.

A Thirty-minute Session

1. Five minutes: select 5–8 valuable chunks from real material.
2. Eight minutes: check pronunciation, sense, collocation, and register.
3. Seven minutes: create short retrieval cards.
4. Seven minutes: speak or write a different context without the source.
5. Three minutes: record errors and the condition for the next check.

Daily new-word count is not the outcome. Understanding and using items in a new task a week later is.

If you are unsure where the bottleneck is, use the Vocabulary Audit Template to record listening, reading, speaking, writing, and delayed transfer separately.

Seven Days, Thirty Days, Twelve Weeks

Seven days

1. collect 20–30 chunks from one real topic;
1. include sound, collocation, and source for each;
1. complete at least two closed-book retrievals;
1. on day seven, record two minutes or write 200 words with the set.

Thirty days

1 use parallel material weekly to test listening or reading coverage;

1 complete one real output with the week's chunks;

1 delete low-value, duplicate, or cue-dependent cards;

1 compare comprehension, production, and retention rather than card totals.

Twelve weeks

1 build a small corpus around one professional or life domain;

1 use high-frequency chunks in meetings, articles, code review, exams, or presentations;

1 sample delayed recall and transfer to unfamiliar contexts;

1 expand domains only after output becomes stable.

Feedback Criteria

For each target chunk, ask whether you can:

1 recognise it in speech and text;

1 explain the current sense in your own words;

1 use natural collocation, form, and register;

1 produce it without a cue;

1 reuse it in a new context one week later.

Put listening, production, delayed retention, and new-context reuse for each chunk into the Evidence Chain Template, not only a card count.

Sources

1 Hu & Nation (2000), Unknown Vocabulary Density and Reading Comprehension - Crossref record

1 Nation (2006), How Large a Vocabulary Is Needed for Reading and Listening?

1 Schmitt, Jiang & Grabe (2011), The Percentage of Words Known in a Text and Reading Comprehension

1 Pashler et al. (2008), Learning Styles: Concepts and Evidence

Closing: Return Words to Life

A word list resembles a warehouse: orderly, quiet, and easy to mistake for ownership. A word becomes yours not when a card turns green, but when you need to ask, explain, refuse, apologise, or comfort, and it walks out of memory to carry meaning toward another person.

You do not need every word in a language. Begin with the words connected to the work you are doing, the people you love, and the world you are trying to understand. Let them return through different voices, sentences, and situations. Allow yourself to forget, then retrieve them again from a real need.

May each new word become less a stone placed on memory than a window slowly opening. Beyond it is not a more impressive vocabulary total, but a conversation, a page of knowledge, and a way of living that you could not enter before.

Listening: From Sound Recognition to Real Understanding

Source (Chinese edition): Listening

Many of the example videos are hosted on YouTube. Captions, availability, and local access rules can change; follow the laws and platform rules that apply where you live, and use an accessible equivalent when necessary.

Listening does not improve just because your ears are surrounded by English. The useful loop is: miss the meaning, check the transcript, listen again, and retell it in your own words.

Quick Overview

1 Keep one main source long enough to build continuity;

1 use intensive listening for detail and extensive listening for stamina;

1 choose material that is slightly challenging but repeatable;

1 leave visible evidence after each session: a dictation, retelling, or three-point note.

Choosing and Maintaining Materials

Treat resources as training equipment, not collectibles. Define the task first, then choose one main source you can stay with and one parallel source for a transfer check. The main source lets you see change; the parallel source tests whether you learned a method rather than memorised a clip.

Task	Material condition	Evidence of completion
Hear the sounds	30 seconds–3 minutes with a reliable English transcript	Mark unclear timestamps and classify the barrier: language, connected speech, or attention
Catch the gist	2–5 minutes on a familiar topic	Write one-sentence gist and three details after the first listen
Adjust to natural speed	An interview, meeting, or lecture segment with varied speech	Retell without captions and keep the recording or transcript
Build stamina	An audiobook, show, stream, or song you will revisit	Note topic, emotion, and key facts without chasing every word

Keep the chosen material for seven days before replacing it. Record the source, title, length, transcript status, access date, and any copyright or usage boundary. Platforms can retitle, remove, or replace videos and captions; the links on this page are entry points, not rankings, sponsorships, or promises of permanent availability. When a link breaks, replace it with a current page from the same source while preserving the task and difficulty.

Copy the Listening Resource Audit to turn “I like this channel” into a test of whether it supports your current task.

Common Mistakes When Practicing Listening

1. **Scattering your materials**

   If you subscribe to everything—VOA, BBC, ten podcasts, random “classic readings”… you’ll end up listening to nothing consistently.

   One day VOA, next day BBC, then you bounce between random YouTube channels. That kind of “no plan, just vibes” practice isn’t very efficient.

   VOA/BBC/podcasts can be great. Just pick a few you genuinely like and that fit your time.

1. **Starting with materials that are too hard**

   Some learners start with VOA, but fit depends on your vocabulary, background knowledge, and task. Even “VOA slow” may contain enough unknown words to make you stuck and lose interest.

   Some people ask: “If I don’t understand it once, what if I listen 10 times?”

   If you have no idea what the material means, repeating it mechanically usually repeats the confusion. Use the transcript to confirm key words and sentence structure, then return to the audio.

   US/UK TV shows are even less beginner-friendly. Choose materials that match your current vocabulary and level, and move up step by step.

1. **Over-relying on subtitles**

   If you watch shows with bilingual subtitles, it’s easy to think you “understand most of it”. Try turning subtitles off. Even on a rewatch, you’ll miss a lot.

   Does “no subtitles” automatically improve listening? Not always—because it can violate the previous rule (material too hard).

A better approach: reduce subtitle support in stages. Understand the story first, remove Chinese subtitles next, then choose a short scene for intensive listening.

1 **Using materials you don’t care about**

No matter how “high quality” a listening resource is, if it bores you, it becomes torture. And I won’t tell you to “learn to love” something you already know you hate.

There’s so much content out there now—it’s not hard to find something both useful and interesting.

Bonus: choose materials that help your work, life, relationships, fitness, etc. Real benefits create real motivation.

1 **Listening on autopilot**

Most people listen to English songs a lot, but rarely pay attention to lyrics. That’s a huge missed opportunity.

English lyrics are often beautifully written. If you learn what the lyrics mean and try to identify what’s being sung, you’ll improve over time.

That said: sometimes just enjoy the music. Turning life into 24/7 studying can lower your happiness too.

Intensive vs. Extensive Listening

Intensive listening

The goal is: understand the meaning first, then try to hear every word clearly. Intensive practice often pairs well with:

1 dictation (spelling what you hear)

1 repeating out loud (shadowing / speaking practice)

It’s normal if you can’t keep up on the first listen. A few repeats usually make a big difference.

For a 30-second to 3-minute clip, use five steps: listen for gist, mark unclear sounds, check the English transcript, listen again without text, and retell the meaning. Do not demand a perfect first pass; make each pass answer a different question.

Intensive practice also helps you notice pronunciation patterns: linking, reductions, pauses, chunking. Find your weak spots and train them deliberately.

In high school I used a very “dumb” method: I listened over and over until I could recite and write down the whole text. I spent a lot of time on *New Concept English* Book 3. Back then, I couldn’t really see the improvement and even wondered if it was pointless—until I scored 115/120 on the English exam.

There are many options, but *New Concept English* Book 3 and 4 are solid classics for this kind of training.

Extensive listening

Extensive listening is about making English exposure natural, building intuition, and understanding the overall meaning rather than every detail.

It helps with vocabulary and speaking too. Great sources include audiobooks, movies, TV shows, and music.

Audiobooks

Many classics and bestsellers have audiobook versions: *Gone with the Wind*, *The Kite Runner*, *Pride and Prejudice*, *The Great Gatsby*, etc.

Many audiobooks are narrated by professional actors or broadcasters. Their voice and pacing may help you keep listening; whether they serve your current task still needs a gist, detail, and delayed-transfer check.

1. audible can be a catalogue entry point; price, region, rights, and app features change, so check them against your task and budget.
1. Some Chinese “FM” apps also have good audiobooks.

TV shows

Friends can be an entry point for familiar everyday dialogue. *Modern Family* is a sitcom I personally enjoy, and its family settings can support short-scene practice. *Better Call Saul* is usually harder in speed, register, and context. Start with one short scene from any of them and retest against your baseline and task.

> Season 1 of *Modern Family* was filmed in 2009. In real life, many people’s “modern family life” still hasn’t caught up to that 2009 version.

Movies

Movies can be an extensive-listening entry when you are willing to revisit them and can follow most of the gist. A ranking is only a selection lead, not a difficulty judgment; see the Douban Top 250 list: https://movie.douban.com/top250

Movies I’ve watched 10+ times (purely personal taste):

1 *Flipped*

1 *The Godfather* I/II/III

1 *WALL·E*

1 *Witness for the Prosecution*

1 *The Apartment*

1 *Interstellar*

1 *Life Is Beautiful*

> Learning English through movies and TV takes a decent foundation. Any benefit should be checked through understanding, retelling, and transfer rather than assumed from exposure. Podcasts or audio with lyrics may reduce visual distraction, but compare samples before deciding that they fit your task better.

Music

When choosing songs, use current charts and check their region and date. The list below preserves only the selection approach.

There are way too many great songs to list, but here are a few directions:

1 popular artists: Justin Bieber, Troye Sivan, Katy Perry, Taylor Swift, The Weeknd, Imagine Dragons, Ed Sheeran, Adele, Maroon 5, Billie Eilish, Sam Smith…

1 Apple Music charts

1 Billboard

1 UK charts

Live streams

If you like streams, find creators you enjoy on Twitch.

Beginner Listening Training

1 Basic English Grammar
Great for beginners. It teaches very basic grammar and introduces common vocabulary at a moderate speed.

1 Learn English with Valen - Basic English lessons by ValenESL
Mostly basic grammar and word usage. The videos are old and the channel is no longer updated, but it’s still a solid beginner resource.

Advanced: Understanding Native-Speed English

Do you sometimes struggle to follow native speakers, or to understand YouTube videos and movies?

Maybe you do fine in listening tests inside apps, feel confident… and then you remove subtitles and everything collapses.

One important thing: most listening training materials are **processed**—they're made easier on purpose so learners don't feel crushed.

A common mistake in listening is focusing too hard on single words instead of the sentence meaning.

But:

1 words change in context

1 when words connect, pronunciation changes too

If you translate word by word, you will misunderstand. Try to listen for **chunks and meaning**.

If you want a deep dive, this is one possible intensive-listening entry. Check its captions, difficulty, and today's task before starting:

1 Understand Native English Speakers with this Advanced Listening Lesson

---

English Learning Resources by Task

The links below are interest-based entry points, not a completion list. Filter them using the criteria above before subscribing; if a resource produces no output for two weeks, unsubscribe or replace it.

Programming Context: Technical Listening

1 laracasts
Useful for tutorial tone, step-by-step explanations, and technical chunks. Course content, pricing, and update status change; verify technical claims against current documentation.

1 LearnCode.academy
The channel has been inactive for years. Older videos can practise the language of software, while frameworks, dependencies, and APIs must be checked in current documentation.

1. Traversy Media
   Broad front-end coverage for technical-context listening. Reassess difficulty for each video and verify conclusions against current documentation.
1. Derek Banas
   His “learn a language in one video” series has high information density and faster delivery; use it after building some foundations and check syntax in official material.
1. The Net Ninja
   Start with a short CSS/Sass segment to practise steps, examples, and terminology; recheck version information in older videos.
1. DevTips
   Inactive for years. Use its CSS/jQuery material as archived listening practice, not as current technical guidance.
1. egghead.io
   Front-end courses and short videos. Recheck availability, content, and technical versions before starting.

English-teaching channels: pronunciation and expression

1. EnglishLessons4U - Learn English with Ronnie! [engVid] Choose a grammar or dialogue clip, observe explanations, examples, and tone, then retell it in your own words.
1. English with Lucy!
   Teaching videos that make pronunciation, vocabulary, and tone easy to observe. Start with a short clip that has English captions.
1. EnglishAnyone
   Choose daily-life topics for gist and retelling. “Standard” is not the goal; understanding and expression are.
1. Speak English With Vanessa
   Scenario-based conversations for practising stress, tone, and repair; filter each clip by task.
1. mmmEnglish
   Short clips for observing pronunciation and chunks; do not treat one speaker’s style as the only target.
1. English Fluency Journey
   Dialog-focused lessons. Very helpful.

Film clips: extensive listening only

1 TopMovieClip
Fan-oriented extensive listening; clips may lack context or reliable captions, so they are not the first intensive-listening choice.

1 BestClips
More superhero movie clips.

Interviews and shows: natural speed

1 Jimmy Kimmel Live Try short captioned clips to observe improvised questions, humour, and changing speed.

1 TheEllenShow (the show ended in 2022; archived clips can practise interview language; platform status and captions change)

1 The Late Show with Stephen Colbert

Music: lyrics and chunks

1 Valerie Pola

1 Luciana Zogbi

1 Sara Farell

1 JFla

1 Boyce Avenue

1 xooos

1 Hailee Steinfeld

Others

1 Disney UK Start with a familiar animated song or dialogue: understand the lyrics first, then isolate a short clip for intensive listening. View counts change and are not evidence of learning quality.

1 Vevo Find official music videos by interest. Confirm lyric source and captions, then isolate a short clip.

1 OneDirectionVEVO Fan-oriented listening or lyric retelling with familiar songs; verify channel status and copyright boundaries.

1 SiaVEVO
Choose official or authorised material by interest and check lyric, caption, and usage boundaries.

1 SSSniperWolf For lifestyle videos, confirm that the topic, captions, and language difficulty fit your current task.

1 TED
Choose a clearly scoped talk to practise gist, evidence, and attitude. Popularity does not guarantee task fit, and captions change.

A Few Specific YouTube Videos

1 Confidence tips - Dr. Ivan Joseph - TEDxRyersonU

1 One small tip to speak English fluently

1 Julian Treasure: How to speak so that people want to listen | Bilibili

1 Sia - Chandelier (Official Video)

CEFR Task Goals

1 **A1–A2**: identify people, time, place, and direct needs in slow, familiar speech.

1 **B1**: follow main points and important detail on familiar topics, then retell them.

1 **B2**: follow natural interviews, meetings, or lectures and distinguish position, reason, and attitude.

1 **C1–C2**: process extended, implicit, or accent-diverse material and synthesise sources.

A level selects material; a real goal states conditions, task, and evidence.

Inspectable Practice

Choose 2–5 minutes with a reliable transcript:

1 Listen once without pausing; write the gist and three details.

2 Mark uncertain time ranges on a second pass without reading the whole transcript.

3 Classify errors: unknown language, known-but-not-heard, connected speech, background knowledge, or attention.

4 Shadow two or three useful segments, close the transcript, and retell.

5. Use parallel material one week later to test transfer.

Keep the first answer, error timestamps, retelling, and delayed test. Playback time is not evidence.

Feedback

Score each 0–2: gist, key detail, segmentation, retelling comprehensibility, and delayed transfer. Repair the largest barrier instead of perfecting every sound at once.

Put the first answer, immediate retelling, delayed test, and cross-material transfer in the Evidence Chain Template so change can be compared beyond playback time.

Seven Days, Thirty Days, Twelve Weeks

1. **Seven days**: four 2–3 minute sessions; compare parallel material on days 1 and 7.
1. **Thirty days**: one intensive listen, two extensive listens, and one no-caption retelling weekly; count error categories rather than hours alone.
1. **Twelve weeks**: increase speed, accent variety, length, and topic unfamiliarity; finish with a blind-rated meeting, lecture, or exam simulation.

Closing: Hear the Person Behind the Sound

Listening is not catching every sound as if completing a checklist that may never lose a corner. It begins with hearing, through rhythm, pauses, accents, and noise, that someone is trying to make a meaning arrive.

At first, English may be one unbroken surface of sound. Later you hear a familiar chunk, a turn in the argument, hesitation inside an unfinished sentence. You still miss things, but one missing word no longer destroys the whole passage. Context, a question, or a retelling can connect understanding again.

When sound is no longer merely exam material, language becomes a human voice again. You hear more than English. You hear an experience, a judgment, and another person's way of seeing the world. This is how the world enters, a little at a time, through the ear.

Reading: From Word-by-word Translation to Claims and Evidence

Source (Chinese edition): Reading

Reading is not moving every word into another language. It is building meaning, structure, and judgment while some uncertainty remains. You need to know when to continue, when to verify, and when to separate the author's claim from your own opinion.

Quick Overview

1 use intensive reading for structure, evidence, and tone, and extensive reading for speed, stamina, and interest;

1 choose material that is slightly challenging but finishable;

1 recommend books by reading task, not by sales or ranking claims;

1 leave a gist, structure, supported inference, and retelling after each session.

Choose Material by Task

Reading material is not more valuable simply because it is harder. Name the task first, then choose a main source you can finish in the available time and a parallel source on a related topic. The main source trains the method; the parallel source checks transfer.

Task	Material condition	Evidence of completion
Locate information	A notice, instruction, short report, or document with a clear question	Mark the answer in the source and state the supporting line
Follow an argument	A structured comment, report, or technical explanation	Map claim, reasons, evidence, and limitations
Build stamina	A novel, biography, or long nonfiction text you will read for seven days	Keep reading time, chapter gist, and one delayed retelling
Synthesise sources	2–3 texts on one topic with different authors or positions	Write a one-page comparison separating fact, inference, and judgment

Keep the chosen source for at least seven days before replacing it. Record author, title, edition or publication date, access date, length, and usage boundary; web pages can change, become paid, or disappear. These links are entry points, not rankings, sponsorships, or promises of permanent availability. Copy the Reading Evidence Card to preserve evidence from each session.

Intensive vs. Extensive Reading

Intensive reading

Short but dense writing is great for intensive reading—*The Economist* is a classic example.

If you skim an Economist-style article, you'll only get the surface. The structure, subtext, and sharp opinions are where the value is.

Treat intensive reading like tasting: look things up, reread, and try to figure out why the author chose those words.

Extensive reading

Beautiful novels are perfect for extensive reading—*Animal Farm*, for example.

This is more about enjoyment. Sometimes the first few lines hook you so hard you can't stop.

Don't turn it into homework:

1 no strict plan

1 no rushing to "finish the book"

1 go with your mood and enjoy it

Also: start with something manageable. Jumping straight into *A Song of Ice and Fire* is a fast way to get crushed by unknown words and quit.

A Complete Reading Pass

1. **First pass**: finish a short section on a timer without looking up every word; write one-sentence gist.
2. **Mark**: label each paragraph's function and the words or sentences that truly block meaning.
3. **Verify**: check recurring, domain-critical, or reasoning-critical items and record the source.
4. **Reconstruct**: close the dictionary, rebuild the structure in five sentences, and write one supported inference.

5. **Transfer**: read a parallel text one week later and compare speed, gist, and evidence tracking.

If almost every sentence is blocked, choose easier parallel material first. Lowering the entry point does not lower the destination.

Recommended English Books

Here are a few books across relative difficulty levels. The descriptions focus on reading practice rather than rankings, sales, or universal difficulty claims. Recheck the specific edition and availability before starting:

1 Animal Farm — George Orwell

A compact allegorical story that works well for practising repeated vocabulary, narrative movement, and the relationship between claims and symbols.

1 The Curious Incident of the Dog in the Night-time — Mark Haddon

The distinctive first-person voice makes it useful for studying logical connectors, perspective, and how a narrator shapes evidence.

1 The Diary of a Young Girl — Anne Frank

The diary form offers practice in concrete detail, daily observation, and expressing changing emotion without a formal essay structure.

1 Harry Potter series — J. K. Rowling

Popular fiction can be a practical bridge to long-form reading: dialogue, action, recurring vocabulary, and sustained plot all build stamina.

1 The Kite Runner — Khaled Hosseini

A longer, emotionally demanding narrative for practising pacing, relationships, and the way a story carries guilt, loyalty, and repair.

1 On Writing Well — William Zinsser

A clear nonfiction text for intensive reading: follow its structure, notice how sentences are shortened, and imitate one paragraph in your own words.

> A Chinese translation can provide a background map, but do not compare sentence by sentence. Let the English text speak first, then compare changes in tone and emphasis.

WeChat Official Accounts

I rarely use WeChat, so the list below is a personal record of accounts I once read. It does not mean they are still active or suitable for every reader:

1. *English Reading* (official account name: [redacted])
1. *The Monster That Dominates Shanghai* (official account name: [redacted])

If you suggest an account, include its reading task, last-checked date, and a public access path in the issue.

How to Read English Documentation

Do not use a mechanical "five unknown words means stop" rule. First decide whether the words block the main idea. Mark them on a fast first pass; on the second, look up recurring, domain-critical, or reasoning-critical items; then close the dictionary and reconstruct the structure. If almost every sentence is blocked, choose easier parallel material or learn the domain chunks first.

For technical terms, be extra careful:

1. read definitions and examples
1. if you still don't get it, search for good explanations (including Chinese blogs when useful)

If you use tools to pre-extract unknown words from a document and learn them first, reading becomes much smoother.

Choose a device for sustainable reading: if a technical PDF is too small or cannot be searched, switch readers, enlarge the page, or find an HTML version. No single device is a universal answer.

Communities and Technical Articles

1. Medium: find technology, design, or life writing by topic; check author, date, and citations first.
1. Quora: use answers to practise separating personal experience, fact, and speculation; upvotes are not evidence.
1. Reddit: observe informal language and community context; for health, legal, or financial claims, return to primary sources.

1 Hacker News: practise reading technical headlines, comments, and linked sources; verify important claims in the original article.

1 Stack Overflow: study the question, constraints, attempts, and accepted answer; test code against current documentation.

Reference Book

Reading reference: On Writing Well

CEFR Task Goals

1 **A1–A2**: understand short notices, instructions, messages, and direct familiar information.

1 **B1**: identify main point, sequence, and main reasons in familiar articles.

1 **B2**: understand arguments, evidence, and position in complex or specialist material.

1 **C1–C2**: process long, stylistically varied, implicit material and synthesise sources.

Inspectable Practice and Feedback

Choose a challenging but finishable article. Time the first read and state the gist in one sentence; label each paragraph's function; reconstruct the argument in five sentences; write one supported inference and one counterexample; verify quotations last.

Score 0–2 for gist, structure, evidence, inference boundary, and delayed retelling. Unknown-word count is diagnostic, not a level judgment.

Record the first read, argument reconstruction, delayed retelling, and related-topic transfer in the Evidence Chain Template, not only the summary.

Seven Days, Thirty Days, Twelve Weeks

1 **Seven days**: read four short texts on one topic; keep first summaries and a day-seven retelling.

1 **Thirty days**: one annotated close read and two timed extensive reads weekly; compare speed and summary accuracy.

1 **Twelve weeks**: move from one text to multi-source synthesis; finish with a cited report, technical review, or exam simulation.

Closing: Give Words Their Weight Again

Reading is not moving the eyes across line after line as quickly as possible. Behind every worthwhile text, someone chose what to claim, which evidence was enough, what remained uncertain, and what may have been omitted, exaggerated, or misunderstood.

Slow down long enough to ask what the author is claiming, where the reason comes from, which facts can be checked, and which silences deserve attention. Speed may arrive naturally with familiarity. Judgment grows only through the moments when you stop.

One day an English document, email, or book will no longer look like a wall built from unknown words. You will see structure, position, and evidence, and enter with questions of your own. Reading then becomes more than carrying someone else's answers home. It becomes the ability to enter a larger conversation.

Speaking: Make Meaning Arrive

Source (Chinese edition): Speaking

Speaking is not about performing one “correct” accent. It is about making meaning arrive clearly and naturally within a real interaction. Pronunciation, vocabulary, and grammar matter, but they serve comprehension, interaction, and task completion.

Quick Overview

1. build intelligible pronunciation with reliable audio and physical practice, not Chinese approximations;
1. move familiar expressions into your mouth through reading aloud, retelling, role-play, and real conversations;
1. record an unaided first take and repair only the one to three issues that most affect understanding;
1. judge progress by whether a listener can restate your point, not by accent conformity.

Define the Speaking Task First

Speaking practice is not only a monologue. Decide whether you need to explain, interact, repair a misunderstanding, or transfer a skill to a new situation, then choose the exercise.

Task	Conditions	Evidence of completion
Explain	60–120 seconds, unscripted, describing an experience, view, or process	A listener can write your gist and two key details
Interact	At least five turns with questions and follow-ups	Keep the conversation notes and mark one question you used to move it forward
Repair	Start from one real uncertain point and practise clarifying, restating, and confirming	Record how the misunderstanding was found, repaired, and confirmed
Transfer	Repeat with a new person, topic, time limit, or audience	Compare task completion, not accent similarity

Copy the Speaking Evidence Card to keep the recording, transcript, listener feedback, and next variable together.

IPA / Phonics

If you want to speak better, start with pronunciation. IPA is a map, not the destination. Any Chinese approximation is only a cue for mouth shape or airflow; it cannot replace dictionary audio, feedback, or comparing your own recording.

There is no shortcut, but the sound inventory is limited. Hear a sound, inspect the symbol, practise it, and return to it inside real words and sentences.

Recommended playlist:

1 Teach Reading with Phonics - American English Pronunciation!

Vowels (quick reference)

1 cop /■/ — like “ah”

1 the /■/ — “uh” (unstressed)

1 cup /■/ — like “uh” (stressed)

1 boot /u/ — “oo”

1 book /■/ — shorter “oo”

1 beat /i/ — “ee”

1 bit /■/ — “ih”

1 make /e■/ — “ay”

1 head /e/ — “eh”

1 had /æ/ — “a” as in “cat”

1 law /■/ — “aw”

1 now /a■/ — “ow”

1 bite /a■/ — “eye”

1 boy /■■/ — “oy”

1 go /o■/ — “oh”

Consonants (quick reference)

1 web /w/

1 yes /j/

1 father /f/

1 very /v/ (like /f/ but with voice)

1 red /r/ (before a vowel)

1 car /r/ (after a vowel)

1 light /l/ (before a vowel)

1 well /l/ (after a vowel)

1 night /n/ (before a vowel)

1 pen /n/ (after a vowel)

1 mom /m/

1 sing /■/

1 roads /dz/

1 let’s /ts/

1 boss /s/

1 rose /z/ (voiced /s/)

1 thanks /θ/

1 them /ð/

1 just /d■/

1 check /t■/

1 she /■/

1 Asia /■/

1 try /tr/

1 dry /dr/

1 pet /p/

1 bed /b/

1 too /t/

1 do /d/

1 kiss /k/

1. go /g/
1. how /h/

Channel recommendation:

1. EnglishAnyone (great for speaking practice)

Speak Out Loud

Speaking quietly and speaking out loud are very different.

Using *New Concept English* Book 3/4 as an example:

1. listen carefully first
2. read out loud
3. at the beginning, don't worry about linking or pausing—just focus on clear, accurate sounds
4. once you can read smoothly, start mimicking the speaker's rhythm and intonation

---

Real Conversations: When Words Arrive Slowly

When you first speak English with another person, the idea in your head may be richer than the sentence you can produce. That is a common phase. Allow simple sentences, then practise moving the interaction forward instead of treating one pause as a verdict on your ability.

Many people speak like this at first:

1. think in Chinese
2. translate into English in their head
3. search for the right word
4. get stuck and freeze

After enough listening and speaking practice, your brain starts building "reflex phrases". In certain situations you'll respond instantly without translating.

That automaticity comes from repeated listening and use of high-frequency phrases, not from memorising isolated expressions.

A minimum interaction turn can be:

1. **Confirm**: restate the key words you heard.
2. **Respond**: give the core meaning you can express now.
3. **Repair**: ask for repetition or try another wording when needed.
4. **Advance**: ask one question so the conversation keeps moving.

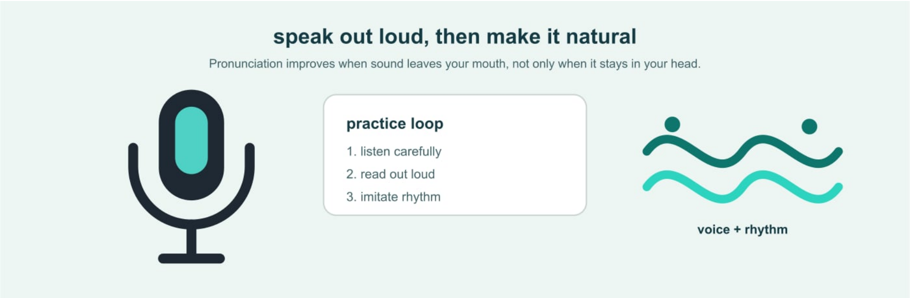
Useful repair lines include `Could you say that again?`, `Do you mean ...?`, `Let me put it another way.`, and `I need a second to think.` They are tools for continuing an interaction, not empty filler.

Sing English Songs

If you're already in love with melodies, why not sing?

Lately I've been into Troye Sivan. Singing can also be a low-pressure pronunciation exercise:

1. organize the lyrics
1. write down unknown words and learn them first
1. sing along (yes, I actually bought a microphone)



speaking practice setup

Keep the interest and make the goal concrete. Singing is not an exam: enjoy the sound first, then notice whether sentences become easier to hear and say.

Prepare Common Questions for Yourself

To build "English intuition", prepare a set of common topics and practice them repeatedly until you can speak smoothly and reorder sentences freely:

1. introduce yourself

1 introduce your hometown

1 how life has been recently

1 a few things that make you happiest

1 a small but unforgettable memory

1 your opinion on a product (e.g., iPad Pro)

Use YouTube Channels by Task

The channels below are entry points for pronunciation and expression practice, not a subscription list. Channels can rename, stop updating, or change captions; check title, captions, access date, and task before starting. Replace or unsubscribe when a source produces no output for two weeks.

1 EnglishAnyone

1 Speak English With Vanessa

1 Doing English with Julian Northbrook

1 A.J. Hoge

1 AccurateEnglish

Less is more. Pick a few and practise a lot. When suggesting a channel, include its task, last-checked date, and public link.

Add Real Interaction Safely

Real interaction does not have to begin with a complete stranger. Start with a classmate, colleague, teacher, or moderated platform partner; voice messages and role-play can add uncertainty gradually.

Do not share identity documents, address, financial, medical, or client information. If someone pressures you, crosses a boundary, or makes you unsafe, end the interaction and use the platform’s block/report tools.

Further reading: Why we’re afraid to talk to strangers

CEFR Task Goals

1 **A1–A2**: complete short introductions, shopping, directions, and appointment interactions.

1 **B1**: explain experiences, plans, and reasons coherently and handle common follow-ups.

1 **B2**: participate fairly naturally, explain specialist matters, and maintain a position.

1 **C1–C2**: organise flexibly and negotiate fine meaning in complex or pressured settings.

Inspectable Practice and Feedback

Choose a real scenario and record an unscripted two-minute first take. Transcribe it and mark only pauses, chunks, grammar, or pronunciation that affect understanding. Repair one to three issues and record again after a delay. Ask a listener to restate the message from the audio alone.

Score 0–2 for task completion, comprehensibility, organisation, interaction, and accuracy/range. A different accent is not an error; prioritise misunderstandings and persistent blocks.

Put the unscripted first take, revised take, listener retelling, and unfamiliar-question transfer in the Evidence Chain Template to separate smoother speech from stable ability.

Seven Days, Thirty Days, Twelve Weeks

1 **Seven days**: four 60–120 second outputs in one scenario, each with first and second takes.

1 **Thirty days**: one monologue, one role-play, and one real or peer conversation weekly; track recurring pauses and repair strategies.

1 **Twelve weeks**: add unfamiliar questions, time pressure, and real audiences; finish with a five-to-ten-minute presentation, interview, or meeting.

Closing: Let Meaning Arrive

Speaking is not removing an accent or reaching a life without hesitation. It is letting another person understand what you mean, why you mean it, and how they might respond, even when time is short and the sentence is imperfect.

You may pause, choose another phrase, or admit that a word has not arrived. Fluency is not the absence of error. It is remaining inside the conversation after an error, repairing what failed, and listening for the place where the other person did not understand.

When you speak the first imperfect sentence and seriously wait for the answer, language stops being a performance completed alone. It becomes a relationship: meaning leaves you, finds an echo in another person's understanding, and returns carrying a new question.

Writing: From Draft to Verifiable Revision

Source (Chinese edition): Writing

Welcome to the writing chapter of *Life Level-up Guide*.

Writing is not decoration applied to thoughts. It is turning something you want another person to understand into a form they can read, answer, and use.

This project began in 2017 as a way to share how I improved my English. It got more love than I expected (I even became “that markdown engineer with a lot of stars”), but after 2019 I basically stopped updating for a few years because I was young, busy with relationships, startups, and other restless experiments.

Coming back to this chapter, I understand writing differently now. It is not decoration outside the English-learning path. It is how a person organizes experience, expresses judgment, repairs the self, and connects with opportunity. Language helps you see a wider world; writing helps you keep what you have seen.

Quick Overview

1 read different forms to study structure, tone, and editorial choices;

1 finish a rough draft before asking for feedback;

1 use AI for diagnosis and comparison, not as a replacement for judgment;

1 let a title serve the work instead of spending readers’ trust for clicks.

Define the Writing Task First

“Write an article” can mean explaining something to a colleague, helping someone choose, telling an experience, or making sense of a difficult season. Each task needs a different shape. State the task, audience, and acceptance condition before drafting.

Task	Conditions	Evidence of completion
Explain	The audience lacks context; write 300–600 words on a timer	A reader can restate the point and next step
Decide	At least two options and a clear deadline	The reader can see reasons, costs, limits, and a recommended action
Narrate	Choose one concrete event without inventing another person’s mind	Timeline is clear; facts, feelings, and speculation are separated

Task	Conditions	Evidence of completion
Reflect	Revisit an experience and label past information versus present interpretation	The piece proposes one testable next step instead of only a conclusion

Copy the Writing Evidence Card to keep task, draft, feedback, revisions, and delivery in one record.

Write for Someone Specific

Before drafting, answer four questions:

Element	Question
Audience	Who needs this, and what do they already know?
Purpose	What should they understand, decide, or do afterward?
Evidence	Which facts, examples, and sources support the judgment?
Constraints	What are the limits of time, length, tone, privacy, and copyright?

If none of these is clear, write an outline first. Clear constraints help you remove attractive but irrelevant sentences.

A resort hotel project used as an example in the author's writing journey

Honestly, I once thought I should just drop the writing chapter. I didn’t feel qualified to talk about writing.

That changed recently, after I published a piece about a failed startup and got a surprising amount of attention. The replies I received were powerful—supportive, thoughtful, and motivating. So I decided to come back and finish this missing chapter.

Writing is both a skill and an art. It helps you express thoughts and emotions, share knowledge, and create value. But good writing is not a one-week project.

This chapter isn't about academic papers. It focuses on everyday writing—articles, posts, and practical communication. Here are a few ingredients that matter.

Read

Reading is the foundation. It teaches you styles, structure, voice, and technique—and it widens your perspective.

Read widely, but read intentionally:

1 pick books/articles based on your interests and goals

1 learn to evaluate the author's arguments, logic, and writing craft

Practice

Practice is the core. It exposes your strengths and weaknesses, and helps you find your voice.

Practice with variety and purpose:

1 choose topics that match your level and needs

1 review your own writing and keep polishing it

A useful 25-minute loop is:

1. 5 minutes: state the point, audience, and acceptance criteria;
2. 12 minutes: write a rough draft without AI writing it for you;
3. 5 minutes: remove repetition and add one fact or example;
4. 3 minutes: record one problem to repair next time.

Keep the rough draft. It is the comparison point that lets you see whether you actually improved.

Four Revision Passes

Do not fix every problem at once. Pass through the piece in this order:

1. **Purpose and facts**: does it answer the task? Can numbers, dates, quotations, and sources be checked?
2. **Structure and evidence**: does each paragraph have a job? Do claims, examples, and limitations match?
3. **Sentences and voice**: remove repetition and filler; tune transitions, tone, and rhythm while keeping your judgment.
4. **Delivery and boundaries**: check title, links, citations, privacy, copyright, format, and the reader’s next step.

Record the one change that most affects the task in each pass. If you cannot explain why a change helps, keep the previous version and return to the feedback question.

Discuss

Discussion is a catalyst. Feedback helps you see blind spots; sharing helps you clarify your thinking.

Do it proactively and sincerely:

1 show your work

1 respect other people’s work

Ask readers to do a specific job rather than “tell me if it is good”:

> After reading, tell me the main point you heard, where you paused, which fact needs checking, and which sentence you would delete.

A reader’s retelling is stronger evidence than a vague like.

Tools

AI can diagnose structure, simulate a reader, check omissions, and generate parallel exercises. Do not begin by asking it to rewrite the whole piece. Give it your version, ask for the three problems that most affect the purpose, revise yourself, and only then compare alternatives.

> For example, this chapter has used AI suggestions. Product screenshots age quickly and can hide the quality of the unaided draft, so this edition keeps the method and revision record rather than old interface images.

Innovation

Innovation is not making language strange on purpose. After the purpose is clear, find your own angle, examples, and rhythm. Help the reader understand first, then give them something to remember.

Honest Titles

Titles can have tension, but they should not promise what the text cannot deliver.

A reliable title matches the subject, scope, and conclusion. Attention purchased at the cost of trust is still a loss in the long run.

I want to remain an honest writer: the work may be imperfect, but it should not deliberately mislead.

CEFR Task Goals

1 **A1–A2**: write short messages, forms, personal descriptions, and simply connected sentences.

1 **B1**: write coherent experiences, email, or familiar-topic texts with basic reasons.

1 **B2**: organise detailed text for an audience, compare positions, and support them with relevant evidence.

1 **C1–C2**: adapt flexibly to complex purposes and registers, synthesise sources, and revise precisely.

Inspectable Practice and Feedback

State audience, purpose, and criteria; produce a timed draft without AI; review facts and task before structure, paragraphs, sentences, and wording; rewrite it yourself; complete a parallel task one week later.

Score 0–2 for purpose, structure, evidence/detail, accuracy/range, and revision transfer. Keep draft, annotations, and final instead of showing only tool-polished work.

Use the Evidence Chain Template to place the draft, immediate revision, delayed writing, and parallel task side by side instead of treating the final as the whole ability.

Seven Days, Thirty Days, Twelve Weeks

1 **Seven days**: complete a real email, an explanation, and a 200–300 word text, each with one revision.

1 **Thirty days**: one real deliverable weekly plus a personal recurring-error checklist; repeat the baseline prompt on day 30.

1 **Twelve weeks**: progress to a multi-source article, report, or application; finish with blind reader feedback and fact, citation, and privacy review.

Pair this chapter with Artifacts: Turn Learning into Something Made to keep draft, feedback, and final delivery in one evidence chain.

Closing: Write the Version You Are Willing to Sign

The world is already noisy. Writing does not need to add more noise. It can preserve a quiet place in life that can be revisited, and let a judgment continue meeting facts, readers, and time after the immediate emotion has passed.

A draft records what you were able to think then. Revision records whether you allowed new evidence and another person's understanding to change you. The writing need not become perfect at once, but every version prepared for delivery should answer more honestly: whose words are these, what supports them, who may be affected, and what remains uncertain?

If you do not know where to start, write a real email, a three-minute explanation, or a 200-word note. Give it to one real person and ask what they understood. Revise until you are willing to sign it, carry its consequences, and open it again in the future.

Learning English with AI: From Practice to Real Delivery

AI can shorten the time needed to find material, create exercises, and receive first-pass feedback. It cannot perform your retrieval, listening discrimination, articulatory movement, judgment, or real communication. This chapter asks one question: **how can AI enter English practice without becoming a substitute for English ability?**

The site-wide loop of problem, baseline, practice, delivery, verification, and review is in Learning Anything with AI. This page keeps only the English-specific work.

Quick Overview

1. state the real situation and acceptance criteria before deciding where AI enters;
1. keep an unaided baseline, feedback, and delayed retest for each skill;
1. use AI for questions, hints, and parallel exercises without outsourcing retrieval or expression;
1. write the result into the AI Learning Log and 90-Day Cycle Map.

> Product features were last checked on **24 August 2026**. Study, project, voice, and writing features vary by region, language, device, account, and plan; reopen the official pages and verify before use.

Define “Can Use English”

Do not start with hours or word counts. Write one real task first:

```
Scenario: I need to introduce an AI project in an English online meeting.
Audience: Three overseas colleagues who do not know the technical details.
Definition of done: Explain the problem, proposal, risks, and next action in three minu
Deadline: 2026-09-30.
Evidence: Raw recording, transcript, question log, email draft, and revision.
```

A useful goal contains a situation, audience, action, acceptance criteria, deadline, and evidence location. AI can help you practise and check; it cannot define completion for you.

1. Save a Baseline Before AI Enters

Do not ask AI to translate, edit, or hint on the first attempt. Complete four 10–15 minute tasks on one topic:

1. **Listening**: hear a two-to-four-minute authentic clip and write the gist, three details, and one uncertainty;
2. **Reading**: read one page and write a five-sentence summary plus one counterexample;
3. **Speaking**: speak for two uninterrupted minutes and save the raw recording;
4. **Writing**: write a 120–180-word work email without a dictionary or AI rewrite.

Score task completion, comprehensibility, accuracy and range, organisation and fluency, and revision and transfer from 0 to 2. Store samples, reasons, and error evidence in the English Diagnostic. Without a baseline, you cannot tell whether AI improved ability or merely polished a product.

Four Skills and Their Evidence Cards

Skill	AI may assist with	Evidence kept after closing AI
Listening	Give one clue, mark timestamps, or create a parallel clip	First pass, error categories, and delayed transfer in the Listening Resource Audit
Reading	Compare paragraph marks and ask for source locations	Gist, claim map, and inference boundary in the Reading Evidence Card
Speaking	Mark unclear segments and simulate follow-up questions	Raw recording, listener retelling, and repair in the Speaking Evidence Card
Writing	Flag layered issues in facts, structure, language, and tone	Draft, four revision passes, and reader feedback in the Writing Evidence Card

Cards are not extra homework. They turn one session into a sample you can revisit. If only AI comments remain, without your first take and transfer task, you cannot tell whether ability changed.

2. Use One Task Card Every Time

```
# English Task Card

Date: YYYY-MM-DD
Real situation:
Action: understand / read / say / write / ask / revise
Acceptance criteria:
Material and source:
Unaided baseline location:
AI may: prompt / question / correct / generate parallel tasks
AI may not: answer for me / rewrite a whole section / invent a source
Output location:
Feedback evidence:
Recurring error:
Smallest next task:
```

At the end choose one or two errors that most affect communication and do a parallel task. Do not collect fifteen suggestions without using them again.

3. Vocabulary: From Recognition to Use

Choose 8–12 high-value chunks from authentic material each week. Save pronunciation, part of speech, collocations, the original sentence, your own sentence, a close alternative, and one retrieval attempt.

AI can generate cloze, correction, and substitution tasks, but check meanings, collocations, and examples against a learner dictionary or real corpus. Schedule four contacts: understand and read aloud on day one, retrieve and make a sentence on day two, use it in speech or email within a week, and transfer it to a new situation after two weeks.

The acceptance test is not “how many I saved”. It is whether you can use the chunk correctly without a cue and be understood.

4. Listening: Split “I Didn’t Understand”

First write only the gist and certain details without subtitles. Then label the problem:

1 unknown vocabulary;

1 known words hidden by linking, reduction, or stress;

1 sentence structure not parsed;

1 insufficient background knowledge;

1 speed, accent, or temporary attention failure.

Ask AI for one small clue, then replay 10–20 seconds. Do not request a full translation immediately. Close the subtitles, paraphrase the clip, and record what remains uncertain.

5. Speaking and Pronunciation: Optimise Communication

A 12-minute session:

1. explain a real problem for two minutes without a script;
2. ask AI to record only unclear points, broken logic, and places that need clarification;
3. choose one high-impact pronunciation or chunk issue and repeat it slowly five times;
4. answer an unprepared follow-up question;
5. save the raw and retest recordings.

Speech recognition is a clue, not proof of natural pronunciation. The stronger test is whether a trustworthy listener understands once, whether repetition is needed, and whether you can continue in a new question.

6. Reading: Train the Evidence Chain

Before AI, mark claims, evidence, definitions, examples, and unknowns. Then ask AI to compare your marks and quote the original locations. Do not accept “the article basically says”.

After closing the material answer: What problem is the author solving? Which evidence supports each conclusion? What is a counterexample? What survives if the setting changes to your work? This is how reading transfers into judgment.

7. Writing: Keep the Author’s Hand

Write the first draft yourself. Ask AI for layered feedback on facts and sources, task completion, structure and logic, language errors, tone, and privacy risk. Fix only the three changes that matter most and explain each one in your own words.

Do not accept a whole rewritten paragraph by default. Keep the original, suggestions, final version, and a new similar email. If the final text is polished but you cannot explain the important edits, the ability is not stable yet.

8. Choose Tools Without Confusing Functions

Task	Useful capability	Verify yourself
Guided learning	Study mode, layered questions, quizzes	Does it let you answer first? Are explanations sourced?
Long-running context	Project spaces and permitted files	Permissions, retention, memory scope, export
Learning from sources	File questions, NotebookLM	Original page, rights, privacy, material boundaries
Online research	Citation-enabled search	Open the primary page and check the claim
Writing feedback	Language models and writing tools	Keep the draft and understand each change
Speaking practice	Voice conversations	Recognition is not natural pronunciation; features change

This is not a ranking. Check upload permission, exportability, reviewability, and total cost first. Store goals, samples, errors, and next actions in Learning State or AI Learning Log. Platform memory is only a convenience layer.

9. Feedback and Retesting

```
Restate the task and acceptance criteria. Let me attempt it first.
Separate feedback into task completion, comprehensibility, accuracy, organisation/fluen
Choose only the one to three issues in each category that most affect the result, cite
Give one minimal hint and one parallel task. Do not complete the final answer.
```

On day 30 and week 12, retest with the same topic, similar time, and the same restrictions. Compare raw samples, not only AI-edited products. Progress means less prompting, fewer repeated errors, faster real-task completion, and transfer to a new setting.

After each retest, write at least one result and the next variable into the 90-Day Cycle Map instead of leaving practice inside the chat window.

For the full change before and after AI and after transfer, use the Evidence Chain Template to keep the four time points together. The cycle map schedules the work; the evidence chain explains the result.

10. Seven Days, Thirty Days, Twelve Weeks

Seven days: one complete loop

1 save at least one baseline sample;

1 complete three sessions with the task card;

1 keep raw output, feedback, and one parallel task each time;

1 record one error that most affects communication.

Thirty days: an error library

1 complete at least four similar real tasks;

1 classify vocabulary, listening, syntax, organisation, pronunciation, and transfer errors;

1 compare first attempts and retests rather than treating rewriting as growth;

1 remove tool steps that do not improve the result.

Twelve weeks: a real English delivery

1 complete a meeting, presentation, email, document, or cross-cultural collaboration task;

1 keep recording, transcript, feedback, revision, and retest;

1 ask a real audience whether the message was understood and the next step was clear;

1 write the result back into the English Diagnostic.

Privacy, Copyright, and Official Sources

Do not upload customer, colleague, student, child, medical, identity, or unpublished contract data to an unapproved tool. Public comments and pages can still contain personal data; consider permission, minimum necessary scope, and retention. Use copyrighted material only within your rights and preserve source and licence records.

1 OpenAI: Study Mode; Projects in ChatGPT

1 Google: Learning tools in Gemini; Quizzes and flashcards; Gemini Live

1 Anthropic: What are projects?

1 Google: NotebookLM

1 Perplexity: Help Center

1 DeepL: DeepL Write

These pages document product functions, not rankings or outcome guarantees. Last checked: 24 August 2026; verify features, regions, and plans again before use.

Closing: After the Tool Leaves

AI can quickly produce fluent sentences, patient explanations, and apparently complete answers. English ability does not live in the chat window. It lives in what remains after the tool closes: whether you can still hear the important meaning, explain it in your own words, and continue thinking when another person asks a question.

Let AI expose a blind spot, generate practice, and offer feedback, then arrange for it to leave. Each departure is a small receding tide. The parts held up by the tool become visible, and so do the parts that belong to you. If the meaning disappears with the window, the practice is not complete.

The goal is not to make yourself more like a model. It is to form your own voice inside limited vocabulary, real hesitation, and judgments for which you remain responsible. When the tool leaves and you still know what you mean, AI has amplified your ability instead of occupying it.

Part II: Return to Life

Learning more does not automatically make life easier.

You will still make bad decisions, overestimate a venture, mistake silence for agreement in a relationship, and demand proof from yourself while the body is asking to be heard. Ability widens the range of action, but it also widens the effects of a choice. Without boundaries and responsibility, moving faster may only delay the moment when a cost becomes visible.

After opening the world, we must return ourselves to life. This does not mean turning experience into fate or decorating failure as a turning point. It means asking again: what happened, what did I know at the time, who carried the effect, which responsibility is mine, and which parts still cannot be confirmed?

This part has no curve that rises without interruption. It is more like returning to a room you once left in a hurry, switching on the light, and seeing the unsettled accounts on the table, the people who waited near the door, and the self who kept wanting to escape somewhere farther away.

Questions for This Part

1 How can I tell a personal story without pouring later knowledge back into the past?

1 How can I own what I did wrong without defending violence, crossed boundaries, or another person's choices?

1 Under uncertainty, how can a decision keep a boundary, a review date, and a way back?

1 When work, relationships, or the body lose order, what should stop first, where is help needed, and what can still continue at a smaller scale?

These questions do not have one answer. People have different bodies, money, responsibilities, and safety conditions. This part offers a way to read the past, not a demand that every reader reach the same conclusion.

Reading Path

Path	Chapters	What to notice
Enter the scene	My Story	Facts, costs, absent voices, and unknowns inside one experience
Read the story again	Narrative and Evidence · Echoes	The version then, the explanation now, and an action that can be tested next
Catch yourself first	Recovery	Safety, basic care, support, and minimum order
Choose again	Decision-Making · Relationships	Reversibility, boundaries, impact, and conditions for repair
Face the venture	Entrepreneurship	Users, cash flow, technical debt, team responsibility, and stopping gates

Allow yourself to pause while reading personal material. If it returns you to persistent sleeplessness, panic, hopelessness, or thoughts of harm, leave the page and contact someone you trust and qualified local support. No review is worth injuring yourself again.

What to Carry Forward

At the end of this part, do not leave only “I have let go” or “I should try harder”. Leave one page you can revisit later:

1. Three confirmable facts and the parts still unknown;
2. One responsibility that calls for ownership, apology, stopping, or repair;
3. One boundary protecting the body, a relationship, or money;
4. One minimum action that does not depend on a dramatic reversal.

You can keep it in the Life Practice Toolkit. Store the record privately and remove unnecessary third-party identity, health, financial, and relationship details.

Enter the Work

We cannot return to the past and choose again for the person we were. We can choose how we understand that person today.

Do not rush to extract a lesson. Let the story land at its original weight and listen for its ambition, silence, pain, and the wish that has not entirely disappeared.

My Story: Failure, Recovery, and Starting Again

> Content note: this chapter includes business failure, prolonged insomnia, severe stress, and past suicidal thoughts. It is a personal account, not medical, mental-health, legal, or financial advice. If you are in immediate danger, contact someone you trust and qualified local support first. If reading becomes distressing, pause and ask someone trustworthy to stay with you.

Narrative Boundary

This is a memory written from my position, not a shared version from everyone involved. Partners, colleagues, and friends are anonymised or described generally; details about the child and other third parties are kept only when needed to understand the event. Dates, amounts, and physical experiences come from my records and memory and may contain error. Emotional interpretation is not a factual judgment about another person. Photographs and stories involving others remain only with necessary permission and respect for deletion requests.

If you want to treat this memory as learning material, read Narrative and Evidence: Do Not Turn Experience into Fate first, then return to ask which parts are facts, which are my interpretations, and which conclusions must remain open.

What Failure Cost Me

Hi, I'm Li Pu. This is the story of one particularly absurd chapter of my life in the internet industry.

On April 1, 2017, I joined a tech company in Nanjing as a regular front-end developer. We were building software for lawyers and law firms. The first version had been outsourced. The code had no comments, no project management, and no real structure. To make things worse, there was no product manager. Most product ideas came directly from the boss's intuition.

In my first month there, the timeline module I was responsible for was revised more than twenty times. That level of churn was exhausting.

Still, a month later, the first version finally went into testing and roughly matched what the boss wanted. After that, I led a front-end rewrite based on Vue. We spent more than half a year rebuilding it and eventually shipped. Sales started, and we thought the product would at least make some noise in the industry. It did not. For a long time, we could not close a single deal.

Office environment

As the company struggled, salaries did not grow with time. A lot of people left. Watching old coworkers leave one after another, often with deep resentment toward the company, felt terrible.

From the beginning, I truly believed in the product. Even as the team turned over again and again, and even though my pay did not increase at all in those early years, I chose to stay.

Eventually, I became one of only two people who stayed throughout the whole journey. I went from an ordinary employee to department leader, then general manager, and step by step toward becoming a partner.

That was how the absurd story really began.

To devote myself fully to work, there was one part of life I cannot leave out: love.

Love

I was lucky enough to meet someone I truly loved at the right age. Her name was Ruohan (a pseudonym). In this guide, then called *English-level-up-tips*, I once used Gu Cheng's words to describe how I felt when I first met her:

> The grass is bearing its seeds.
> The wind is shaking its leaves.
> We stand together, saying nothing, and that is already beautiful.

On August 19, 2017, I went with her to Shanghai for something deeply significant. We took many photos on the Bund that day. Even now, whenever I see those photos, I still feel like crying. To this day, if they appear on my phone, I quickly scroll past them on purpose. I still do not have the courage to relive that pain.

That night was beautiful, but the air was heavy with pressure. Looking at the rows of bank buildings on the Bund and enjoying the night breeze, we both tried hard not to let the other person feel our emotions sinking, because we both knew that something was happening and there was nothing we could do about it.

At one point, while I was talking with great confidence about our bright future, she suddenly cried. Not loudly. Silently. I only realized it after she had been crying for a while. She seemed to understand that the future I was describing might not really have a place for her. She turned away from me, and in that moment I saw her vulnerability.

That was also the moment I realised I truly loved her, and began to understand that love is not designing happiness for another person. It is choosing to face uncertainty together.

If Love Has an Echo

Later, we got married and had a lovely son.

Later, in order to expand my business world, I also tried hot spring resorts and private club projects. I lost heavily there too, but that is another story.

Some of the ventures I tried

Resort project

Food Business

One of my relatives opened a Huainan beef soup shop in Nanjing and did very well. Later my cousin opened a second one, and business was extremely good. After studying the category a bit, I opened one myself, and it performed far better than I had expected.

Then I started handling the design, renovation, and branding choices myself, and gradually expanded the product range. I opened a second store, then a third.

The workstation I built for myself

To make the products look better on food delivery platforms, I taught myself photography and Photoshop and created a full set of product images by hand.

Food product photo

Those small food businesses were genuinely exhausting, but the cash flow was strong. Although those stores gradually shut down during the pandemic years, they made me a decent amount of money before that. That money later became part of the capital that allowed me to become a partner in the software company. During that period, I also bought my Dream Car.

Running the Company

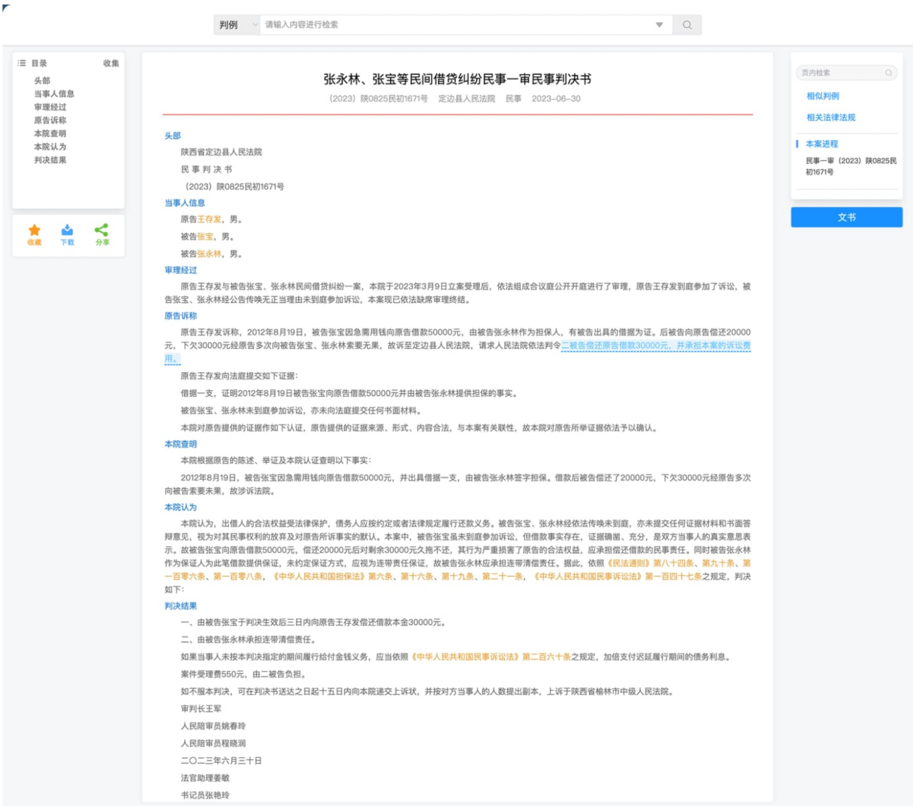
Once the company's income and expenses were roughly balanced, we moved into a bigger office. Standing in front of an unfinished display wall, I imagined a very good future.

New office

To create a better working environment, I hired more young staff, improved employee benefits step by step, and organized dinners and hangouts every so often.

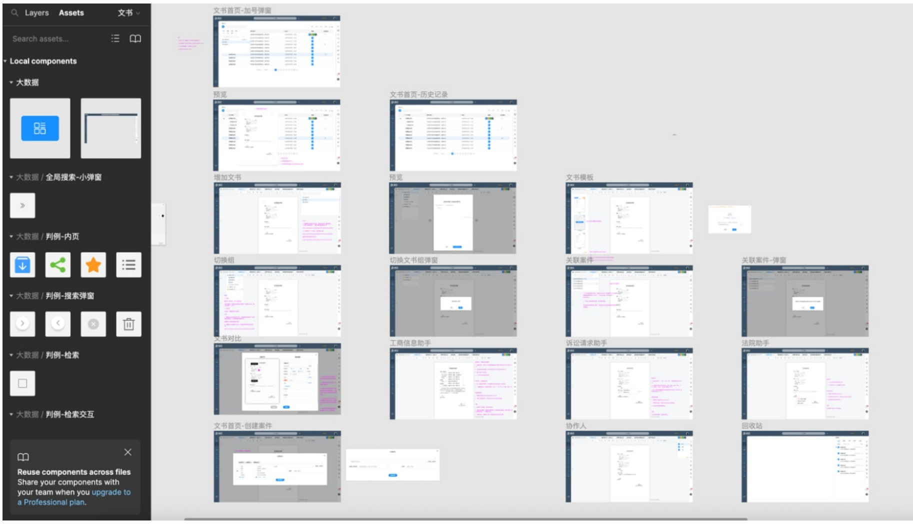
The photo above is a precious picture of me with our front-end leader, Nas.

But the good period did not last long. Starting in early 2022, software sales fell off a cliff, and we could not find a solution. I had never been truly satisfied with the product. It was huge, bloated, and full of bugs. Frankly speaking, it was a mess. Customers said there was a bug every three steps and called it garbage. If the price had not been so low, some of them might have sued us.



Product page

To solve some core problems, I brought in my high school deskmate, who was then doing container security at ByteDance. He had always been someone special in my mind. After he joined us, he discovered some extremely serious issues.



Product design draft

First, the project structure was outdated, and many parts had serious performance and security problems. Second, some of the "AI" features were not generated through any actual model training at all. They were basically powered by Elasticsearch search behavior. We had spent years talking about big data, but in reality a lot of it was just preset outputs wrapped around business requirements.

That meant what we had been treating as core assets were, in truth, mostly junk. Meanwhile, we had spent most of our time on multi-platform adaptation, UI polish, and stuffing the product with miscellaneous features.

We kept iterating on UI and experience details, but the real problem was that there was no usable dataset. The so-called big data extraction had no meaningful training samples behind it, which meant nothing real could be trained.

In other words, the team that had been "doing big data" for years had never even built the dataset properly.

When I realized how serious that was, I felt a chill down my back.

At that stage, we were trapped. Continuing to iterate on the old foundation meant staying in a total garbage pile of code that was almost impossible to move. Rebuilding it would require far more money than the company still had.

One night I stayed late in the office discussing this with the other two partners. Mr. Gong, our largest shareholder, was close to breaking and kept asking whether the project could still be done.

I understood his emotions. He had already put more than ten million RMB into the company, all of it his own money. Not a single cent came from outside investors. I had also put in several million myself. It is hard to describe how everyone felt at that point.

Later, he slammed his forty-page employee management handbook onto the meeting table like a madman. The sound was so loud it felt like the office might collapse. In truth, some things had already become impossible to continue. We were just still holding onto illusions.

As the company's losses got worse, we could no longer pay salaries properly. We tried everything to find money, including borrowing. Under extreme pressure, Mr. Gong started tightening attendance rules, cutting benefits, pushing meaningless overtime, and even monitoring employees' work. Weekly reports became daily reports, then hourly reports. The team was being disgusted by one new control tactic after another.

I knew the team breaking apart was only a matter of time. I strongly opposed these performative management methods, but one sentence shut me down:

> “I put in the most money. I make the decisions.”

By September, the atmosphere was so bad that nobody wanted to come to work anymore. Then people resigned together, and that was the end of the game.

The company collapsed. Leave aside the money for a moment. I had given five or six years of my life to it. How could I forget all those days and nights spent rushing projects? On top of that, I had dragged my deskmate into this mess. If he had stayed at ByteDance, maybe he would have had a much better future.

I used to imagine all of us celebrating success together one day, drinking and laughing. Instead, everything went the other way.

After the company shut down, I did not even have the courage to apologize to him. I felt awful inside, and I had no way to explain it to anyone. When I think about all those teammates who fought alongside me, I remember the times we cheered over difficult breakthroughs, the nights we were so excited we could not sleep, the promises I made, and the grand words I spoke in meetings.

I still feel deeply guilty.

To them, I just want to say:

> I’m so sorry.

Even though they may never see this.

When My Body Broke Down

Starting in June, because of severe conflicts with Mr. Gong over how the company should be managed, and because my own management decisions were being overridden harshly, my body began to react.

My stomach started feeling bad. Later I developed erosive gastritis that never really healed. Then came insomnia. Then the stomach problems got worse. Then I got COVID. After that, it felt like every possible illness was landing on me at once. My vision became blurry. I lost my appetite. Long-term insomnia plus wandering pain throughout my body made me feel like I was falling apart.

One night, I suddenly told Ruohan that I thought I might not make it. Then I started talking nonsense and even began trying to explain what should happen after I died. She cried loudly enough to wake our sleeping child. I still remember the two of them crying for a long time, impossible to calm down.

In the following months, I went from one hospital in Nanjing to another. Waiting in lines, doing scans, MRIs, blood tests. I felt like a shell of myself. My whole world was wrapped in a layer of black fog.

The tests found a few minor problems, but doctors kept telling me with certainty that I was basically fine. I could not believe them. I was convinced that something serious had not been found yet. So every day became the same cycle: register, wait, get checked, wait for results, ask another doctor, rule out one disease, then look for the next one. I kept searching websites for symptoms like mine, telling myself I was okay and then doubting myself again.

Years of programming had also left me with persistent lower-back problems. That experience reminded me that the body is not an unlimited asset. Recurring symptoms deserve professional assessment and earlier care in daily work.

When people get desperate, they try everything. During that period, I visited famous traditional Chinese doctors, and my family even took me to pray and ask folk spiritual healers for help.

I knew this was not a real solution, but I still could not sleep night after night. I had no energy left at all.

The losses from our group alone were more than 20 million RMB. Once the resort and club projects were included, the pressure was enormous. At the hardest point, I even considered selling Ruohan’s family home. I never borrowed a single cent from relatives. I simply could not bring myself to ask.

I know that once certain words are spoken, relationships can change. Before borrowing money, be honest about repayment ability, relationship cost, and an exit plan; do not transfer an impossible burden to someone else.

I even considered selling the car I had bought just over a year earlier, but my family stopped me. The house was already gone. If I sold the car too, it would directly affect daily life, especially with a child going to school, and it would not even recover that much money anyway.

My former Dream Car

After Going Back Home

At the end of March 2023, I transferred away my last small food business. By the end of June, I packed everything up and returned to my hometown.

Leaving a city I had lived in for more than ten years, with my three-year-old son beside me, was painful in a quiet way.

As my physical discomfort kept getting worse, I became quieter and quieter. First I stopped wanting to go outside. Then I stopped wanting to talk. Eventually I did not even want to eat.

If my mom had not messaged me every day telling me to come eat, I probably would have skipped meals entirely.

I was nearly thirty, yet I still needed my mother to remind me to eat. It embarrassed me, but it also forced me to admit that I needed help.

I hated that version of myself too. But I felt powerless, like I was trapped in the center of a whirlpool. No matter how hard I struggled, I could not climb out.

Doing nothing for a long time is also unbearable. One day I reassembled my desktop computer and started playing *League of Legends*. I played day and night, until even I felt bored by it. But since I could not sleep anyway, I just let myself keep spiraling.

A Life That Felt Hopeless

I lost control of my gaming. My days and nights flipped upside down, and I earned nothing. The contrast with my old modest but decent life was brutal.

When you are living off money from selling a house, sharing daily life with parents, and showing no sign of moving forward, disappointment naturally builds. She also carried great pressure and asked how long this life would continue.

I shouted back at her, “What do you want me to do?”

The truth is, I really was lost. I had no idea what to do.

The software company was gone, and with it, my life as a programmer seemed to end too. I silently left many chat groups, closed GitHub, muted some contacts, and stopped visiting websites I used to browse every single day.

During the startup years, I even fell out with my best friend, Lele, over money. So many years of friendship collapsed because of my stubbornness. We barely spoke after that. I lost a lot.

More than once, I asked myself:

> Why did I fight so hard to keep this going?

Would things have ended differently if I had made other choices? If I had worked even harder at certain turning points, would it have helped? If I had started earlier or later, would it have gone differently? If only I had...

Looking back, building industry software really cannot be done through passion and a few seemingly clever ideas alone. Every founder believes he understands the user, believes his product solves a real pain point, and believes growth will eventually explode.

But success depends on many things outside your control: timing, conditions, luck.

For example, we spent huge effort building an “intelligent Q&A bot.” If we had done that after ChatGPT arrived, it would have been an entirely different story. But in real life, you do not get to wait for a world-changing product to arrive exactly when your own company needs it.

Reflection

If you ask me what it feels like to watch a company fail after building it with that much money and effort, I can only say this:

Falling hard while you are still young is not necessarily the worst thing. It may be only one episode in life.

That is the tough version of the answer. The honest version is simpler: it hurt deeply.

I still clearly remember my son’s birthday. Early that morning, Ruohan said, “Let’s have hotpot tonight.” I hesitated for a long time and finally said, “There’s no need. Let’s just buy a small cake and celebrate at home.”

That answer was obviously not what she expected. She went quiet and tried hard to hide her disappointment. At some point, even going out for a real meal had become something I treated as a luxury. And this was not just any day. It was supposed to be worth celebrating. I had never imagined I would reach that point.

I had never imagined I would end up in such a state. That kind of sadness is probably understood only by people who have truly fallen low.

That night we still went to Haidilao, but we barely ordered anything. When the staff sang the birthday song and got to the line about “saying goodbye to all your troubles,” I completely broke down inside.

If only it were that easy.

When family members carry pain because of your decisions, your own suffering does not cancel the guilt. A tiny, ordinary moment can shatter the armour you built for yourself, and sadness and frustration rush back at once.

2026-04-22 Update

A lot of people have asked how I am doing now. I’m still here, and I’m doing well.

One more thing: this article mainly records my conflict with my partner Mr. Gong (a pseudonym) during the company’s final period, so it can make him look like a single opposing figure. That is my perspective, not a complete judgment of him; he has many admirable qualities. Public writing should leave other people room not to be defined entirely by my version.

2026-06-16 Update

On June 16, 2026, as Chairman of China Ciyuan Cloud Computing Co., Ltd., I was invited by Alibaba in Hangzhou to visit and study at Alibaba Cloud's Hangzhou headquarters.

Visiting Alibaba Cloud Hangzhou headquarters

This visit made me more willing to believe that AI should not remain only as a concept or a tool held by a small group. I hope it can enter real industries, land, and ordinary lives only after permission, responsibility, and real-world verification are in place.

Learning about the Qwen large language model

Going forward, I hope to keep exploring practical ways for AI to empower agriculture, forestry, animal husbandry, fisheries, and other parts of the real economy. In particular, I plan to provide free AI training for rural cooperatives, so that more ordinary people can understand AI, use AI, improve production efficiency, and discover new ways to grow their businesses.

Seeking benefits for ordinary people and doing practical work should not be only a slogan. After going through the lowest points of my life, I increasingly believe that turning the ability to stand up again into something useful for others is one of the most grounded reasons to keep moving forward.

Closing: Starting Again Is Not a Triumph

I do not want to write 2026 as a victory over 2022. A visit, a title, and a direction begun again cannot repay the costs of the past or prove that the future has arrived. They show only that I can sit at the table again, face a problem, and let reality answer it.

Starting again is not becoming the person who believed he could solve everything. It is living with another kind of memory: companies can collapse, the body keeps accounts, choices can injure relationships, and a family's silence is not erased by later success. Knowing this, I still want to work, but no longer want to wager everyone's tomorrow on my own certainty.

There is no triumph or complete reconciliation at the end of this story. I am still learning how to carry responsibility, make repairs, and keep new work from repeating old harm. Perhaps beginning again means only seeing the cost earlier, asking for help sooner, and leaving a way back for myself and others when stopping becomes necessary.

Narrative and Evidence: Do Not Turn Experience into Fate

When we look back, it is difficult to see facts alone. We compress years into a sentence: I succeeded because I persisted; I failed because I was afraid; I met someone and my life changed forever. These sentences have force, but they also carry danger. They give disorder a shape while turning chance into necessity, hiding other people's work, and sending today's answer backwards into yesterday.

A good story does not have to lose its literary quality to deserve evidence. The more willing it is to admit time, perspective, and uncertainty, the more likely it is to reach another person. It stops being the author's stamp on life and becomes an invitation: see how events unfolded, which judgments worked under which conditions, which costs cannot be erased, and what we are willing to do more honestly next time.

Quick Overview

1 separate facts known at the time, explanations formed later, and what remains unknown;

1 use timelines and evidence to test causality instead of letting outcomes masquerade as fate;

1 accept responsibility while preserving other people's agency;

1 translate experience into conditional principles rather than universal success advice;

1 turn reflection into a testable next action with a one-page case review and seven-day practice.

1. One Event Has at Least Three Versions

The same event usually has three versions:

Version	Question it answers	Common risk
The version then	What did I see, know, and fear that day?	Limited information turns feeling into fact
The version in hindsight	How does today's self explain the choice?	The outcome creates an illusion of foresight
The public version	What did I keep or remove so others could understand?	Completeness exposes or exaggerates other people

Separate them before writing. Because you know the company eventually failed, do not make every decision in 2019 look “obviously wrong”. Because you later stood up again, do not arrange every action in the low point as a step toward success.

Write three lines first:

```
Facts I could confirm then:
Explanation I hold now:
What I still cannot confirm:
```

These lines do not weaken a story. They give it room to breathe.

2. A Timeline Is Safer Than a Beautiful Cause

People like causal chains: I changed jobs, so my health worsened; the product had no users, so the company failed; someone left, so I learned to grow. Causes sometimes exist, but sequence is not proof of cause, and simultaneous events do not automatically explain one another.

Draw a timeline without conclusions first:

1. What observable action happened on which date?
2. Which conditions already existed?
3. Who was affected, and who had decision authority?
4. Which evidence changed your judgment?
5. Which part still lacks enough information?

Then label each sentence:

1. **Fact**: a date, file, record, direct observation, or sample someone else can check;
1. **Interpretation**: your reading of those facts, open to revision;
1. **Hypothesis**: a judgment you will test in the next action.

“The product had no orders for two years” can be a fact. “We did not understand users” is a hindsight interpretation. “Ten willingness-to-pay interviews before adding features may provide more information next time” is a hypothesis. When all three sit in one paragraph, the reader cannot tell what you actually know.

3. Do Not Punish the Past with Counterfactuals

After failure, “what if” appears automatically: what if I had worked harder, started earlier, chosen another partner, or spent less? Counterfactuals can teach, but they can also become an endless self-trial.

Turn the question into three others:

1. **What information was available then?** Do not send later knowledge backwards;
2. **Which decision could be checked earlier next time?** Turn regret into a gate;
3. **What is the smallest experiment now?** Let action reduce uncertainty instead of imagination enlarging it.

A good review cannot promise that another road would have been better. It leaves an earlier checkpoint: before investing more, what evidence must I see, and where am I willing to stop if it does not arrive?

4. Explain the Context Without Convicting Other People

Personal stories contain people who are absent from the page: partners, parents, co-founders, colleagues, customers, and children. You know your own feelings, but you cannot possess everyone's complete inner life. Writing “she had already…” or “he was just…” makes a story neat while injuring reality.

Try these revisions:

1 “I treated her silence as agreement; now I know that was my interpretation.”

1 “He said this, and it produced this observable result; I cannot confirm his motive for him.”

1 “I accept the impact I caused, but I do not decide how the other person should feel or whether to forgive me.”

This is not an appeal to please everyone. Name responsibility and harm clearly. Just do not use your narrative to remove another person's agency. With identity, children, health, finances, or private conversations, apply data minimisation and permission boundaries first.

5. Turn Experience into Conditional Principles

Experience is easily misread as advice. One person surviving an investment does not make investing safe. One learner improving through a method does not make it universal. A company finding a direction later does not make every early choice correct.

Write principles with conditions:

Overgeneralisation	More useful wording
Persistence creates success	When demand is real, cost is bearable, and feedback continues, persistence may be worth extending
AI improves efficiency	For a bounded task with acceptance criteria, AI may reduce some search or rework time
Failure is the best teacher	Failure yields information only after facts, cost, and the next gate are recorded
Relationships must always be saved	Repair when safety, respect, and mutual willingness exist; leaving ongoing harm can also be responsible

Conditional principles are poor poster slogans but better guides for real decisions.

6. One-page Case Review

For a public profile, a project story, or your own experience, copy the AI Case Review Template, then add two gates:

```
## Narrative boundary
- Is this my observation, another person's words, or my interpretation?
- Who could be identified, and which details must be removed or generalised?
- Did I send today's outcome backwards into the past?

## Next test
- Under what conditions does this principle hold?
- What is the smallest next experiment?
- What evidence would make me stop, downgrade, or rewrite it?
```

Ask a reader who does not know the background to answer three things: what happened, which sentence sounds unproven, and what next action they could actually take. Their retelling exposes a narrative gap better than your own feeling about the draft.

7. Keep One Place Uncertain

Literature does not require every blank to be explained. A story made entirely of certain sentences often reveals not life but an edited advertisement.

Uncertainty can mean:

1 admitting that memory may be wrong;

1 naming a motive you cannot know;

1 preserving a problem that was unresolved then;

1 stating that an experience has not been independently verified;

1 ending with a next action rather than announcing a completed personality.

This is not performed modesty. The unknown is part of the facts. An honest author is not flawless on the page. An honest author tells the reader what can be trusted and where judgment must remain open.

8. Seven-day Narrative Review

1 **Day 1:** choose one experience and write ten observable facts without adjectives;

1 **Day 2:** label every sentence fact, interpretation, or hypothesis;

1 **Day 3:** draw the timeline and add what you did not know then;

1 **Day 4:** find one sentence that assigns another person's motive and rewrite it as your observation;

1 **Day 5:** turn one absolute principle into a conditional one;

1 **Day 6:** ask someone without the background to retell the point and record misunderstandings;

1 **Day 7:** use the Weekly Review Template to choose what to keep, delete, and test next.

After seven days, you do not need a more dramatic essay. You should know what you truly know, which costs you accept, which sentences need to be withdrawn, and how action will answer the question next time.

9. Stage Standard

A reliable narrative review usually lets a reader:

1 retell the event without guessing what belief they are being asked to accept;

1 distinguish fact, feeling, interpretation, and hypothesis;

1 see that privacy, permission, and other people's agency were not sacrificed for completeness;

1 understand the conditions and limits of the transferable principle;

1 identify one executable, stoppable, reviewable next step.

If these conditions are not met, do not rush to publish “my method”. Gather more samples, or label the piece clearly as a personal record.

For practice, treat My Story: Failure, Recovery, and Starting Again as a personal sample still open to revision, use Echoes: Do Not Romanticise Avoidance to inspect how an old explanation speaks through the present, then return to Writing: From Draft to Verifiable Revision and let a real reader's retelling change the narrative.

Closing: Let the Story Return to Life

We need stories to recognise ourselves across long days. But a story should not lock a life inside one conclusion. It may contain a turn without pretending the turn was written into the opening; it may carry responsibility without turning everyone else into a supporting character; it may offer direction while allowing new evidence to revise it.

The best result of looking back is not proving that you were right. It is gaining a gentler, more accurate ability: I know where I came from, and I know which parts still require learning. To turn the next action in a narrative into a comparable sample, continue to Evidence: How Change Becomes Visible and write baseline, delayed retention, and transfer back into life.

Echoes: Do Not Romanticise Avoidance

When I was young, I liked turning a life into one decisive sentence.

Good grades meant I was clever. Falling grades meant my teachers did not understand me. Skipping class was resistance to rigid rules. Enduring pain proved strength. Finding a job later seemed to confirm that every earlier act of defiance had been leading somewhere right.

Those sentences protect pride well at twenty. They are sharp and complete; they leave almost no opening. Walk a little farther, however, and other sounds return: the body that was ignored, the people who cleaned up after me, the luck left unnamed, and the consequences I could have carried sooner.

This chapter is neither a trial of my younger self nor an attempt to turn old wounds into inspiration. I want to reopen several memories and separate four things: **what happened, how I explained it then, what I own now, and what I am willing to do differently next time.**

> Content note: this chapter refers to school violence, long-term insomnia, and past suicidal thoughts. These are personal experiences, not medical advice. Violence is not justified by a victim's character or behaviour. If you are facing persistent sleeplessness, hopelessness, thoughts of harm, or a threat to your safety, contact someone you trust and seek qualified local medical, mental-health, or emergency support first.

1. I Treated Intelligence as a Free Pass

In middle school, I ranked near the top of my year. I also developed a dangerous habit: if I could find an answer faster, I thought I had earned the right to mock someone else's mistake. I dismissed lessons, challenged teachers, and mistook refusal to cooperate for independence.

I was later subjected to violence at school. The school dealt with one teacher involved; another apologised after losing control. For a long time, whenever I told this story, I rushed to add, “Most of the problem was mine.” Blaming myself first seemed like proof that I was honest, fair, and somehow more mature than the injury.

Now I am willing to hold two truths together: **violence is not education, and I should not have been hurt; arrogance and humiliation are not independence, and that part is mine to change.** The first protects the facts. The second protects the possibility of growth.

Neither cancels the other.

When responsibility and harm are mixed together, a story tends to move toward one of two extremes. I become the permanently innocent hero, or I demonstrate my capacity for reflection by finishing the defence of the person who crossed a boundary. The harder and more accurate account allows both judgments to stand: someone crossed a line, and I still needed to change how I treated people.

Afterward, I lost interest in mathematics and tore up my competition certificates. The paper made almost no sound. The consequences lasted much longer. I believed I was rejecting an evaluation system I disliked; I was also throwing away part of an ability that might have continued to grow.

2. The Body Keeps Unsettled Costs

In high school, I developed insomnia.

I could not sleep at night and had no energy in class. Because I could not learn during the day, I feared the next night and the next failure, which made sleep even harder. My homeroom teacher saw falling grades. The grade director saw lateness. My father saw a ranking. I saw a person who had used achievement to recognise himself losing the only proof he knew.

My seat was moved to the front row. Later, my bed was moved into a hospital. I spent two years receiving treatment for insomnia. At the worst point I had suicidal thoughts. On many nights I cried alone in a bathroom and wanted only to sleep.

Looking back, I no longer summarise this as “willpower defeated insomnia”. Recovery is rarely that tidy, and memory cannot establish medical causation. Professional assessment, time, changes in environment, family care, and the activities I found may all have played a part.

What I can confirm is that I began practising calligraphy with my right hand. I had written with my left hand before. Changing hands gave the long nights one small, slow activity that did not judge my whole life at once. A bad horizontal stroke could be written again. Ten minutes still left a sheet of paper behind.

Later I won calligraphy competitions, received high marks for Chinese essays, and gradually slept better. Calligraphy was not treatment, and the story does not prove that a hobby cures illness. It was a handrail in that season: when I could not solve an entire life, it gave me one bounded act to hold.

A small act in a low season does not have to reverse fate. Sometimes its work is simply to help a person finish today and leave a little usable strength for tomorrow.

3. I Mistook Avoidance for Freedom

At university, an English teacher asked me to spell words because I had forgotten my textbook. I got every word right and proudly continued with a short conversation in English. After that, she paid close attention to my attendance.

I interpreted the attention as persecution and called skipping class resistance. Eventually other teachers in the department began checking whether I was present. By the second semester of junior year, I had failed nineteen courses. The university planned to move me back a year, and graduation was close to impossible.

The same English teacher I believed was “against me” spoke with my homeroom teacher, department head, and academic office. She argued that I should remain in my year. The condition was clear: retake nineteen courses, or leave without a degree.

During senior year I carried a heavy bag between classrooms and the library. At the end, I faced twenty-six examinations. Each evening I hated her again in my head, as if resentment preserved the last respectable part of my defiance.

When I passed all nineteen retakes, I nearly cried. Only later did I understand what had changed me. It was not proof that I had always been gifted. Someone preserved one opportunity for me without taking the examinations in my place.

Help does not erase consequence. Strictness is not automatically malice. A person can be grateful for having been held up and still admit the burden he placed on others.

The sentence I now leave with those university years is this: **do not romanticise avoidance.** Escaping a class, a conversation, or a deadline briefly feels like taking back control. But when the cost is paid by your future self and the people around you, it is not freedom. The invoice has simply not arrived.

4. One Success Cannot Decide for Someone Else

After graduation, I spent four months and RMB 20,000 on web front-end training. Two weeks after it ended, I received an offer from Meituan and was among the first in the class to find work.

The old article interrupted itself here with a joke: “They even gave me an electric bike, a helmet, and a coat. Gotta go, another order just came in.” The joke preserves my voice at the time, but it also exposes something I learned later. A personal result can easily become an advertisement for a course, even when it may have emerged from existing ability, a hiring window, city-level opportunity, practice, and luck acting together.

I therefore cannot use my outcome to claim that bootcamps always work. Nor can I claim that abundant public material makes all paid learning worthless. What a course may genuinely provide is structure, practice, feedback, peers, and accountability, not secret knowledge.

Before paying, check at least five things:

1. What real work must be completed, beyond watching a number of videos?
2. Who gives specific feedback on your errors, and how often?
3. How are employment outcomes counted, and does the denominator include people who did not find work or changed fields?
4. Where are the refund, loan, instalment, default, and employment terms written?
5. If the ideal job does not appear, is the cost still within what you can carry?

A success story can show one possibility. It cannot provide a probability or carry another person's debt and time.

5. Five Minutes and a Device Are Not Magic

I also wrote about whether five minutes a day could teach English and whether a Kindle or iPad was worth buying. They seem like separate topics, but both contain the same wish: to find a tool that makes change easier without requiring us to face repetition, duration, and uncertainty.

Five minutes has real value. It can review chunks, shadow a recording, produce three sentences, or open the file you avoided yesterday. But five minutes is best at starting and maintaining contact. By itself, it rarely carries deep understanding, complete output, feedback, and revision.

A device is similar. Its value is not settled by brand, price, or the excitement of ownership. It is settled by whether it repeatedly reduces friction in a real task: whether the text is comfortable, material is searchable, annotation returns to writing, and you still choose to open it a week later.

A useful boundary looks like this:

Tool or promise	What it may help	What it cannot replace
Five minutes a day	Starting, review, continued contact	Deep practice, feedback, complete delivery
A course	Structure, material, feedback, peers	Interest, practice, judgment, employment outcomes
A device	Lowering friction in reading or making	Choosing content, returning, producing work
AI	Decomposition, explanation, practice, revision support	Source checks, privacy boundaries, final responsibility

A tool belongs between an action and a result. Once it becomes proof of identity, it easily becomes another form of delay. “I bought it”, “I enrolled”, and “I have done this for five days” are not yet the same as “I can do it”.

6. What I Actually Want to Keep

I once used these stories as evidence for talent, effort, and interest. Reading them now, I would rather keep four less attractive but more dependable conclusions.

Being Hurt Is Not Failure, and Reflection Is Not Self-conviction

Admitting what I did wrong does not require denying that someone else crossed a boundary. Responsibility is not a search for one person who deserves all the pain. It is a way to clarify the boundary and change the next action.

Resistance Is Not Freedom

Freedom includes consequence: knowing what you refuse and who will pay after the refusal. Resistance that enjoys the posture but does not carry the cost eventually becomes another form of passivity.

Persistence Does Not Prove Direction

Effort approaches a goal only when it enters feedback, boundaries, and review. Adding more without evidence can merely increase the sunk cost.

Receiving Help Is Not Weakness

A teacher preserving one opportunity, a parent reminding someone to eat, or a professional providing an assessment can all become conditions for standing again. Accepting help does not cancel agency. It gives agency somewhere to return.

7. Give an Old Story a New Reading

If you also carry a story you repeat, read Narrative and Evidence, then place the story into four columns. Do not search for the perfect line yet. Let facts and responsibility return to their own places.

Observable fact	My explanation then	Responsibility I own now	Next observable act
Dated, recorded, or checkable behaviour	How I understood myself and others	Apologise, stop, repair, ask for help, set a boundary	One conversation, retest, or stopping condition

Then ask four questions:

1. Have I poured later knowledge back into the past?
2. Have I defended a violation merely to prove that I can reflect?
3. Have I turned one fortunate result into a method for everyone?
4. Which act can this story change today, beyond changing how I feel?

If the memory returns you to persistent sleeplessness, panic, hopelessness, or danger, stop the exercise. Go first to Recovery: Catch Yourself Before You Push Forward, a trusted person, and qualified professional support. No review is worth injuring yourself again.

Closing: Let the Past Stop Speaking for Today

I once believed growth meant finding a cleverer explanation and arranging every failure as foreshadowing for the present. Now I am more willing to admit that some things were simply injuries, some were luck, and some costs do not disappear because I later stood again.

The past does not have to remain at the centre of the courtroom. We can return facts to facts, injury to care, error to responsibility, luck to chance, and the next step to today.

I do not need to prove that my younger self was always right. Nor do I need lifelong shame to prove that he was once wrong. I need only hear the echo when it returns and make one choice that is not entirely the same.

Perhaps that is the real purpose of looking back: not to rewrite the opening, but to stop an old story from writing the ending for us.

Recovery: Catch Yourself Before You Push Forward

> Content note: this chapter mentions insomnia, prolonged stress, broken relationships, and past suicidal thoughts. It is not medical, mental-health, legal, or financial advice. If you are in immediate danger, contact someone you trust and qualified local support first.

I used to imagine "starting again" as something loud. After the company failed, I thought the next project, product, or income would restore meaning.

I learned that the first task in a low season is usually not acceleration. It is stopping the fall.

Recovery is not empty space edited out of a success story, and it is not a reward you earn after completing a goal. It is basic infrastructure: restoring rhythm to the body, keeping emotion from steering alone, returning relationships to honest boundaries, and shrinking work to a weight you can carry.

Quick Overview

1. confirm safety before discussing efficiency or the future;
1. treat the body as part of life, not as a tool for completing goals;
1. separate shame into facts, interpretations, and responsibility;
1. ask for specific help, keep boundaries clear, and apologise without demanding forgiveness;
1. use seven days to restore minimum order, then use the 90-Day Action Plan to rebuild a longer rhythm.

1. Confirm Safety First

Long insomnia, hopelessness, pain, or debt can narrow judgment. The first task is not to prove strength, but to move irreversible risks out of reach.

Start with four small actions:

1. Tell someone trustworthy: "My state is not safe right now. I need help handling it."
2. Pause high-risk decisions such as large borrowing, impulsive resignation, dangerous driving, total isolation, or plans to hurt yourself;

3 Give medication, weapons, or other objects that could cause harm to a trusted person for safekeeping;

4 Contact local emergency services, a hospital, a crisis service, or another qualified professional.

If you already have a specific plan to harm yourself or someone else, do not stay alone and do not rely on the next chat to solve it. Contact a person nearby and local emergency support now.

Asking for help is not losing control. It is moving control into a more reliable support network when you need it most.

2. Restore the Body Without Punishment

The body often speaks before language does: appetite disappears, sleep breaks apart, vision changes, the heart races, and pain moves around. Do not dismiss these signals as "just overthinking", and do not diagnose yourself from similar symptoms online.

A steadier order is:

1 **medical care**: let qualified professionals assess persistent or recurring symptoms;

1 **sleep**: begin with a stable wake time; do not grade your character by one bad night;

1 **food**: start with simple food you can tolerate; regularity matters more than perfection;

1 **movement**: take a short walk and keep the amount below the level that makes tomorrow worse;

1 **records**: note time, symptoms, triggers, and what you tried before an appointment.

Restoring the body does not mean designing a stricter discipline system. You do not need to charge interest on exhaustion.

3. Turn Shame Back into Facts

After failure, we compress many facts into one verdict: I am useless, I ruined everything, I do not deserve another beginning. It sounds honest, but it gives you nothing workable.

Write three columns:

Fact	My interpretation	Responsibility I accept
The project did not gain recurring orders	I treated feature count as user value	Test willingness to pay and delivery cost earlier

Fact	My interpretation	Responsibility I accept
I slept badly for several weeks	I feared that stopping meant losing everything	Seek professional assessment and tell my family the truth
A relationship ended	I interpreted loss as proof I would never be loved	Respect the boundary and study my own patterns

Facts create boundaries. Interpretations reveal bias. Responsibility makes the next step specific. You need all three.

4. Relationships Need Apology and Boundaries

People in a low season often feel guilt and loneliness at the same time. You may want to pull everyone back, explain every decision, and make them understand your pain. They still have the right not to accept the explanation or to step away.

A responsible apology includes at least four things:

1. Say what happened without hiding behind “if you felt hurt”;
2. acknowledge the impact you caused without blaming everything on circumstances;
3. say how you will correct the pattern, rather than only describing your pain;
4. do not make the other person’s forgiveness a condition of your recovery.

An apology is not a long letter that forces a reply. A short, specific message that allows distance is often more respectful.

You also need boundaries: no humiliation, no endless midnight arguments, and no responsibility for every cost simply because you made mistakes. Recovery is not handing yourself back to the loudest judge.

5. Return Work to a Carryable Scale

For many people, work is both income and dignity. During recovery, it should not become another instrument of punishment.

Shrink the task to one saved result:

1 organise one page instead of “replanning my career”;

1 fix one test instead of “rewriting the entire system”;

1 write three sentences instead of “producing my defining work”;

1 answer one important email instead of “solving every relationship”;

1 walk for ten minutes instead of “returning to my old self immediately”.

Leave evidence: a file, recording, commit, feedback note, or next step. Evidence is not performance for other people. It lets you see what you have done when your mood sinks again.

6. Ask for Specific Help

“I am suffering” is true, but it may not tell another person how to come closer. Turn the request into an action:

1 “Please eat with me tonight. You do not need to give advice.”

1 “Please come with me to the appointment and help me record the instructions.”

1 “Please review this contract. I need professional advice.”

1 “Please remind me twice this week to go outside.”

1 “I cannot take this project right now. Please help me state the delivery boundary clearly.”

Specific requests give people a way to help and let you choose the form of support. Family, friends, and professionals have different roles; none fully replaces the others.

7. Seven Days of Minimum Order

This is not a challenge or a perfect streak. Do one main thing each day and keep everything else at a minimum.

Day	Main task	Evidence
1	Write safety contacts, symptoms, and high-risk decisions to pause	One-page safety list
2	Eat one regular meal and confirm professional support	Appointment record
3	Walk for 10–20 minutes and observe your body	Time and notes
4	Turn one debt into facts, impact, and responsibility	Apology draft
5	Complete one 15-minute work slice	File or commit
6	Have one conversation with no demand to solve everything	Three honest feelings
7	Review the week and choose what to keep, stop, and ask for	Three next arrangements

If a day is impossible, make the task smaller. Do not repay missed work by staying up late. Recovery is about boundaries, not another source of failure.

Copy the Recovery Reset in the Life Practice Toolkit to keep safety items, people you can contact, and today’s smallest task on one private page. Use the Weekly Review to decide what needs changing.

8. When Willpower Is Not Enough

If insomnia, low mood, panic, pain, appetite changes, inability to work, or thoughts of harm keep returning, seek medical or mental-health assessment early. For debt, contracts, labour disputes, or company responsibility, consult qualified legal, financial, or industry professionals.

Do not label yourself from one online test, and do not dismiss persistent suffering because one appointment found no major problem. Professional support helps separate issues, reduce risk, and plan the next step. It does not decide whether you are allowed to hurt.

9. Signs of a Recovery Phase

Recovery does not mean “I am completely well”. More useful signs are:

1 I can name the most important thing today;

1 I can contact someone instead of disappearing completely;

1 I notice physical and emotional alarms and take an appropriate action;

1 I can complete one small task and still allow myself to stop;

1 I can separate facts, interpretations, and responsibility;

1 I can plan the next week without using the plan to punish myself.

These changes are quiet, but they mean the steering wheel is returning to your hands. When minimum order is stable, enter the 90-Day Action Plan and put the recovered energy into one real ability and one deliverable.

Closing: Catch Yourself, Then Move

I no longer see a low season as a page that must be deleted quickly. It records what I believed, what I ignored, and who sat beside me when I had no strength.

A person begins again not because they become indestructible, but because they learn to acknowledge their weight and let others carry part of it when necessary.

Catch yourself first. Then take the next step.

Decision-Making: Choosing Under Uncertainty

Life rarely asks us to decide when the information is complete. More often a bill is due, an opportunity lasts three days, the body sends an unclear signal, a relationship needs an answer, and only part of the facts is in your hands.

I once mistook the courage to bet everything for bravery, and past investment for a reason to continue. I learned that a mature choice does not remove uncertainty. It names the cost you are willing to carry and leaves room for the next correction.

A choice is not a one-time proof of who you are. It is closer to a temporary contract: make a decision under certain facts and assumptions, then agree on when to return and check it.

When a decision grows out of a complicated experience, use Narrative and Evidence: Do Not Turn Experience into Fate to separate timeline, facts, and hindsight before returning here to map options and costs.

Quick Overview

1 separate facts, interpretations, and wishes;

1 judge reversibility before deciding how quickly and how much evidence you need;

1 use a small experiment instead of waiting to understand everything;

1 put money, health, relationships, and responsibility on the same cost sheet;

1 leave a decision record so your future self can review it instead of judging the past only by its result.

Let Confidence Set the Action Size

Do not treat “I feel confident” as one number. Separate at least three things: how reliable the facts are, whether the key assumption has been tested, and how easy the choice is to reverse. Different combinations deserve different action sizes.

Fact confidence	Assumption confidence	Reversibility	More suitable next step
High	Low	High	Run a small experiment and buy information quickly

Fact confidence	Assumption confidence	Reversibility	More suitable next step
High	Low	Low	Add cooling-off time, seek relevant professional advice, and avoid expanding the commitment
Low	High	High	Add sources or samples instead of treating intuition as fact
Low	Low	Low	Pause high-risk action and protect safety, cash, and relationship boundaries

This is not a calculator or a decision score. It is a reminder: the more expensive and irreversible the unknown, the smaller the action should be and the thicker the evidence.

1. Write Facts Before the Story

Under pressure, we blend fact and interpretation:

> “This project will succeed because we have already invested so much.”

“We have invested so much” is a fact. “It will succeed” is an inference. The unanswered question is what evidence would support or overturn it.

Write three columns:

Fact	My interpretation	Still unknown
Time, money, and people already invested	Continuing can recover the loss	Will users keep paying?
Risks a doctor has ruled out so far	I should immediately return to my old workload	Why do symptoms persist, and what is the next assessment?
A boundary another person stated clearly	One more explanation can change the outcome	Whether they will want to talk again

Writing down the unknowns does not make a choice easy. It stops imagination from quietly posing as evidence.

2. Judge Reversibility First

Not every choice deserves the same amount of discussion. Ask: **If the result is bad, can I reverse it at a reasonable cost?**

1. **Highly reversible**: try another textbook, test a tool for two weeks, schedule an interview;

1 **Partly reversible**: accept a job, sign a short contract, move to another city;

1 **Hard to reverse**: take on major debt, sell an important asset, publish a damaging accusation, or make a long-term arrangement that harms health.

Move reversible choices into experiments sooner. Add cooling-off time, a second opinion, written boundaries, and an exit plan to irreversible choices. Decisiveness is not making everything immediately. It is knowing what should not be decided on impulse.

3. Replace the Gamble with a Small Experiment

“Should I do it?” is rarely the only option. Ask instead: **Can I spend a small amount of time and resources to buy the next important piece of information?**

For example:

1 do not spend six months building a full product; make a slice three target users can try in one week;

1 do not resign just to prove commitment; finish one real side-project delivery and observe whether you want to continue;

1 do not buy ten courses; complete one task and identify whether the missing piece is knowledge, feedback, or time;

1 do not ask AI to generate a complete plan; ask it to list assumptions, then design a test that could disprove the plan.

A small experiment is not timid. It turns expensive unknowns into affordable unknowns.

4. One-Page Decision Brief

For an important choice, write one page. You do not need to analyse every possibility:

```
# Decision Brief — YYYY-MM-DD

Problem to solve:
Decision deadline:

Known facts and sources:
Key assumptions:
Still unknown:

Option A:
Option B:
Do nothing for now:

Benefits, costs, and worst case for each option:
What is reversible:
```

```
Smallest experiment:
Stop or rollback condition:
Whose advice is relevant:

Current decision:
Review date:
Evidence to preserve:
```

You can also copy the Decision Brief in the Life Practice Toolkit and keep facts, costs, stop conditions, and review date in a private record.

“Do nothing for now” must be a real option. It is not avoidance. It acknowledges that some information is not yet worth its price.

5. Four Cost Sheets

A choice that counts only benefits usually transfers the cost to your future self or the people beside you. Check at least four categories.

Money

Count maintenance, rework, learning time, opportunity cost, and the worst-case exit cost in addition to purchase or development cost. When cash is tight, protect essential living and family responsibilities before expanding risk.

Health

Late nights, chronic pain, persistent anxiety, and no recovery time belong on the plan. A plan that works only while the body deteriorates is a design failure, not intensity.

Relationships

Who will carry extra uncertainty because of my decision? Have I stated the boundary, timeline, and worst case clearly? “Everyone supports me” is not a substitute for informed agreement.

Responsibility

If the result is bad, who can pause, notify, repair, and carry the consequence? AI can list options, but it cannot sign, apologise, or make a promise for you.

6. Do Not Judge a Decision Only by Its Result

A decision that succeeds may still contain luck. A decision that fails does not mean every fact supporting it was worthless.

Review four points in time:

1. What did I know then?
2. What did I not know then?
3. Which assumption did the facts support or overturn?
4. At what earlier point could I have obtained the information?

This turns failure into method and prevents success from being misread as a universal formula.

7. AI Can Participate, But It Is Not an Oracle

Give AI a defined role:

1. **organiser**: structure facts, options, and questions;
1. **opponent**: find counterexamples, omissions, and worst cases;
1. **simulator**: act as a customer, colleague, reader, or reviewer;
1. **recorder**: preserve assumptions, decisions, evidence, and review dates.

Do not ask AI to answer “Should I resign?”, “Is this project worth the investment?”, or “Should this relationship continue?” The facts, responsibility, and value order belong to you. A tool can help make the question clearer.

Try this prompt:

> Here are my facts, constraints, and three options. Do not decide for me. Separate facts, inferences, and values. For each option, list likely benefits, costs, unknowns, and a test I can run within two weeks. Mark conclusions that require a professional or an original source.

8. Seven Days to Clarify a Decision

When one decision keeps occupying your attention, use a seven-day process:

1. **Day 1**: write facts and the deadline, without a conclusion;
2. **Day 2**: list at least three options, including doing nothing;
3. **Day 3**: mark reversibility, worst case, and who carries responsibility;
4. **Day 4**: ask one relevant person to check your omissions, not unrelated people for applause;
5. **Day 5**: design a smallest experiment with a time and cost limit;

6. **Day 6**: ask AI to act as the opposing side and find overlooked facts;
7. **Day 7**: decide, record a review date, and state the stop condition.

You may still choose to wait after seven days, but waiting must have a next piece of information and a date. It cannot be indefinite delay.

9. Signs of a Good Decision Process

A good decision does not guarantee a good result. It should have these properties:

1. facts and assumptions are recorded separately;
1. affected people know the boundaries and costs;
1. reversible and irreversible parts are treated differently;
1. a small experiment buys information before a gamble hides the unknown;
1. there is a path to stop, roll back, or ask for help;
1. new evidence can change the plan without defending the image that you were never wrong.

Maturity in choosing is not always choosing correctly. It is seeing earlier what cost you are paying for what result.

Closing: Leave a Way Back

I still make bad decisions and still overestimate my clarity under pressure. Now I am more willing to write the decision down, give it a boundary, an experiment, and a review date.

Life is not an exam that allows one choice only. What matters is retaining the ability to observe, apologise, revise, and return after each choice.

Relationships: Becoming an Adult in Connection

It is easy to believe you are mature when you are alone. Relationships are the real test: someone misunderstands you, someone disappoints you, someone needs you, and you are tired, afraid, or ready to escape.

I once thought loving someone meant designing a better future for her. I learned that a relationship is not a stage for one person to display ability. It is two concrete people repeatedly asking, within limited time, money, energy, and emotion: What are we living through? What can we carry together? Which boundaries cannot be crossed?

Becoming an adult in a relationship does not mean staying calm forever or never making mistakes. It means learning to name feelings, separate responsibility, make smaller promises, and treat the other person’s freedom as part of reality.

Quick Overview

1. presence matters more than immediate advice;
1. a boundary describes what you can and cannot do, not how to punish someone;
1. in conflict, handle safety and facts before positions and winning;
1. apology faces impact, repair depends on repeated action, and leaving can be responsible;
1. do not use AI to manipulate emotion, inspect private data, or speak commitments you do not own.

1. Presence: Let the Other Person Be Heard

Many arguments are not caused by a lack of answers. They begin because one person has not been heard. We rush to explain, comfort, analyse, and solve, skipping the facts of what the other person is living through.

Try three steps:

1. **Reflect the fact**: “I hear that you were criticised in front of everyone today.”
2. **Name the feeling**: “That left you hurt and alone.”
3. **Ask what is needed**: “Do you want me to listen, or think through options with you?”

This is not a therapy script. It gives the conversation an opening that cannot be stolen. The other person may not need agreement or an immediate solution. They may need to know their experience was not brushed aside.

Presence also includes naming your capacity:

> "I am tired, but I can listen carefully for ten minutes. If we are not finished, let's continue tomorrow."

Limited presence is more reliable than a distracted promise to be available all day.

2. Boundaries: Return Responsibility to Each Person

Without boundaries, a relationship can look close while everyone guesses, tests, and stores resentment. A boundary is not "you must". It is "when this happens, this is how I will protect myself and state the consequence".

Compare:

1 Control: "You are not allowed to contact that person again."

1 Boundary: "If the conversation includes insults, I will end the call and schedule another time after we are calm."

Make boundaries concrete: what behaviour, what you can do, and when to reconnect. They do not require the other person's full agreement, but they do require your willingness to follow through.

Common boundaries include:

1 time: I can discuss this for 20 minutes tonight;

1 information: this includes a third party's privacy, so I will not forward screenshots;

1 money: this is what I can lend and when it can be repaid;

1 work: these are the situations in which you may contact me after hours;

1 body: every intimate act requires clear consent in the moment.

Boundaries do not push people away. They make closeness less dependent on guessing.

3. Conflict: Safety Before Viewpoint

Different opinions do not equal a failed relationship. Threats, violence, persistent humiliation, stalking, financial control, and other behaviour that removes the ability to speak safely require priority.

If those risks are present, leave, contact someone trustworthy and professional support, and do not treat communication technique as the only solution. When safety is not secured, learning non-violent language is not the first task.

In a relatively safe conflict, use this structure:

```
When I observe [specific fact], I experience [specific impact].
I need [a describable need].
I am asking that we try [one concrete request] at [time/place].
If that is not possible, I will [a boundary I can enforce].
```

For example:

> When project changes are not recorded before delivery, I redo work repeatedly. I need to know which decisions are final. I am asking that every change leave a date and owner in the shared document; if it is not confirmed tonight, I will pause the release.

This structure does not guarantee agreement. It stops personality judgment from replacing factual communication.

4. Apology: Pain Is Not an Exemption

A real apology does not begin with “I am suffering too”. Your pain can be seen, but it does not erase the impact on someone else.

A responsible apology:

1. says what you did;
2. acknowledges the impact;
3. does not use circumstances, pressure, or good intentions as a discount;
4. names one observable correction;
5. accepts that the other person may not reply, forgive, or stay.

“I am sorry, please stop being angry” often asks the other person to care for your emotion. A more honest version is:

> “I made a decision for you without confirming it, and you carried extra pressure because of me. I caused that impact. I will ask for your consent first and return this arrangement to your control this week. You do not need to reply now.”

After an apology, the work begins. A long beautiful message matters less than a few weeks of consistent change without applause.

5. Shared Life in Intimate Relationships

Intimacy is not a continuous performance of romance. It is joint management of money, housework, sleep, work, children, parents, space, and an uncertain future.

Consider a 30-minute weekly life meeting with four questions:

1 What made us feel supported this week?

1 Which concrete task is creating pressure?

1 Who owns what next week, and by when?

1 Which problem will not be solved tonight but needs a review date?

The purpose is not to turn love into project management. It is to keep invisible labour and emotion from being carried silently by one person. Romance needs room; reliability needs a calendar.

6. Family, Friendship, and Work Boundaries

Different relationships carry different promises:

1 family may offer long-term support without owning all your choices;

1 friends may accompany and remind you without being forced to provide therapy, loans, or rescue;

1 colleagues need clear collaboration, not every private detail;

1 managers owe teams responsibility without cancelling labour boundaries through “we are family”.

The more important the relationship, the more you need to translate “I want you to understand” into a concrete request. Unspoken expectations often return as blame.

7. Relationship Ethics in the AI Era

When AI can imitate tone, draft an apology, and analyse a chat, we need to know what not to give it:

1 do not upload private chats, photos, recordings, or identity information without consent;

1 do not let AI fake your feelings, commitments, or apology;

1 do not mass-generate messages designed to manipulate, pressure, or lure someone;

1 do not treat an AI inference about a person as a diagnosis, fact, or moral verdict;

1 before publishing another person's story, reconfirm permission, necessity, and the ability to delete it.

AI can organise a confused feeling into a draft or simulate questions the other person may ask. The actual conversation, consent, and responsibility remain human work.

8. Leaving: Not Every Relationship Must Be Saved

Growth stories often make persistence noble and leaving a failure. If a relationship leaves someone in long-term fear, shame, danger, or loss of self, leaving may be the most honest choice for both people.

Before leaving, distinguish:

1 am I avoiding a repairable conflict, or responding to ongoing harm?

1 have I clearly expressed the boundary and need?

1 who carries the cost of staying, and is anyone in danger?

When there is violence, threat, or stalking, make a safety plan and seek professional help. Do not arrange a final negotiation alone.

Leaving also needs boundaries: state necessary facts, arrange possessions, finances, and care, reduce repeated explanations, and do not create new harm to prove the old decision was right.

9. Seven Days of Relationship Practice

1 **Day 1**: name one relationship to improve without judging the other person's character;

2 **Day 2**: record the facts, feelings, and needs in one conversation;

3 **Day 3**: make one small, concrete request;

4 **Day 4**: write your boundary for a recurring problem;

5 **Day 5**: have a 20-minute conversation without looking at a phone;

6 **Day 6**: draft an apology for past harm without rushing to send it;

7 **Day 7**: decide whether to move closer, keep distance, seek help, or begin leaving.

Do not turn this into a task that forces someone else to change. You directly control your expression, boundaries, actions, and requests for help.

Copy the notes from days 2–4 into the Relationship Communication Card in the Life Practice Toolkit. If the other person does not participate, you can still record your own boundary, request, and next review date.

10. Signs of a Healthy Relationship

A healthy relationship can contain conflict and still allow people to:

1 disagree without first proving they deserve love;

1 say no without fear of punishment or retaliation;

1 see each other’s effort and limits;

1 apologise and repair after harm while accepting that repair may fail;

1 seek outside support instead of trapping two people on an island;

1 let a relationship change without interpreting departure as proof of anyone’s worthlessness.

If a relationship keeps you in fear or control, seek help before trying to become “better at communication”.

Closing: Let Love Have Boundaries

I still make mistakes in relationships. I still mistake silence for understanding and persistence for responsibility. Now I try to slow down: hear the facts, state the boundary, own the impact, and then decide whether to keep moving closer.

Love is not designing another person’s life, and it is not sacrificing yourself until you cannot breathe. It is a continuing respect: I will be present, and I accept that you have your own road; I will repair, and I accept that you may choose to leave.

Entrepreneurship: From Ambition to Purpose

> First written in June 2026 and revised on 2026-08-31 for evidence levels, privacy, and affiliation disclosure. This personal review offers no success formula, investment advice, or route for others to copy.

When I was younger, entrepreneurship meant opportunity, ambition, and a chance to take my life off its old track. Today it feels more like a delayed mirror. Courage and greed appear in the same reflection; ability and immaturity grow larger together.

People first found me through this English-learning repository. Others later read about the software company that failed, the health problems that followed, my return home, and the effort to begin again. Connected together, those events ask one question:

> How many times must a person break before understanding where their abilities should be used?

Separate Memory, Review, and Plans

This chapter contains personal memory, explanations made in hindsight, and plans for the future. They have different evidence standards:

Level	How it is written	How a reader should use it
What happened	Dates, roles, products, accounts, or public records	Treat it as my record and return to primary evidence when needed
Hindsight explanation	Why I think a decision worked or failed	Treat it as a hypothesis, not proof of causation
Reusable gate	What I will ask, test, or stop next time	Use it to design your own checks, not to copy my route
Unverified plan	An industry, service, or public-interest direction I want to explore	Keep it labelled as a direction until users, costs, and time answer

Loss figures are estimates from personal records and require financial evidence for formal conclusions. For current affiliations and commercial relationships, use the latest Author Projects and Real-world Practice disclosure.

Cover: a workspace between city and countryside at dawn

2016: Putting Work into the Market

2016: a first product starting from a desk and a website

I went to Beijing on 7 March 2015 to find an internship. A series of encouraging interviews gave me a young person's illusion that I might force a place for myself in the world.

The university required me to return for my graduation defence. I did not receive my certificate on schedule because of unfinished internship requirements, so I went home. The period did not feel impressive: I learned to cook and developed joint pain. In retrospect, major turns often grow through the gap created by having nowhere obvious to go; their beginnings are rarely well lit.

In 2016 I built a film website, `bt0.com`. It was small, but it had real users and real feedback. That was enough to teach an important lesson: code has to leave the editor, and a product has to leave the maker's imagination and meet another person's choice.

I took web-design projects and formed early companies with a former classmate. I moved quickly and easily mistook speed for direction. In an old post I had written that I wanted to work steadily, avoid rushing, and boast less. It took years to understand my own sentence.

2017: Joining a Company and Betting on It

On 1 April 2017, I joined a Nanjing technology company as a front-end developer to work on software for lawyers and law firms.

The first version had been outsourced. The code lacked comments, project management was confused, and product direction often changed by impulse. In my first month, one timeline module went through more than twenty versions. I did not yet know the terms organisational capability or requirements governance. I knew only that repeated demolition can turn enthusiasm into numbness.

I later led a front-end rewrite in Vue. After more than half a year, the new release reached the market, and for a long time produced no orders. Compensation stagnated and colleagues left. I continued because I believed in the product, moving from employee to team lead, general manager, and partner.

There is much I still value: I worked seriously on a product, led people seriously, and sincerely believed the work could succeed. But I also confused persistence with correctness, investment with a moat, and effort with a claim on the market.

Entrepreneurship permits sincerity and hard work. It never promises compensation for either.

Restaurants, Hotels, and Cash Flow

Outside software, I took part in a resort hotel and a club and lost heavily. Small restaurants taught me more directly.

A relative ran a successful beef-soup shop. I studied it, opened one of my own, then designed, renovated, photographed products, and expanded to more locations. Restaurant work was exhausting but honest. Customers, table turnover, serving time, consistency, reviews, rent, labour, and cash flow answered every day. The numbers could not hide behind a narrative.

The software company taught me that dreams are expensive. Restaurants taught me that cash flow is real.

The shops helped fund my later software investment, but eventually closed during the pandemic period. They offered no verdict that physical business was superior to the internet. Every business returns to exchange: will people pay, can the cost structure survive, and can the organisation remain alive when conditions change?

2022: Seeing the Foundation of Product and Responsibility

2022: an empty meeting room after failure

The software company moved into a larger office and invested in hiring, welfare, and environment. At the beginning of 2022, sales fell sharply. The product had accumulated features and defects, and customer feedback was poor.

An experienced engineer joined and helped expose deeper problems: old project structure, performance and security risk, and AI/data claims without the training data and foundations we had imagined. Much of what looked like core capability was search and preset output.

We had invested in interfaces, platforms, and feature volume without securing the core data and engineering foundation. Continuing to add features felt like painting a dangerous building; rebuilding required money the company could not afford.

One evening, the partners talked late into the night. A major shareholder who had invested heavily was close to emotional collapse and demanded to know whether the project could continue. I understood the despair. The money was personal savings, not abstract investment capital. I had also invested millions.

The company struggled to pay salaries and borrowed money. Management became more controlling: attendance enforcement, reduced benefits, meaningless overtime, constant reports, and monitoring. By September the team no longer wanted to come to work, and the company ended.

According to the records I had at the time, our combined losses exceeded twenty million yuan before other ventures. This estimate requires financial evidence for any formal conclusion. Harder than the number was guilt towards colleagues, family, and people who had trusted my judgment. Beyond the balance sheet came the discovery that something once held with certainty had been wrong at the foundation.

2023: Survive Before Restarting

2023: recovery after returning home

At the end of March 2023 I transferred the final restaurant. In June I left Nanjing with family and returned home.

My health and routine had deteriorated: stomach problems, insomnia, poor appetite, blurred vision, and pain. Medical examinations did not reveal the catastrophic illness I feared, yet every day felt dangerous. I escaped into games, reversed day and night, stopped earning, left online groups, and disconnected from GitHub and people I had known.

Lack of money was hard. The absence of visible hope was harder. I repeatedly asked whether stopping earlier or recognising the foundations more clearly would have changed the outcome.

Recovery came through slowly regaining control: eating, sleeping, going outside, learning again, facing the past, admitting mistakes, and sorting the wreckage. No inspiring sentence could perform those acts for me.

Founders often romanticise “starting again”. It may begin with admitting that a founder is an ordinary person who can fail, needs rest, and must first support health and daily life. Another company can wait.

2026: AI and the Physical Economy

2026: bringing AI into industry and everyday life

By June 2026, I had returned to technology, products, and industry as a company leader. Product details, company visits, relationships, dates, and non-sponsorship disclosures are now centralised on Author Projects and Real-world Practice so that a personal review does not double as product promotion.

An industry visit reinforced a direction: AI has to leave abstraction and the hands of a small group, enter real processes such as agriculture, and become usable by ordinary people before its value can be tested.

That statement is still a direction, not evidence of impact. After the software failure, I ask harder questions: who needs this, can it enter a real workflow, can people keep using it, and can delivery, compliance, cost, and service close the loop? Without answers, a beautiful technology story can become another unstable building.

Five Reality Gates for the Next Venture

Each gate should leave evidence another person can inspect. A founder's confidence is only a starting point:

1. **Problem gate**: who meets the problem, in which repeated situation, and what interviews, orders, or usage records exist?
2. **Value gate**: what time, risk, or cost changes, and how will the user accept the result?
3. **Delivery gate**: who implements, supports, trains, and handles incidents, and can someone else take over?
4. **Survival gate**: are revenue, fixed cost, variable cost, worst case, and stop/exit conditions in the ledger?
5. **Relationship gate**: what cost do team, family, customers, and third parties bear, and are permission, privacy, and promises clear?

Use the Life Practice Toolkit for choices and boundaries, and the AI Project Scorecard for pilot quality. Tools can expose questions; they cannot carry entrepreneurial responsibility.

Lessons That Remained

Features do not make a product

Features acquire the weight of a product only when people repeatedly use them to solve a problem more quickly, reliably, or affordably.

Technical debt becomes business debt

Confused code, old architecture, missing data, and security risk eventually consume delivery, slow iteration, raise maintenance cost, and damage sales, support, and morale.

Cash flow is more honest than valuation

A small business that survives can carry more weight than a grand internet narrative. Cash flow makes a business answer to reality.

Founders should distrust heroic stories

“One more push will work”, “we invested too much to be wrong”, and “everyone following me will have a future” can become harm when facts no longer support them.

The willingness to learn after failure is an asset

I once closed the connection to GitHub and technology. The pain remains. I returned because it needed to become judgment; otherwise failure would remain only failure.

Entrepreneurship Cannot Depend on Self-immolation

I once thought a founder should burn time, health, relationships, and savings, and that success would justify it. I eventually abandoned that belief.

Good entrepreneurship should make a founder clearer, a team more orderly, users better served, and family more secure. Risk still needs limits; persistence still needs an exit; belief in the future must keep looking at the present.

Before continuing, I now want plain answers:

1. Who needs this and why now?
1. Where does revenue come from and where are the costs?
1. What guarantees delivery?
1. How is risk contained?
1. If it fails, how can people exit responsibly?
1. If it succeeds, can ordinary people benefit?

This review neither displays youthful success nor prosecutes later disappointment. It records an attempt to rebuild judgment after reality broke it and use what remains for work that helps others.

Related Reading

1. Archive from a Decade Ago
1. Last Year and Now
1. My Story
1. Author Projects and Real-world Practice
1. Life Practice Toolkit
1. AI Project Scorecard
1. GitHub profile

Closing: Let Ambition Pass Through Reality

I do not want to lose ambition. Without it, I would not have entered unfamiliar industries or returned to technology after failure. But ambition left untested can recruit everything nearby: a team's time, a family's sense of safety, a customer's trust, and the rest a body was meant to receive.

If there is another venture, I want it to pass through plain realities: the problem exists, users choose the work, the ledger closes, promises can be delivered, and someone knows how to stop when it fails. It may grow more slowly and remain smaller, while leaving the people inside it more ordered instead of merely making the founder's story more dramatic.

I no longer need a company to prove that I stood up after a low season. Work worth doing should remain useful after I leave the stage. Even if it never becomes a grand enterprise, it should not require the people who love me to keep paying for my certainty.

Part III: Amplify Ability

A tool never amplifies efficiency alone. It amplifies the clarity or confusion of the goal, the reliability or carelessness of judgment, the order a team already possesses, and the problems it has kept avoiding.

AI has made answers cheap and drafts, code, and plans unusually fast to produce. The speed is exciting. It also creates a persuasive illusion: enough output must mean understanding; a running page must mean a viable product; a confident model sentence must mean the fact has been checked.

This part is not about becoming a more fluent operator of prompts. It takes on the harder work: retaining ownership of the question, protecting attention, moving an answer into an artifact, making the artifact face evidence, and taking responsibility for permission, cost, failure, and other people's interests when the tool enters a real project.

The best place for a tool is not the driver's seat. It is after you have named the purpose, boundaries, and acceptance standard, helping you travel farther without taking the direction away.

Questions for This Part

1 What must I write independently before opening AI?

1 Which inputs deserve attention, and which entrances should close?

1 How does an answer become work that can be signed, delivered, accepted, and rolled back?

1 How can baseline, immediate performance, delayed retention, and transfer form a trustworthy evidence chain?

1 When a tool enters customer, team, and commercial systems, who carries permission, cost, safety, and the final result?

The stronger the tool, the clearer the stopping condition must be. Acceleration that cannot be explained, tested, or rolled back may only deliver an error to more people sooner.

Reading Path

Path	Chapters	What to leave behind
Define collaboration	Learning Anything with AI	Problem, baseline, sources, privacy, and human judgment boundaries
Protect judgment	Attention	One closed entrance and one window for independent thought
Make an artifact	Artifacts	Audience, completion standard, versions, acceptance owner, and rollback
Verify change	Evidence	Baseline, immediate performance, delayed retention, and transfer
Enter the project	AI Development and Resource-layer Business · Author Projects and Practice	Tests, cost ledger, permissions, incident plan, and affiliation disclosure

Do not put one tool into every task because it leads a ranking. Choose the problem first, the evidence second, and the tool last. Product names will change. This order should survive them.

What to Carry Forward

At the end of this part, complete one real delivery instead of saving another impressive conversation:

1. An AI Task Brief with the problem, sources, and data boundaries;
2. An artifact a real audience can accept;
3. An independent retest after AI is closed;
4. One explicit decision to keep, adjust, stop, or roll back.

If an important decision can be found only in chat history, the project does not yet belong to you. Write it back into code, documentation, ledgers, and records another person can take over.

Enter the Work

Do not begin with “Which model is best?” Close the conversation window and write the problem you actually need to solve today, followed by what would count as complete.

Only then can speed arrive without carrying direction away with it.

Learning Anything with AI: From Real Problems to Verifiable Delivery

My name is Han Xiankai, also known online as Li Pu. Many readers first met me through English learning, then through stories about software, restaurants, a failed company, disrupted health, and a return to technology and AI. I now treat AI as learning infrastructure, not a button that thinks on my behalf.

The method comes from an uncomfortable fact: an answer can be complete while a product has no users; code can run while its data and security have no foundation; a person can sound clever in a chat and still be unable to perform alone after the chat closes. A real learning result survives without AI: you can explain, judge, perform, transfer, and leave evidence another person can inspect.

Quick Overview

1 define the real outcome before deciding where AI enters;

1 compare an unaided baseline, an assisted version, and a delayed independent retest;

1 put sources, permissions, privacy, cost, and ownership into the task boundary;

1 save state at the end so the next session does not depend on chat memory.

Where the Method Comes From

The following are personal records, not research findings or a universal promise. Read each case in four steps: what happened, which judgment failed, what principle followed, and what you can practise today.

If you are analysing a public profile, an AI project experience, or your own failure record, copy the AI Case Review Template first. Separate source, facts, judgment, outcome, and transferable principle. The template cannot prove an outcome for you, but it can stop a narrative from quietly becoming a conclusion.

2015–2016: From a Dead End to Real Users

After setbacks around an internship and graduation, I returned home. In 2016 I started `bt0.com`, a small movie website, and later accepted web-design work. It was not a grand product, but it had real users, feedback, and traces of use.

The easy mistake was to treat “I can build it” as “people need it”. What changed my judgment was not another technology lesson. It was seeing people use, review, and leave because of a detail.

Principle: learning starts with a real problem; work exposes gaps better than collected answers.

Try today: choose a problem someone near you actually has. Without AI, write one page naming the audience, action, completion standard, and three things you do not know.

2017–2022: From Front-end Refactoring to Organisational Constraints

In 2017 I joined a software company serving lawyers and law firms. I moved from front-end developer to team leader, general manager, and partner. The early product came from outsourcing and changing requirements; I later led a Vue rewrite, but the released product went a long time without a sale.

The lesson was that effort, refactoring, and feature count cannot replace problem discovery, user validation, and team coordination. One person learning to code does not mean an organisation has learned to deliver.

Principle: write learning as a real task, not “understand a topic”; every step needs an audience and acceptance standard.

Try today: replace “learn product management” with “write a one-page brief for a real user in 45 minutes and let that user reject one assumption”.

2022: Mistaking Search and Presets for AI

Sales fell sharply in 2022. When my high-school desk mate joined, we discovered an old project structure, performance and security problems, and “big data” and “AI” features without a real dataset or training foundation. Some features were essentially search and preset results.

We had spent too much effort on UI, multi-platform support, and feature accumulation before confirming that the core capability and data existed. The company eventually closed. Better demonstrations could not erase the loss or the responsibility.

Principle: a demo is not a capability, a model answer is not a fact, and generation speed is not delivery quality. Important claims must return to sources, tests, users, and an accountable person.

Try today: ask AI to explain a familiar topic. Then, without the chat, write its sources, a counterexample, an unknown, and one test that could disprove it. What you cannot write is a learning gap.

2023: Recovering the Ability to Act

After the company failed, I closed GitHub, left many groups, played games, and lost the boundaries of daily life. Returning home, the first step was not founding another company. It was eating, sleeping, going outside, facing the past, and reducing tasks to a scale I could complete.

Principle: a learning system must include energy, health, and ordinary responsibilities. Consistency beats short bursts, and a difficult season should not be judged by a dramatic reversal.

Try today: reserve 5–15 minutes for one saved action: organise a page, run a test, listen to a clip, or write three sentences. Record what happened instead of hiding in a plan.

2026: Returning to AI and Physical Industries

In 2026, as chairman of China Token Cloud Computing Co., Ltd., I returned to technology, enterprise services, and physical-industry practice. I am exploring AI for agriculture, forestry, animal husbandry, fisheries, and other real settings, and plan to offer basic training for rural cooperatives. This is a direction and a personal plan, not proof of revenue, customer count, or impact.

Principle: AI must eventually enter a real workflow and accept constraints around cost, permissions, privacy, user feedback, failure, and rollback.

Try today: for one organisational problem, write where data enters, who can see it, what passes acceptance, how work stops when it fails, and which human responsibility you will own.

The Seven-step Loop

1. **Define a real outcome**: situation, audience, action, deadline, and acceptance criteria.
2. **Save an unaided baseline**: attempt the task first and expose gaps and blind spots.
3. **Prepare trustworthy material**: prefer official documents, books, papers, data, code, and real cases.
4. **Design guided practice**: ask AI to question, explain, compare, hint, and create parallel tasks without doing the critical step.
5. **Produce actively**: close the material and explain, code, write, calculate, demonstrate, or decide.

6. **Use plural feedback**: sources, tests, experts, users, and security review join AI in judging the result.
7. **Update state**: save work, errors, cost, open questions, and the smallest next task.

Without step one, AI turns a wish into an answer. Without step two, you cannot see growth. Without steps six and seven, errors return in the next conversation.

One-page Task Brief

Copy this into a private project directory. Redact sensitive material; never send passwords, identity documents, customer records, or third-party private data to a general model.

```
# AI Task Brief

Real situation:
User/audience:
Decision or action to complete:
Deadline:

Known facts and sources:
Files allowed:
Data sensitivity: public / internal / confidential / restricted
Material deliberately withheld:

Final deliverable:
Format and length:
Acceptance criteria:
Items a person must confirm:

AI may:
AI may not:
Human reviewer:
Rollback or stop condition:
```

“Good experience”, “advanced architecture”, and “learn AI” are not acceptance criteria. Use observable actions, such as “a user can import a file in ten minutes and receive an explainable error report”.

A Minimal Session Protocol

Before starting, ask AI only to restate the boundary:

```
Restate in no more than eight bullets: goal, audience, inputs, acceptance criteria, con
List the sources you intend to use. Mark source-free facts as unverified.
Do not produce the final deliverable. Identify the three risks most likely to cause rew
```

During the work, advance one inspectable slice:

```
Break the task into the smallest verifiable slices. Advance one slice at a time and sta
If a prerequisite conflicts, pause and ask. Do not silently replace the requirement. Ke
```

At the end, create a state update instead of a polished essay:

```
Based only on what happened in this session, output:
1. completed work and evidence location;
2. judgments confirmed by a source, test, or person;
3. recurring errors, risks, and open questions;
4. the smallest next task, acceptance criteria, and required material.
Do not claim to remember another session or turn inference into fact.
```

Different Outputs Need Different Evidence

Output	Minimum evidence	Stronger evidence
Explanation	Primary source, key terms, uncertainty	Closed-book restatement, counterexample, transfer task
Code	Run result, basic tests	Boundary tests, static checks, security review, real samples
Research	Primary link for material facts	Cross-source verification, definitions, dates, counterexamples
Prose	Audience, purpose, facts, structure	Real-reader feedback, revision record, version comparison
Decision	Options, assumptions, cost, risks	Small experiment, decision log, after-action review
Teaching	Goal and practice result	Independent transfer, delayed retest, changing errors

For high-risk content, “not yet confirmed” is more professional than a fluent guess.

Three Comparisons: Prove What AI Changed

Keep three samples of the same task:

1. **Unaided baseline**: complete it independently and record time, quality, bottlenecks, and confidence;
2. **Assisted version**: let AI do only the agreed work and record prompts, sources, accepted/rejected suggestions, and rework;
3. **Delayed independent version**: after 3–7 days, close the chat and answer key, then repeat under a related condition.

Comparison result	Cautious interpretation
Assisted and independent versions both improve	AI may have supplied useful scaffolding that remained yours
Assisted improves while independent regresses	The product improved, but a critical step may have been outsourced

Comparison result	Cautious interpretation
Time falls while rework and errors rise	You gained speed and accumulated "speed debt"
Confidence rises while accuracy is flat or lower	Calibrate confidence before granting the tool more access

Record task completion, quality, independent performance, rework, cost, and transfer. One comparison cannot prove causation, but it is more inspectable than "AI feels useful".

Common Failures and Handover

Failure point	Signal	Immediate action
Fabricated fact	No source, version, or data location can be found	Stop sharing; return to a primary source and mark it unverified
Requirement drift	The answer grows complete but stops answering the original task	Paste the brief again and ask for conflicts and unknowns
Privacy leak	Input contains customer, identity, health, or key material	Stop upload; redact or use an approved environment
False completion	Code runs without boundary tests, or prose reads well without citations	Run the smallest acceptance test; fluency is not completion
Session dependency	You cannot explain the next step outside the chat	Save it in the AI Learning Log and Learning State

At handover, save the current goal, completed work and evidence location, unconfirmed facts, errors and risks, cost, smallest next task, and stop/rollback condition. A chat window is a temporary workspace, not the project's only archive.

From Learning to Delivery

When a task becomes code or a team project, add three gates:

1 **Explainable**: the owner can explain important decisions without the chat;

1 **Testable**: real inputs, edge cases, permissions, and failure paths are checked;

1 **Reversible**: someone knows who pauses, who is notified, and how to recover from risk or outage.

Use a portable directory:

```
00-brief/       task brief and acceptance criteria
01-baseline/    unaided sample and initial tests
02-sources/     primary material, licences, source index
03-working/     drafts, experiments, prompts
04-output/      deliverable, recording, build artefact
05-feedback/    user feedback and error categories
```

```
06-decisions/   decision log and open questions
07-operations/  permissions, monitoring, deployment, rollback
learning-state.md
```

Data, Privacy, and Copyright

Level	Examples	Default handling
Public	Published documents, public code, public data	Check source and licence before use
Internal	Unpublished plans, processes, non-sensitive logs	Approved tools only; limit members and retention
Confidential	Customer records, contracts, commercial strategy, unpublished vulnerabilities	No upload without approval; prefer local work or redaction
Restricted	Keys, identity/health data, children's data, third-party private material	Keep out of general models; follow policy and law

Deleting a file does not delete history, shared links, exports, caches, or backups. Public articles can contain personal data too; confirm permission, minimum necessary scope, and retention before processing them.

Seven Days, Thirty Days, Twelve Weeks

Seven days: one reproducible micro-delivery

1 write the brief and acceptance criteria;

1 save an unaided baseline;

1 complete a one-to-three-hour deliverable with the loop;

1 save sources, prompts, tests, feedback, and state;

1 record where AI helped, misled, and what remains without it.

Thirty days: one repeatable workflow

1 complete four loops for a recurring task;

1 compare time, quality, rework, cost, and independent performance;

1 remove steps that do not improve the result;

1 conduct a failure retrospective, not only a success demo.

Twelve weeks: delivery to a real user or organisation

1 obtain real-audience feedback every two to four weeks;

1 complete fact, test, security, privacy, copyright, cost, and handover review;

1 export the material and state, then write a retrospective and next-cycle decision;

1 if evidence is weak, narrow the problem, change the audience, or stop instead of adding prompts.

Put the three comparisons and cycle result into the 90-Day Cycle Map, changing one variable in the next cycle.

Sources and Verification

1 **Personal experience**: mainly My Story, Entrepreneurship, and Author Projects and Practice. These are personal records, not universal rules.

1 **Product information**: official help pages listed in Learning English with AI; features, regions, and plans change.

1 **Project status**: China Token Cloud, `token.love`, public articles, and physical-industry plans carry affiliations or unverified scope; none is an independent review or proof of revenue.

1 **Last checked**: 24 August 2026. Recheck official product pages, external links, and project status before updating or using this guidance.

Closing: Keep the Ability with the Person

AI readily creates more than wrong answers. It creates a premature sense of completion. The explanation is fluent, the code runs, the plan is arranged, and we begin to believe the problem has been understood. Answers can arrive much faster than judgment forms.

Learning worth continuing should leave something the conversation cannot carry away: a more accurate question, a traceable source, a failed test, a judgment changed by evidence, an artifact another person can use, and a person who still knows what to do after the tool closes.

Learning is not asking AI to arrive on your behalf. It is using the tool to reach what you could not yet see, then checking the ground yourself. Close the window, explain the work to a real person, complete the next step, and carry the result. If the ability follows you out of the conversation, it has begun to remain.

Attention: Return Your Attention to Yourself

AI is making answers cheaper while attention becomes more expensive. In seconds we can receive a summary, plan, code, or opinion, and in the same seconds notifications, short videos, and endless links can carry us away.

I no longer want to call this simply a lack of willpower. Attention is shaped by its environment: too many entrances, too much switching, and tasks without boundaries make sustained clarity difficult for anyone. The skill is not turning yourself into a machine that never drifts. It is deciding what deserves to enter, stay, and be completed by you.

Quick Overview

1. separate attention into capture, choice, and completion;
1. set boundaries around input instead of letting saved links become an anxiety warehouse;
1. write your own judgment before using AI, then retest after closing the chat;
1. reduce switching through environment design rather than daily battles with willpower;
1. audit where attention went each week and turn “I was busy” into adjustable facts.

1. Attention Is Not a Lamp That Stays On

When we say “I need to focus”, we often mix three different actions:

1. **Capture**: what enters my sight, ears, or task list;
2. **Choice**: whether I judge it worth handling now;
3. **Completion**: whether I can finish a deliverable slice without constant switching.

Many tools only capture: they push, recommend, and remind. Many plans only choose: they list everything you “should” do. Completion is scarce because it needs uninterrupted time, clear boundaries, and permission not to answer every other stimulus.

Do not begin by asking whether you can focus for eight hours. Ask: **Can I protect 25 minutes for one important slice without opening unrelated entrances?**

2. Three Gates for Input

Information is not free simply because it costs no money. Every link carries reading cost, emotional cost, judgment cost, and the later cost of organising it.

Put three gates in front of input:

1 **Relevance**: does it serve the real problem I am working on?

1 **Credibility**: do I know where it came from and can I return to the original source?

1 **Actionability**: what concrete action will I take after reading it?

If a piece fails all three gates, do not save it yet. A smaller collection is not a refusal to learn; it leaves attention for material that matters.

Use three zones:

Zone	Purpose	Limit
Inbox	Hold links, ideas, and sources not yet judged	Empty weekly; never grow without limit
Workbench	Material required for the current task	One main question at a time
Archive	Verified material that may be reused	Record source, date, and purpose

Without zones, everything pretends to require attention now.

3. Leave Your Version Before Using AI

AI is useful for expanding options, explaining difficulty, and finding blind spots. It can also show you a fluent answer too early. Once the answer appears, it can cover the original confusion and make it hard to tell what you actually learned.

Before each AI session, write three lines:

1 What do I currently understand?

1 What am I most uncertain about?

1 What result would prove that I learned it?

Let AI handle process work: questions, examples, parallel tasks, contradictions, and simulated audiences. Do not hand over every important choice at once.

After using AI, run a screen-off test. Close the conversation and explain, code, write, or decide without prompts. If you cannot continue without the original chat, you have a temporary scaffold, not yet an independent ability.

4. Let the Environment Protect Focus

Focus does not happen only inside the mind. Reduce unnecessary choices in the environment:

1 handle messages and news in fixed windows;

1 keep only current-task files and windows on the workbench;

1 define a start condition and an end condition for each task;

1 use a 25–45 minute time box, then decide whether to continue;

1 put the phone somewhere that requires standing up to retrieve it;

1 prepare an offline or fallback version for deep work.

The purpose is not ritual. It is reducing the cost of deciding what to do again after every switch.

If work requires constant response, do not pretend you have uninterrupted focus. Cut tasks into smaller savable units and leave state at every handoff. Reality deserves more respect than an ideal schedule.

5. Attention in Relationships

Attention is not only a productivity issue. It is also a relationship issue. When someone keeps looking at a screen while you speak, what you feel is not “they are efficient”. It is “I am not really here with them”.

In an important conversation, say what you can offer:

1 “I want to hear you fully. Let’s put our phones aside.”

1 “I can talk for 20 minutes, and I will be present for those 20 minutes.”

1 “Let me listen first, then decide whether advice is useful.”

1 “I cannot handle this today. I will reply at a specific time.”

Boundaries make attention trustworthy. They protect you and save others from guessing whether you are present.

6. A Weekly Attention Audit

Do not end a review with “I was busy”. Write down where time and attention went:

Area	Facts this week	Result	Adjustment next week
Input	Main topics in reading, meetings, video, and chat	What changed my judgment?	Keep/delete what?
Switching	What interrupted me most?	What needed rework?	Which entrance closes?
Output	Work or decisions preserved	Who used or reviewed them?	Next smallest delivery
Relationships	Conversations where I was present	Which boundaries need explaining?	Schedule one full conversation
Body	Sleep, movement, and energy	When was I clearest?	Adjust work and rest

An audit is not a score. It shows how the system shapes behaviour. A pattern repeated for three weeks matters more than one emotional day.

Copy this table into the Attention Audit in the Life Practice Toolkit, then put next week's single experiment into the 90-Day Cycle Map.

7. Seven Days to Reset Attention

If information feels like it is flooding you, run a small seven-day experiment:

1. **Day 1**: list subscriptions and notifications; keep only entrances that serve the current goal;
2. **Day 2**: protect 25 minutes without switching for one important task;
3. **Day 3**: sort the inbox into delete, workbench, and archive;
4. **Day 4**: write your three lines before AI, then run a screen-off retest;
5. **Day 5**: finish one real delivery under 45 minutes;
6. **Day 6**: have a 20-minute screen-free conversation with someone important;
7. **Day 7**: audit attention and choose one experiment for next week.

You do not need to disconnect completely. Notice which entrances move you toward your goal and which ones pull you away automatically when you are tired.

8. Signs of Growing Attention

Better attention does not mean you never drift. More reliable signs are:

1. I can name the most important question instead of only saying "I am busy";

1 I can decline input unrelated to the current goal;

1 I preserve my own judgment before and after using AI;

1 I can cut work into a result that can be saved and handed over;

1 I can say when I am present and when I need to leave a conversation;

1 I adjust the environment from weekly facts instead of only blaming myself.

These skills return boundaries to learning, work, and life. A boundary does not shut the world out. It gives what matters a chance to be heard.

Closing: Give Attention to What Deserves It

We cannot control every message, change, or expectation. We can slowly reclaim some attention and give it to a real book, a person who needs us present, a piece of work worth finishing, and the self we keep postponing.

AI can speed up many steps. It cannot decide what deserves to be seen, heard, done, or loved for a long time.

Choose first, then focus. Be present first, then move.

Artifacts: Turn Learning into Something Made

“I have learned it” is a comfortable feeling, and an easy one to misread. As long as you keep reading, saving, and listening, familiarity keeps appearing. The harder test is whether you can close the material and make something another person can see, use, question, and improve.

I understood this after the software company failed. We had features, demos, and meetings, but not enough reliable evidence of user value, data foundations, or delivery. When I returned to AI and technical learning, I added one gate: **every learning cycle must leave an artifact that can be inspected.**

An artifact does not have to be a product. It can be an email, recording, report, process map, small tool, presentation, or sourced essay. What they share is that they place understanding in front of reality and allow another person to use, question, or improve it.

Quick Overview

1. distinguish knowing, doing, and delivering;
1. use a small artifact to expose problems before a grand project;
1. give every artifact an audience, situation, acceptance criteria, and version;
1. let AI speed up decomposition, feedback, and testing while preserving your first draft and key judgments;
1. publish, retest, and review so artifacts become trustworthy evidence over time.

1. Three Meanings of “Know”

Learning contains at least three states:

1. **Know**: you can read a definition, hear an explanation, or recognise an answer;
2. **Do**: you can complete a task independently under similar conditions;
3. **Deliver**: you can complete, explain, revise, and hand over work under real constraints.

Moving from knowing to doing needs retrieval and repetition. Moving from doing to delivering needs an audience, time, quality criteria, and responsibility. Many courses reach only the first state; professional ability begins testing reality in the third.

Ask:

> If I cannot open search or chat now, what can I make? Who will see it? What counts as complete?

2. Choose the Artifact Size

Start with a size that fits your actual time:

Size	Time	Example	Main test
Micro	10–30 minutes	Three English sentences, one test, one process sketch	Do I understand the smallest concept?
Small	1–3 hours	Work email, short report, runnable script	Can I complete and explain it independently?
Project	1–2 weeks	Tool prototype, presentation, content series	Will a real audience use or review it?
Portfolio	4–12 weeks	Sourced report, course, pilot, portfolio	Can I deliver and transfer it reliably?

A small artifact is not a lower standard. It buys feedback early. A problem visible in two hours is cheaper than a wrong direction discovered after two months.

3. One-Page Artifact Brief

Write one page before you begin:

```
# Artifact Brief — YYYY-MM-DD

Artifact name:
Real situation:
Audience/user:
One problem to solve:

Inputs and sources:
My current baseline:
Key assumptions:

Smallest deliverable:
Format and constraints:
Acceptance criteria:
What this will not include:

First-version deadline:
Who will give feedback:
Evidence to preserve:
How to shrink, pause, or roll back:
Next review date:
```

“What this will not include” matters as much as “acceptance criteria”. It resists feature creep and makes feedback concrete.

4. Four Passes Through an Artifact

Pass One: Independent Version

Complete it without an answer key or AI writing it for you. It may be slow and rough, but preserve the original. Without a first version, you cannot compare growth.

Pass Two: Structure Version

Check whether the audience knows the problem and next step, whether information is ordered by importance, whether facts and guesses are separate, and whether failure paths are explained. Fix structure before sentences and colour.

Pass Three: Feedback Version

Give it to a real person, a small group of users, or an AI playing a defined reviewer role. Ask: What helped? What caused confusion? Which change matters most first?

Pass Four: Delivery Version

Revise from feedback and record the version, limits, sources, and known issues. Let another person begin without your oral explanation, even if they can complete only one small action.

5. AI’s Place in the Artifact

AI can be four kinds of assistant:

1. **decomposer**: break a goal into steps and acceptance conditions;
1. **practice partner**: generate parallel tasks in different contexts;
1. **reviewer**: question audience, facts, structure, quality, and risk;
1. **tester**: create edge inputs, counterexamples, and failure paths.

Keep these parts human: define the problem, choose the audience, write the first version, verify facts, decide what to remove, and sign the result.

A useful sequence:

1. Write the brief and first version yourself;
2. ask AI to identify only the three issues most affecting the result;

3. revise yourself and preserve the difference;
4. ask AI for a parallel situation or counterexample;
5. close AI and complete a retest independently;
6. write sources, feedback, cost, and open questions back into the record.

If AI delivers the final artifact immediately, you may get a beautiful file while losing the most important training.

6. Quality Gates

Different artifacts need different standards, but check five gates:

1. **clear**: the audience knows the problem and next action;
1. **accurate**: facts, citations, code, and numbers return to a source or test;
1. **usable**: the main action works under real constraints, not only in a demo;
1. **maintainable**: version, dependencies, limits, and owner are visible;
1. **responsible**: sensitive data, privacy, copyright, and consequences of error are considered.

Speed, word count, and feature count are proxy measures. A smaller artifact that is explainable, reviewable, and revisable usually has more long-term value than a grand deliverable nobody can hand over.

7. Publishing Is Information, Not Performance

Publishing does not mean giving your privacy to everyone. Choose an audience by risk:

1. private record: preserve process and errors for yourself;
1. small pilot: give it to three to five relevant people and record whether they can complete the task;
1. public version: remove unnecessary personal data and state sources, limits, and version;
1. formal delivery: state permission, responsibility, support, cost, and exit terms.

Before publishing, ask: Do I have permission? Did I redact third-party information? Am I packaging an unverified personal story as proof of results? Honest limits do not reduce an artifact’s value. They make feedback more trustworthy.

8. Seven-Day Artifact Start

1 **Day 1**: choose a real problem from something you are learning;

2 **Day 2**: write the artifact brief and unaided baseline;

3 **Day 3**: finish the first version of a micro or small artifact;

4 **Day 4**: ask AI or a partner for the three highest-value issues;

5 **Day 5**: revise yourself and add sources, limits, and failure paths;

6 **Day 6**: give it to one real audience member to use or read;

7 **Day 7**: record feedback, decide the next version’s scope, and preserve the evidence.

If all you can finish in seven days is one page, a recording, or a runnable small script, you have still completed a learning-to-delivery loop.

9. A 12-Week Artifact Ladder

1 **Weeks 1–2**: complete four micro artifacts and confirm the topic and situation;

1 **Weeks 3–5**: complete two small artifacts and begin gathering real feedback;

1 **Weeks 6–8**: expand one small artifact into a usable prototype and record cost and failure;

1 **Weeks 9–12**: make one public or formal delivery and retest with blind review, user feedback, or a parallel task.

Preserve the original, revised, and reviewed versions at each level. The number of artifacts is not the point. The signal is whether you can explain how you moved from a problem to a result.

10. Signs of a Real Artifact

You do not need to wait for perfection. A useful stage result usually has:

1 a defined audience and situation;

1 an observable acceptance criterion;

1 an unaided original version;

1 feedback from a person, test, or source;

1 a version, limit, and next step;

1. an explanation of key decisions without the chat history.

When another person can see, use, and question the work, learning has left the mind and entered the world.

Ask Again After Delivery

Delivery proves immediate performance under one set of conditions. It does not prove retention or transfer. After finishing an artifact, open Evidence: How Change Becomes Visible and schedule one retest with recent prompts removed plus one transfer task with a new topic, audience, or constraint. Keep the original, delivered, and retested versions so you can see the work leave a demo and enter real use.

Closing: Let the Artifact Remember

Knowledge fades, emotions change, and chats disappear. An artifact is another kind of memory. It reminds you which problem you faced, what you chose, where you failed, and how you turned the failure into a next step.

I no longer see finishing an artifact as proving that I am impressive. It is more like leaving a light for my future self. When I doubt whether I can begin again, something real can answer: I have done this once.

Evidence: How Change Becomes Visible

People easily mistake familiarity for ability, a completed streak for progress, and one smooth conversation for having learned. The difficult work is not collecting more numbers. It is knowing which traces can answer the question in front of you. When you need to record one task end to end, use the Evidence Chain Template.

I write about evidence not to turn life into a cold dashboard. Evidence gives us less room for self-deception and less reason for unsupported self-blame. It shows where something has changed, where a result is only temporary fluency, where a method needs to change, and where further investment should stop.

What This Chapter Covers

1 Evidence returns to a concrete task, condition, and time instead of a context-free score;

1 baseline, immediate performance, delayed retention, and transfer form one chain;

1 AI-assisted and independent performance stay separate, including who owns judgment at handover;

1 failure, rework, and conditions where a method does not apply are evidence too;

1 life changes cannot all be measured, but they can be recorded with honest observation and boundaries;

1 one main question is enough for a seven-day review; more records should not replace action.

1. Evidence Is Not a Report Card

A report card answers “how many points under one set of rules?” Evidence answers “under what conditions, what did I complete, can another person inspect it, and can I do it again?” The two sometimes overlap, but they are never identical.

Saving ten articles does not prove that you can explain one concept. Writing code with AI does not prove that you can maintain it without the chat history. Waking early for seven days does not automatically prove that your life has more order. These are clues. They need to return to a task.

A useful piece of evidence can answer four questions:

Question	What to state	What happens without it
Can it be traced?	Where are the sample, source, version, and date?	The result survives only in memory
Does it have conditions?	What topic, audience, time, tool, and limits applied?	Different conditions look like one level
Can it be compared?	Did both attempts keep a similar task?	Change cannot be explained or checked
Can it transfer?	Can the action survive a new topic, person, or setting?	Fluency stays trapped in the practice item

Evidence is not for ranking people. It makes the next choice less blind.

2. Keep Four Time Points

For one task, preserve four states when possible. They do not need to be long. They do need to say who provided what help and when.

Time point	Purpose	Example
Baseline	See what you can do before concentrated practice or tool support	Explain a familiar work process without notes
Immediate performance	Observe the task just after practice or feedback	Record again after seeing a demonstration
Delayed retention	Return later without the most recent prompt	Repeat a similar task with new material after seven days
Transfer sample	Change topic, audience, medium, or constraint	Turn an internal explanation into a short client update

If you keep only immediate performance, you will overestimate yourself most easily. If you keep only the final artifact, you forget how you moved from not knowing to knowing. The four time points together form a more explainable trajectory.

3. Do Not Confuse Three Results

Learning often produces three different results: **you can do it**, **you can still do it later**, and **you can use it somewhere else**. They are related, but need different checks.

1. **Performance**: Can you complete the task today? Inspect errors, time, and outside help;
1. **Retention**: Can you complete it after an interval? Remove the recent hints and keep similar difficulty;
1. **Transfer**: Can you complete the action when its surface changes? Change topic, person, order, or pressure.

For example, writing an English email with AI may show reasonable immediate performance. Writing a similar email the next day without the original shows retention. Clarifying a real customer's question in unfamiliar wording begins to show transfer. Do not use the first result to stamp the other two.

4. When AI Enters, Record the Human Gate

AI changes speed and changes the nature of the task. Record more than the model name. Record which judgments a person still owns:

Condition	What the person must do	Evidence focus
Unaided version	Complete a first version without looking at AI	Baseline, errors, and where you got stuck
Assisted version	Let AI question, explain, compare, or give feedback	Prompts, sources, edits, reasons, and rework
Handover version	Explain, maintain, or continue the work after closing the chat	Key decisions, permissions, tests, and owner

If AI produces the final answer directly, add a retest after removing the tool. A correct answer you cannot explain is not yet an ability you own. An automation nobody can hand over is not yet a system you can safely run.

That is why this guide repeatedly asks you to preserve the AI Task Brief, Artifact Brief and Delivery Card, and Learning State. They are not paperwork. They keep the human gate and responsibility boundary visible.

5. Write Failure and Rework into the Evidence

Showing only smooth versions makes a method look simpler than life. A failure provides at least three kinds of information: which condition did not hold, which hypothesis was disproved, and which risk to reduce next time.

Do not write only "I did not do well." Write:

```
Task and conditions:
I originally assumed:
What actually happened:
The earliest error:
What the rework cost:
The one variable I will change next:
What result would make me stop investing:
```

The number of reworks is not an ability score. One timely rework may protect a user or a relationship; repairing an unworthy task again and again may be a way to avoid a more important decision. Evidence matters because it lets cost participate in the next choice.

6. Do Not Turn Life into a Dashboard

Some changes suit counting: deliveries completed, delayed-retest accuracy, or whether a test passes. Other changes should not be compressed into one score: asking for help earlier, causing less harm in a relationship, or finally stopping when exhaustion arrives.

For those changes, record observations closer to fact:

1. In what situation did I notice overload earlier than before?
1. Did I tell affected people about a boundary instead of disappearing?
1. After a conflict, what repair did I attempt, and what happened?
1. Did protecting rest prevent one high-risk decision?
1. Which changes are visible only to me, and which have others observed?

These questions have no common score, and they do not ask you to turn relationships or the body into KPIs. They help turn “I seem different” into a privacy-respecting account that can admit uncertainty.

7. Use Evidence to Choose the Next Step, Not to Judge Your Worth

Evidence can show whether a method worked under one condition. It cannot show whether a person deserves love or a second beginning. A failed recording, a missed test, or a week without practice is not a verdict on character.

During a weekly review, ask in this order:

1. What are the facts? Write only what returns to a file, source, or direct observation;
2. Which interpretation is most useful? Keep at least one plausible counterexample;
3. Which one variable changes next? Do not change the material, tool, time, and goal at once;
4. What support or boundary is required? Include peers, professionals, permission, and pause conditions;
5. When is the retest? Let date, setting, and completion standard precede mood.

When evidence is weak, do not rush to score yourself. Narrowing the question and saving a better baseline is more honest than manufacturing a precise conclusion from thin data.

8. One-Page Evidence Chain

Compress one learning or life action into this page:

```
# Evidence Chain — YYYY-MM-DD

Main question:
Real context and affected people:
Completion standard:

Baseline sample (conditions / location / date):
Immediate performance (what I did / what help I received):
Delayed retention (when / which prompts were removed):
Transfer sample (which condition changed):

Most important error or failure:
Conclusion supported by evidence:
What is still a hypothesis:
Privacy, permission, health, or relationship boundary:
The one variable I will change next:
Retest date and stop condition:
```

Link this page to the Weekly Review and the 90-Day Cycle Map. At the end of a cycle, place it beside the first sample. Keep the version that was wrong, not only the sentence that summarises it.

9. A Seven-Day Evidence Audit

Check one thing per day:

1. **Day 1**: save an unaided baseline;
2. **Day 2**: state the task conditions and completion standard;
3. **Day 3**: complete one assisted practice and record what AI actually did;
4. **Day 4**: close the tool and redo a small part independently;
5. **Day 5**: invite a counterexample from a person, test, or source;
6. **Day 6**: change the topic or audience and attempt transfer;
7. **Day 7**: compare the four time points and choose one variable for the next cycle.

After seven days, you may not feel that you have improved dramatically. You will know more clearly where change occurred and where it did not. That clarity is an ability: it keeps the next step from depending on excitement or shame.

Evidence is not an ending. It is an entrance into the next responsibility. When the method is ready for technical or enterprise delivery, continue to AI Development and Resource-layer Business and let users, cost, failure, and handover test the result. When an ability is ready for a full cycle, enter the 90-Day Action Plan. If a concept remains unclear, return to the Glossary of Terms and Methods instead of increasing commitment around an uncertain definition.

Closing: Let Change Be Seen Honestly

Many important changes in a life receive no applause: a hurtful message you did not send, a timely request for help, an apology finally completed, or a delivery that protected a boundary while you were tired. They may not belong in a chart, but they deserve to be remembered.

I hope evidence finally gives us not surveillance, but gentle credibility. I know where I began, what I did today, and which conclusions are not ready to be written. With that credibility, we do not need to inflate an accidental success into talent, or expand one failure into fate.

Change does not happen because it is recorded. Recording gives us a chance to recognise it after it happens and carry it into the next part of life.

AI Learning, Project Development, and Resource-layer Entrepreneurship

My name is Han Xiankai, also known online as Li Pu. Many readers first found me through this English-learning project and later through my writing about software entrepreneurship, failure, recovery, and beginning again. I now disclose my role as chairman of China Token Cloud Computing Co., Ltd. and place the next stage of my work inside a more concrete question: **as AI becomes a general capability, how can an ordinary person move from learner to builder, then from builder to an entrepreneur in the resource layer?**

This is not a story about getting rich easily with AI, and it contains no return promise. It is a working map under real-world testing: what has happened, what methods may transfer, and what business outcomes must still be answered by real users, real costs, real incidents, and time. When the company failed in 2022, I saw how features that looked like AI could hide missing data, weak architecture, and unclear responsibility. Today's gates grew out of that failure.

Keep Fact, Practice, and Result Separate

1. **Already true**: I serve as chairman of China Token Cloud Computing Co., Ltd. The current homepage describes `token.love` as a unified AI gateway for enterprise and government-related scenarios, listing model access, routing and failover, usage metering, audit trails, and private/offline deployment.
1. **In practice**: I use AI to learn, decompose requirements, develop projects, write tests, organise documentation, and deliver work while testing those methods in team and enterprise settings.
1. **Still unverified**: whether customers will keep paying, whether unit economics will hold, whether supplier changes can be managed, and whether revenue can cover the risk.

When fact, judgment, and aspiration are mixed together, an entrepreneurship essay becomes an advertisement. Separating them makes an honest retrospective possible. When you analyse a public experience, use the AI Case Review Template to record the source and facts before writing judgment or transfer.

How the 2022 Failure Changed Today's Gates

The problem was not a lack of code. We failed to prove the core capability, dataset, performance, security, and user value first. UI work, multi-platform support, and preset results made the product look complete, but could not answer where data came from, how results were verified, or who owned failure.

Every AI project now starts with five questions:

1. **Is the capability real?** Is it a model, retrieval, a rule, or a human process? Do not replace the explanation with a marketing label.
2. **May the data be used?** Are source, permission, sensitivity, retention, and deletion clear?
3. **How is the result accepted?** What are the test samples, edge cases, human review, and real-user standard?
4. **Can the cost be covered?** Are model, network, engineering, support, rework, compliance, and incident costs in the ledger?
5. **How do we leave safely?** Who can pause, degrade, switch, notify, roll back, and review?

If these questions have no answer, the next action is not more features. Narrow the problem and run an experiment that could disprove the assumption.

1. From Learner to Builder

I once treated English learning as accumulating more knowledge. Eventually I learned that the destination is not a larger collection of answers but the ability to complete a task independently. Learning with AI is the same. The result is not the length of a model's response. It is whether I can close the conversation, explain the important decisions, run the program, face the errors, and deliver the work.

I now use a working loop:

1. **State a real problem**: identify who has the problem and what counts as done;
2. **Save an unaided baseline**: expose knowledge gaps, constraints, and blind spots;
3. **Prepare trustworthy context**: provide documentation, data, existing code, organisational policy, and risk boundaries;
4. **Use AI to decompose**: compare options, create small experiments, and explain assumptions without outsourcing judgment;

5. **Build and verify actively**: use AI for prototypes, code, refactoring, tests, documentation, and debugging;
6. **Collect plural feedback**: tests, users, domain experts, sources, and security review decide together;
7. **Save state and evidence**: record completion, errors, cost, decisions, and the smallest next action.

This extends Learning Anything with AI, but project development adds one hard rule: **every critical decision must be testable, explainable, or reversible**.

2. Building Projects with AI: Quality After Speed

AI can generate apparently complete code in minutes and spread a bad assumption across a system in minutes. My approach is not to replace the developer, but to treat AI as a high-frequency collaborator that can be questioned and must pass acceptance.

2.1 The project brief

Create a one-page `task-brief.md` for each project:

```
# Task Brief

Real situation:
User/audience:
Decision or action to complete:
Deadline:

Known facts and sources:
Files allowed:
Data sensitivity: public / internal / confidential / restricted
Material deliberately withheld:

Final deliverable:
Format and length:
Acceptance criteria:
Items a person must confirm:

AI may:
AI may not:
Human reviewers:
Rollback or stop condition:
```

“Good experience”, “advanced architecture”, and “high intelligence” are not acceptance criteria. Use observable actions such as “a user can import a file and see an error report within ten minutes”.

2.2 An inspectable delivery chain

Stage	AI may assist with	A person must confirm
Requirements	Structure the user, scenario, constraints, and questions	Whether the problem is real and the outcome observable
Design	Propose architecture, interfaces, and minimum experiments	Data boundaries, dependencies, failure modes, and long-term cost
Prototype	Generate pages, interfaces, scripts, and sample data	Whether it solves the core task rather than merely looking good
Implementation	Complete code, explain changes, and generate tests	Critical logic, permissions, error handling, and maintainability
Validation	Run tests, static analysis, performance, and security checks	Whether tests cover real risks and results are reproducible
Delivery	Prepare documentation, deployment, change records, and rollback	Whether users can work, teams can take over, and failures can be traced

Advance one logical slice at a time. Do not mix requirements, refactoring, formatting, and dependency upgrades. Preserve an unaided baseline, a working artefact, and an error/revision record so that speed can be distinguished from ability.

2.3 Code and release gates

```
Here is the task brief and current code structure. Do not write code yet.
Propose two minimal implementation options and compare requirement coverage, change sco
Mark missing information and inference. Recommend only one slice that can be verified i
```

Before release preserve a version, change summary, migration steps, monitored signals, rollback trigger, owner, and user notice. Review by severity for requirement drift, data loss, permission bypass, injection, races, error handling, performance, maintainability, and test gaps.

Complete the AI Project Scorecard after each pilot or release and keep an unaided baseline, assisted version, and delayed independent retest. Without all three, you cannot tell whether the tool created ability, outsourcing, or rework.

3. What Is the AI Resource Layer?

Models provide capabilities and applications provide the results users see. Between them lies infrastructure that makes capabilities accessible, controllable, measurable, and sustainable. I call this the **AI resource layer**.

It is more than reselling a model endpoint. It organises models, accounts, compute, data boundaries, and operating processes into a service a team can understand, use, and govern.

3.1 Capability map

Resource-layer capability	Customer problem	Minimum evidence to verify it
Multi-model access and routing	The business is locked to one supplier	Routing rules and comparison records for one task across two models
Identity, permissions, and quotas	Usage and accountability are unclear	Role matrix, quota policy, and audit-log sample
Metering, cost, and billing	Teams use AI without cost visibility	Cost report by team/project/request and reconciliation process
Deployment and operation	Service cannot enter approved environments	Deployment checklist, environment differences, and rollback drill
Observability and incidents	Latency, failure, and quality shifts cannot be explained	Request logs, error categories, alerts, and handling records
Data and compliance boundaries	Sensitive data flow and retention are unclear	Data-flow map, retention rules, approvals, and deletion evidence
Integration and support	Capability never enters the business process	Integration acceptance, on-call path, support tickets, and handover

For the customer, the value is not one more model name. It is less duplicated integration, less uncontrolled cost, fewer interruptions when suppliers change, and a responsibility boundary the organisation can understand and govern.

3.2 The request lifecycle

This reference architecture is not a product promise. Every resource-layer service should be able to explain how a request moves:

identity → permission and quota → data check → routing decision → model call → output filter → metering record → monitoring/alert → user delivery

Each step must answer who owns it, what is recorded, what happens on failure, how long data is retained, and whether the request can be replayed or deleted. Interface forwarding without metering, permissions, logs, degradation, and audit is not reliable enterprise service.

3.3 Routing is not "choose the strongest model"

Routing should follow the task and its constraints:

1 for low-risk, high-volume, stable tasks, consider cost and latency first;

1 for complex reasoning or long context, compare quality, limits, and failure rate;

1 for sensitive data, check approved scope, deployment location, and logging policy;

1 during supplier failure, use degradation, retry, switching, or human takeover;

1 record the version, reason, sample, and rollback for every routing change.

The strongest model is not always the right model if it is unstable, unauditable, or unaffordable.

4. China Token Cloud and token.love: A Business Path in Practice

China Token Cloud Computing Co., Ltd. is the company in which I currently serve as chairman. The current homepage describes `token.love` as a unified AI gateway for enterprise and government-related scenarios, listing model access, routing and failover, usage metering, audit trails, and private/offline deployment. This is a homepage product-positioning statement, not an endorsement from any third party, and it does not replace formal documentation, compliance approval, contracts, or a customer's own security review.

From a resource-layer perspective, the path can be expressed as:

model and compute resources → unified access and routing → permissions, metering, and governance → enterprise integration → operations and continuing support

A real product helps the customer understand where capability comes from, how cost is created, where data travels, who handles incidents, and whether migration remains possible. Specific capabilities, regions, plans, compliance scope, and service commitments must be verified against the current token.love documentation and written agreement.

5. Enterprise Pilots: Solve One Acceptable Problem First

5.1 Discovery

Do not begin with a model demo. Ask:

1 what the current process is and which step is slowest or most error-prone;

1 who bears the cost, how often it occurs, and what an error affects;

1 which data may be used and which data must never leave the organisation;

1 which accounts, contracts, networks, permissions, and security requirements already exist;

1 who will continue to use, approve, and pay if the pilot works;

1 what result means “continue” and what result means “stop”.

Produce a one-page problem brief, not a one-page AI value statement.

5.2 Pilot

A credible pilot has scope, sample, non-goals, data boundary, owners, dates, acceptance criteria, failure exit, and a cost ceiling. Preserve the old-process baseline: human time, error rate, waiting time, rework, current cost, and user satisfaction.

During the pilot record model calls, routing, latency, failures, human takeovers, support hours, data exceptions, rework, and user feedback. Recording generated content alone cannot prove business improvement.

Use the AI Project Scorecard to log test conditions, cost, independent performance, and release gates by version, so the pilot does not end as a single demo.

5.3 Acceptance and handover

Split acceptance into four layers:

1 **Function**: can the flow complete and are errors visible?

2 **Quality**: does output meet the business standard and can a person take over?

3 **Security**: do permissions, logs, retention, deletion, and audit pass?

4 **Operations**: who handles upgrades, incidents, cost, supplier switching, and support?

The handover package should contain architecture, data flow, permissions, environment variables, deployment, monitoring, on-call path, rollback, known issues, and the next review date.

6. How the Business Might Earn Money

Revenue does not come from renaming a model and adding a margin. It comes from assuming work that is expensive, fragmented, or difficult for the customer to manage. Possible value exchanges include:

1 **resource-management services**: manage model access, quotas, and costs by request, team, project, or service level;

1 **integration and delivery**: connect existing systems and complete deployment, permissions, logs, and acceptance;

1 **managed operations**: handle upgrades, incidents, quality shifts, supplier changes, and daily support;

1 **governance and security**: establish data boundaries, approval, audit, traceability, and risk response;

1 **custom projects and training**: take a real business problem through design, prototype, launch, and handover.

These are not revenue promises. They are charging interfaces that can be tested one by one. Each must answer why the customer will pay, how the result will be accepted, and whether service cost can be covered over time.

6.1 Charging interfaces and use cases

Charging interface	Suitable problem	Main risk	Evidence to record
One-off discovery/design fee	Clarify workflow, boundaries, and pilot	No value after the plan is delivered	Deliverable, hours, and continuation signal
Implementation fee	Integration, deployment, permissions, acceptance	Every customer becomes a new custom build	Scope, changes, rework, and contribution space
Usage/resource-management fee	Ongoing calls, projects, or team governance	Supplier prices and volume fluctuate	Calls, routing, cost, reconciliation, and caps
Subscription/service tier	Continuing operations, support, and governance	Promises exceed team capacity	Response time, availability target, support hours, exceptions
Training/advisory fee	Build team capability and governance	Learning does not become use	Objectives, work, transfer, and retest

Formal agreements govern actual service. This public chapter discusses business logic without inventing prices, profits, customer counts, or return results.

6.2 The cost ledger

Resource-layer businesses can see demand while failing to see cost. Record models and compute, networking and storage, engineering, customer support, acquisition, compliance, security, incident compensation, supplier price changes, migration, taxes, and management time.

```
contribution space = customer revenue
                   - models and infrastructure
                   - engineering and support
                   - acquisition and compliance
                   - incidents, rework, and refunds
```

Separate one-off cost from continuing cost. One-off projects are judged by delivery efficiency; continuing services by retention, support intensity, unit cost, and continuation signals. If every new customer adds calls, labour, and risk without enough value, scale can accelerate the loss.

7. Operations: No Runbook, No Enterprise Service

7.1 Minimum operations dashboard

1 request volume, success rate, failure categories, and retries;

1 latency distribution rather than only an average;

1 cost by model, team, project, and task;

1 quota breaches, data exceptions, permission denials, and human takeovers;

1 supplier status, routing changes, and version changes;

1 user feedback, support hours, and recurring problems.

These are recommended operating signals, not a claim that `token.love` currently provides all of them. Before launch, write indicators, owners, alert thresholds, and retention into the project agreement or internal runbook.

7.2 Incident handling

```
discover → assess impact → pause risky changes → degrade/switch/take over
         → notify affected people → preserve logs and timeline → repair and verify
         → review root cause, cost, prevention → update the runbook
```

Record discovery time, affected projects, recent changes, data risk, temporary action, supplier status, recovery time, customer communication, root-cause hypothesis, and permanent repair evidence. AI can structure a timeline; it cannot replace the incident owner.

7.3 Supplier-switching drills

For each critical supplier prepare a backup route, degradation model, rate limit, cache or human process, data-migration plan, contract contact, and rollback test. Run a low-risk drill at least quarterly to verify that “switchable” is more than a sentence in a document.

8. Data, Security, and Compliance Boundaries

Data level	Examples	Default handling
Public	Published documents, public code, public data	Usable after checking source and licence
Internal	Unpublished plans, process, non-sensitive logs	Approved tools only; limit members and retention
Confidential	Customer records, contracts, strategy, unpublished vulnerabilities	Do not upload without explicit approval; prefer local processing or redaction
Restricted	Keys, identity/health data, children's data, third-party privacy	Keep out of general models; follow policy and applicable law

A resource-layer service must answer where data enters, which suppliers see it, which logs are retained, who can read them, when data is deleted, and how deletion is evidenced. Deleting one file does not remove every history, cache, export, or backup.

9. A Twelve-week Validation Route

Time	Central question	Action	Evidence to preserve
Weeks 1–2	Which organisations have an urgent, specific problem?	Interview, observe the old process, map data	Interview notes, baseline, boundaries, stop condition
Weeks 3–5	Can a minimum product reduce integration or management cost?	Build a sandbox, connect one task, run comparison tests	Working prototype, tests, failures, cost
Weeks 6–8	Will the customer keep using a real process?	Small pilot, human takeover, weekly review	Usage traces, incidents, support hours, security record
Weeks 9–10	Can another person reproduce delivery?	Handover, deployment, rollback drill	Runbook, permission table, handover acceptance
Weeks 11–12	Do cost, quality, and charging form a combination?	Review, pricing experiment, continuation discussion	Cost ledger, proposal, continuation signal, next decision

When evidence does not support continuing, narrow the problem, change the customer, or stop. When it does, complete security, contracts, permissions, monitoring, and handover before expanding.

10. Two Public-writing Practice Slices: From “Abstract” to “Frame by Frame”

Two WeChat articles about me approach AI from different directions: one is a profile of a thinking style; the other is a narrative about handling a noisy comment stream. They are not technical audits, customer case studies, or proof of income. I use them as public narrative material and translate their useful moves into experiments with explicit limits.

10.1 Refuse the first “most likely” answer

On 11 August 2026, TokenMany published “Han Xiankai: The Most ‘Abstract’ Human in AI”. It describes “abstract” as refusing ready-made answers and allowing technology, business, human behaviour, and daily life to illuminate one another. That is a literary observation about a public persona, not an independent measurement of capability.

I turn the transferable part into development habits:

1. write down the default assumption, then add at least one competing explanation;
2. compress a cross-domain idea into an experiment that can run in one or two hours;
3. mark which observations are facts and which are analogies, intuitions, or hypotheses;
4. let the experiment disprove an attractive idea and keep the failed sample in the project record.

This keeps “having a wild idea” from ending as a style of expression. The idea must pass through problem definition, a minimum prototype, tests, and retrospective before it becomes evidence another person can inspect.

10.2 Turn noise into a question that can be answered

On 21 August 2026, Wanli Center published “Han Xiankai and AI: Splitting the Noise into Emotion, Frame by Frame”. In its narrative, comments are classified one by one and annotated with “claim, evidence, emotional intensity, expression, and answerability”; insults are first treated as “emotion samples”. This does not prove that a public-opinion product was delivered or that the analysis improved an outcome. It offers a feedback-processing frame worth testing cautiously.

In a real project I would constrain it to this workflow:

Step	AI may assist with	A person remains responsible for
Collect	deduplication, clustering, and recurring themes	source, permission, data minimisation, and deletion deadline

Step	AI may assist with	A person remains responsible for
Separate	distinguishing claims, guesses, emotion words, and rhetorical tactics	checking evidence and refusing to turn labels into conclusions
Prioritise	ordering by impact, urgency, and answerability	setting priority, risk, and escalation
Respond	drafting several restrained replies aimed at a specific issue	facts, privacy, responsibility, and publication scope
Review	summarising changes, recurring misunderstandings, and open issues	deciding whether to change the product, clarify, pause, or stop

Comments, tickets, and customer feedback may contain personal data. Without permission, do not send whole conversations, names, contact details, or identifying context to a general model. Even public data should be redacted, access-limited, and assigned a retention period. AI can queue the noise; it cannot decide who is right or carry responsibility for a public response.

The shared lesson from these articles is simple: creativity supplies a different entry point, while evidence decides whether to continue. Emotion deserves to be seen, but it enters a product or enterprise process only after facts, privacy, and responsibility have done their work.

11. Where the Path Loses Control

1 treating model output as fact and a demonstration as product quality;

1 mistaking one-off project revenue for a sustainable business;

1 counting API cost while ignoring support, rework, compliance, sales, and management time;

1 uploading customer data, company secrets, or third-party private material to an unapproved tool;

1 becoming locked to one model or supplier without migration, degradation, or incident plans;

1 promising response time, availability, or compliance that the team cannot reliably provide;

1 presenting an affiliated product as an independent review or hiding the relationship;

1 using more prompts to cover the absence of a real user, real cost, or real acceptance.

This project will keep a few simple rules: sources remain traceable, interests are disclosed, results can be retested, risks are not romanticised, and unknowns are named as unknowns.

12. What I Hope to Leave Behind

Even if this path does not become a large enough business, it should leave three things:

1. a method that helps me and the team learn and build faster without abandoning quality;
2. real work that users can use, test, and criticise;
3. a commercial record that does not delete failure, so later readers can see which judgments worked and which were only hopes at the time.

I still want to make money because revenue is one form of evidence that a value exchange can continue. It is not the only value, and it is not an ending that can be announced in advance. The more honest objective is to connect AI capability to real people, real organisations, and real responsibility, then see whether the work deserves to continue.

Sources and Verification

1. **Personal experience**: the 2022 failure, 2023 recovery, and 2026 return to AI are documented in My Story and Entrepreneurship.
1. **Project affiliations**: China Token Cloud, `token.love`, `ku0.com`, and the WeChat articles are disclosed in Author Projects and Real-world Practice; they are not independent reviews.
1. **Commercial claims**: charging models, cost ledgers, and the twelve-week route are methods to test, not proof of revenue, customer count, profit, or investment return.
1. **Official pages checked**: 1 September 2026. The homepage positioning for `token.love` and `ku0.com`, as well as the external article links in this chapter, were reachable; verify exact capability, service scope, region, policy, and contract commitments again in the real project.

Return the Method to Daily Life

This chapter should not leave a reader among product names, architecture diagrams, and charging interfaces. Its useful remainder is a slower, more honest working posture: name the problem, write the boundary, and place a run, a cost, and a failure where they can be inspected.

Whether a project continues is still answered by users, teams, agreements, time, and responsibility. Visit Author Projects and Real-world Practice to check relationships, status, and evidence boundaries; or move directly into Part IV: Practice and Recovery and bring the judgment here back to one small task, one week's rhythm, and one action that can be restarted.

Technology can lay a road quickly. That does not mean a person has travelled it. What carries into the next stretch is not one elegant demonstration, but the ability to keep learning, delivering, and revising under real conditions.

Author Projects and Real-world Practice

This page centralises projects in which Han Xiankai has a direct role so that commercial relationships do not blend into learning-method recommendations. It is disclosure, not a purchase, investment, or return promise.

To analyse a public experience mentioned here, use the AI Case Review Template to separate source, facts, judgment, and unknown outcomes first; project disclosure is not an independent audit.

Status and Evidence Boundaries

Status	Meaning	How a reader should use it
Author affiliation	The author has a stated role or material relationship with a company, product, or article	Treat it as self-disclosure, not an independent review
In practice	Work has begun, but impact, scale, or sustainability is still being tested	Look for samples, costs, user feedback, and failure records
Historical material	An older article, product page, or personal memory	Use it for context, not as current guidance
Unverified	A plan, goal, or judgment without enough public evidence	Wait for formal documents, agreements, users, and time

Project status can change. Each item keeps its own checked date; a page update means the disclosure text was reorganised, not that a product result changed.

China Token Cloud and token.love

1. **Relationship**: Han Xiankai serves as chairman of China Token Cloud Computing Co., Ltd.
1. **Purpose**: The current homepage describes `token.love` as a unified AI gateway for enterprise and government-related scenarios, listing model access, routing and failover, usage metering, audit trails, and private/offline deployment.
1. **Relationship to this guide**: both are maintained by the same author; this is not third-party sponsorship.

1 **Checked**: 2026-08-31. The capability list reflects the homepage checked that day; exact service and compliance scope must still be verified in the formal token.love documentation, approvals, and contract.

Archived token.love product page

AI Learning, Project Development, and Resource-layer Entrepreneurship

Han Xiankai is connecting personal AI learning, AI-assisted development, and China Token Cloud's enterprise-service practice into one working path: begin with a real task; use AI for requirements, prototypes, code, tests, documentation, and delivery; then organise multi-model access, routing, metering, permissions, deployment, and continuing operations into a resource-layer service a team can manage.

This path has a describable product and service direction. That does not mean profitability or scale has been publicly demonstrated. Customer retention, repeatable delivery, and whether revenue can cover model, infrastructure, engineering, support, acquisition, compliance, and incident costs still require evidence from real projects over time.

See AI Learning, Project Development, and Resource-layer Entrepreneurship for the method, business logic, cost boundaries, and twelve-week validation framework. It discusses possible charging models without disclosing or implying unverified revenue, profit, customer counts, or investment returns.

WeChat Articles and Practice Notes

Public articles about the author provide observation and narrative material. They are not independent audits, customer case studies, or proof of commercial results:

1 “Han Xiankai: The Most ‘Abstract’ Human in AI” (TokenMany, 11 August 2026) describes the author through a refusal of ready-made answers, cross-domain

associations, and continued questioning. The project translates that into competing hypotheses, minimum experiments, and preserved failure evidence rather than treating a profile as a capability verdict.

1 "Han Xiankai and AI: Splitting the Noise into Emotion, Frame by Frame" (Wanli Center, 21 August 2026) narrates a way to separate claims, evidence, emotional intensity, expression, and answerability in comments. The project borrows only the problem-decomposition frame and adds redaction, permission, retention, and human review; it does not present the story as validated public-opinion product performance.

The links point to public WeChat pages and were checked on 24 August 2026; platform policy may make a signed link expire. The method and boundaries are documented in AI Learning, Project Development, and Resource-layer Entrepreneurship.

ku0.com

1 **Relationship**: the author participates in the operation and presentation of the project.

1 **Purpose**: The current homepage describes it as an AI resource directory for mainland China businesses and developers, covering relay services, account recharge, asset transactions, model tools, and official references.

1 **Relationship to this guide**: this is neither an independent review nor a recommendation without a material relationship.

1 **Checked**: 2026-08-31. Categories and scope were checked against the homepage that day; availability, region, plans, transactions, and compliance statements must still be verified on ku0.com and in written terms.

AI and Physical-industry Practice

On 16 June 2026, the author visited Alibaba Cloud's Hangzhou headquarters as a company representative and recorded plans to explore AI in agriculture and other physical industries, including free community training. This is a direction and personal commitment, not an Alibaba Cloud endorsement or evidence of completed outcomes.

Visit to Alibaba Cloud headquarters

Recommendation Policy

Core chapters assess tools by task, evidence, privacy, and transfer. An affiliated product receives no higher evidence status and never replaces official documentation, independent comparison, or the reader's security review. Hidden sponsorship is not accepted. Any future paid relationship must identify the party, date, and affected scope next to the claim.

Verification Order

1. Start with current formal documentation, contracts, licences, and applicable policy.
2. Ask how the result will be accepted, how cost is calculated, and how work stops on failure.
3. Treat personal narrative and public profiles as leads, not customer cases or proof of return.
4. For customer, identity, health, or commercial data, confirm permission, minimum necessary scope, and deletion method first.

Part IV: Practice and Recovery

A plan is almost always tidier on paper than it is in life.

Paper has no unexpected call, sleepless night, person who needs care, or afternoon when strength suddenly disappears. It knows only goals, dates, and a line that appears to keep moving forward. Real change must enter these untidy days before we know whether it can stand.

This part adds no larger ambition. It places the abilities, stories, tools, and evidence from earlier parts inside one week, one day, and one interruption. We will observe which conditions make action easier to begin, which costs are being hidden, how weight changes when capacity falls, and how to know where to return after stopping.

A reliable system is not one that never breaks. It is one that keeps a way back after the break without requiring you to humiliate yourself first.

Questions for This Part

1. How can a first week leave a baseline, feedback, delayed retest, and transfer instead of only a streak?
1. How can full, compressed, and recovery days carry different weights?
1. How do time, energy, relationships, and the body enter one budget?
1. What genuinely compounds, and which repetitions only accumulate exhaustion?
1. After interruption, how can one small action restore rhythm without compensatory depletion?

Recovery here does not mean returning to productivity as quickly as possible. Safety, food, sleep, asking for help, and basic care may be the most important work of the day.

Reading Path

Path	Chapters	What to leave behind
Finish one week	Practice: Finish the First Week	Baseline, seven-day evidence chain, and weekend decision
Place it inside a day	Daily System	Three capacity modes, an environment entry point, and relationship boundaries
Give it to time	Rhythm	Repeatable action, return protocol, and review date

Do not rebuild sleep, learning, exercise, work, and every relationship in the same week. Choose one main question. A system that requires five simultaneous reforms before it works is not ready for real life.

What to Carry Forward

At the end of this part, leave:

1. One Rhythm Ledger recording capacity, minimum action, and resistance;
2. A record of returning after a real interruption;
3. One design to continue and one demand explicitly removed;
4. A protected window, a boundary you can state, and a person you can contact when needed.

Rising numbers are not the only outcome. Noticing exhaustion earlier, repaying fewer interruptions with lost sleep, asking for help sooner, and knowing what should not continue are also evidence that a system is becoming reliable.

Enter the Work

Do not design an ideal year yet. Reduce the future to seven days and let one question meet a real schedule, different capacities, and one weekend review.

One week cannot define you. It can still tell you whether the next week should become lighter or clearer.

Practice: Finish the First Week

When we begin again, we often ask too much of the first day.

We open a new book, build folders, buy a device, and schedule the next three months as if a serious enough opening will automatically produce the person who can finish. What weakens the plan is rarely a lack of enthusiasm on day one. It is the late meeting on day three, poor sleep on day five, someone who needs care on day six, and the overfilled plan we no longer want to see on day seven.

The first week therefore does not have to prove that you have changed. It has one more honest question to answer: **after this enters my real life, can it continue?**

You do not need to perform discipline or turn a low season into a comeback story. Keep one unpolished starting point, complete several actions small enough to survive reality, and notice which conditions gave you capacity and which removed it. The answer from a lived week is usually more useful than the determination of its first morning.

Chapter at a Glance

1. Take one real question into the week instead of redesigning your whole life.
1. Preserve an unaided baseline before using AI, a course, or a template.
1. Use seven days for input, output, feedback, delayed retest, and transfer.
1. Prepare different actions for full, compressed, and recovery days.
1. At the weekend, keep one useful condition, remove one failed demand, and decide whether to continue.

1. The First Week Is Not a Smaller Ninety Days

Many seven-day plans squeeze ninety days of ambition into smaller boxes: study, exercise, read, wake early, track mood, and reflect every day. The plan looks complete, but observing life has become five examinations taken at once.

The first week needs to leave only three things:

1. **A baseline sample** showing what you can do independently now.
2. **Several real attempts** showing whether you can begin again under different conditions.

3 **One weekend decision** about what to keep, stop, or change.

This week does not estimate your potential. It discovers system conditions. You may learn that mornings do not support deep learning but commuting supports listening. You may find that time is not the main problem; every session begins without a visible first step. You may discover that exhaustion is already affecting daily function and that health or responsibility needs attention before training becomes heavier.

Seeing those facts early is not failure. It prevents a long plan from hiding a condition that could have been changed sooner.

2. Take One Question into the Week

A useful question must connect to real life, produce observable evidence within seven days, and allow the answer to change what happens next.

Context	Goal that is too broad	A question the first week can answer
English	Improve speaking	Can I explain one real difficulty in English and answer a follow-up?
Work	Become a better programmer	Can I independently fix one real issue, add a test, and explain the change?
Writing	Publish consistently	Can I finish a short piece whose main idea a new reader can retell?
Daily life	Become disciplined	Can I leave tomorrow a clear entry point at three levels of capacity?
Relationships	Communicate better	Can I state one boundary and say when I will return to respond?

Do not choose a question whose only possible answer is “try harder”. A real question permits three outcomes: continue, shrink, or stop.

Write four lines:

```
The one question for this week:
The real situation where it occurs:
Evidence that will answer it at the weekend:
A result that would make me shrink or stop:
```

If the question involves persistent sleeplessness, pain, low mood, loss of control, or thoughts of harm, change the first-week target to recording facts, protecting safety, and seeking qualified local support. This chapter is not medical or mental-health care.

3. On Day One, Keep an Unpolished Baseline

Before asking AI to revise, watching a tutorial, or applying a template, complete one independent attempt. Limit it to 10-25 minutes. Do not search for the perfect answer or record repeatedly to protect your image.

The baseline can be a 90-second recording, one page of writing, a code change, a real email, a reading reconstruction, or a draft for a boundary-setting conversation. It does not have to be public. It must be comparable with another attempt on day six or seven.

Attach five lines:

```
Date and situation:
Task and constraints:
My independent version:
Three most visible difficulties:
New condition for the retest one week later:
```

An awkward baseline is doing its job. It does not protect pride; it prevents your future self from remembering only that things “used to be worse”. Without a starting point, excitement can exaggerate progress and a bad day can exaggerate decline.

After saving it, decide whether to use AI, a peer, or a course. A tool can analyse errors, generate a parallel task, or support feedback. It cannot fill in the baseline after the fact.

4. Across Seven Days, Practise Returning Rather Than Being Perfect

The table below is not a compulsory streak. It is a minimum evidence chain. Combine actions if a day is interrupted. When capacity falls, shrink the output instead of staying up late to repay it.

Day	Do one thing	Evidence left behind
Day 1	Complete the unaided baseline	First version and three difficulties
Day 2	Use one high-quality input to address one difficulty	Source, main idea, and one reusable structure
Day 3	Close the material and complete a second version	Output and difference from baseline
Day 4	Obtain one piece of specific feedback	Exact comment, testable issue, advice not accepted
Day 5	Change one variable and complete a third version	Before and after versions
Day 6	Retest without notes after a delay	What remained and what was forgotten

Day	Do one thing	Evidence left behind
Day 7	Change topic, audience, or constraint to test transfer	Result under a new condition and next-week decision

If you complete only four days, do not manufacture continuity. Record the absence as fact: what happened, which condition changed, and how costly returning became. More important than a seven-day streak is knowing where to continue after interruption.

5. A Real Example: Speaking About Tiredness in English

Suppose the week's question is: **Can I explain in English why I feel tired, what support I need, and answer one follow-up without translating sentence by sentence?**

Tiredness can involve sleep, illness, stress, caring responsibility, working conditions, and many other causes. The task here is communication, not diagnosis. Sleep or physical symptoms that keep affecting life deserve assessment by a qualified professional.

Keep five structures that can travel into ordinary conversations:

English structure	Job it performs	Your sentence
`I have been feeling ...`	Describes a recent state without turning it into an identity	
`What makes it harder is ...`	Names one observable condition	
`I am not sure whether ...`	Preserves uncertainty instead of pretending to diagnose	
`What I need this week is ...`	Requests specific, limited support	
`If this continues, I will ...`	States the next help-seeking or checking action	

On day one, record 90 seconds. On day three, record again after using one reliable source or receiving language feedback. On day six, speak without the script. On day seven, change the listener from a friend to a colleague or professional and observe how vocabulary and boundaries change.

Do not score only grammar. Ask whether the listener can answer three questions: what happened, what you cannot confirm, and what you want to happen next. Keeping a real conversation moving is closer to usable fluency than copying one accent.

6. A Project in a Low Season Does Not Have to Save a Life

During one disrupted period of my life, programming gave me a small entry point for action. A former company's product needed a high-performance rich-text editor. I could not find an open-source project that met the requirements, so I began building Editable and released it on GitHub.

The work included an editor core, plugin system, complex-table data structures, and a rendering engine. I completed it gradually over a long period and contributed related work to Slate.js. You can inspect the Editable project.

I no longer describe this as “programming cured me” or “finding your passion will end a low season”. The project did not solve every problem and could not replace care. What it gave me was one bounded hour: a problem could be decomposed, code could be tested, and a small completed part did not disappear when my mood changed.

Your first-week artifact does not need to prove the value of your life. Choose something that can close within seven days:

1 reproduce and fix one issue, then add a test;

1 finish one page for a specific reader;

1 record an explanation that can receive a follow-up;

1 improve one step a real user crosses every day;

1 submit one bounded contribution that another person can reject.

An artifact does not save you. It allows judgment to enter reality. It can show whether the problem is real, where ability is missing, whether another person can use the result, and whether continuing is worthwhile.

7. Prepare Three Levels of Capacity

The first week often fails because the plan recognises only one ideal condition. Prepare three modes before the interruption arrives:

Mode	Available capacity	Action for the day
Full day	30-45 minutes of continuous attention	Input, output, and one-line record
Compressed day	10-20 minutes or repeated interruption	Minimum output and one marked error

Mode	Available capacity	Action for the day
Recovery day	Illness, sleeplessness, grief, or a surge in responsibility	Protect safety and basic care; prepare only the next entry point

A recovery day does not have to produce an artifact. Placing material where you can find it, writing tomorrow's first step, or telling someone about a delay can all be return actions. If only recovery mode is possible for several days, go first to Recovery: Catch Yourself Before You Push Forward and examine health, safety, and support.

The next chapter, Daily System, develops capacity budgets, environment design, relationship boundaries, and interruption recovery. The first week needs to prove only one thing: you are willing to change the task according to capacity instead of punishing capacity according to the task.

8. At the Weekend, Answer Only Four Questions

On day seven, do not begin with “Did I work hard enough?” Place the baseline, feedback, delayed retest, and transfer result together in the Evidence Chain Template, then answer four questions:

1. **Completion:** Did I complete the target action under real constraints?
2. **Quality:** Which observable dimension of the output changed?
3. **Retention:** What remained after the material was closed?
4. **Transfer:** Was the ability still usable after topic, audience, or environment changed?

Then write two decisions:

```
One condition to keep next week:
One demand to remove or reduce next week:
```

Do not double the task simply because one week went well. Do not define yourself as unsuitable because one week became chaotic. Use the Weekly Review Template to separate fact, interpretation, and the next experiment. One week is enough to adjust direction, not enough to define a person.

Closing: The First Week Does Not Prove Who You Are

At the end of the week, you may have three awkward recordings, one issue that is not fully repaired, a heavily revised page, or several interrupted notes. They do not look like a transformed life. They are still closer to a future than a grand plan that never entered the day.

A real beginning is not the intensity of the first morning. It is finding the file after life interrupts, seeing the next step, admitting today's capacity, and completing an action that does not require a performance.

Finish the first week. Let facts filter direction, let an artifact leave a trace, and let one weekend decision reduce the weight of the next week.

You do not need seven days to prove who you are. You need only leave day eight a road you are willing to enter again.

Daily System: Put Change into the Day

A person is not a spreadsheet waiting to be optimised. We have nights when sleep does not come, unexpected calls, people who depend on us, and afternoons when our capacity suddenly disappears. A plan that works only in ideal conditions reveals its cracks as soon as real life arrives.

Progress is therefore not only about adding goals. It is also about building a small house around those goals that does not collapse at the first disruption. This chapter does not offer a perfect schedule. It helps you place learning, work, relationships, and recovery on the same table and find a minimum system you can return to when the day becomes untidy.

Quick Overview

1 replace a full-score schedule with a minimum viable day;

1 budget time, capacity, and responsibility together instead of paying every cost with willpower;

1 use the environment and default choices to reduce starting friction and mindless input;

1 state boundaries for relationships and work so focus does not require disappearing;

1 restart only the next step after an interruption, and keep evidence for review;

1 use a seven-day practice to adapt the system to your own life.

1. Design a Minimum Viable Day

“Study for two hours every day” sounds clear, but it avoids a more useful question: what will I do when only twenty minutes remain?

Write three versions of the day. They are not success, failure, and surrender. They are three capacity settings for one system:

Setting	When it fits	What must remain
Full day	Time and capacity are relatively stable	One input, one output, one record
Compressed day	Work expands or attention is fragmented	A 10–25 minute minimum output
Recovery day	Illness, sleeplessness, grief, or responsibility rises sharply	Safety, food, rest, and a cue for returning

A full day is not the answer, and a recovery day is not a moral failure. Write your own version:

```
# My Minimum Viable Day — YYYY-MM-DD

What I must protect today:
Smallest learning or work output:
Person I need to contact or answer:
What I can temporarily leave undone:
First step when I open the file tomorrow:
```

If even the minimum output is impossible, check sleep, health, safety, and responsibility before adding pressure. This is life planning, not medical diagnosis; conditions that keep affecting daily functioning deserve assessment from qualified local professionals.

2. Budget Time, Capacity, and Responsibility

Every day has twenty-four hours, but not all of them can support deep work. Commutes, pain, care, meetings, emotion, and switching consume capacity. Writing them into a plan is not making an excuse. It is making the plan describe a real person.

Each week, answer four questions:

1. Which hours are already occupied by fixed responsibilities?
2. Which periods are most likely to hold 25–45 minutes of uninterrupted attention?
3. Which activities tonight will reduce tomorrow's capacity?
4. If only one important thing happens this week, what deserves protection?

Use this table for a rough budget:

Resource	Fact this week	Floor to protect	Adjustment when exceeded
Time	Fixed and available windows	One main time box	Shrink the task, not rest
Capacity	High, low, and unpredictable periods	One minimum output	Switch to a low-friction version
Attention	Notifications, switching, and inputs	One protected window	Close one entry point
Relationships	People and responsibilities needing a response	One honest conversation	State delay and boundary early
Body	Sleep, pain, movement, and recovery	Basic care and safety	Pause high-risk decisions and seek support

Do not budget with “I can probably squeeze in more.” A budget leaves non-negotiable floors first, then gives the remaining room to ambition.

3. Let the Environment Reduce Friction

Many delays are not value problems. The first step is simply too far away: the file is in the wrong folder, the material needs to be found again, or a phone lighting up brings ten new entrances. Instead of demanding more strength every time, put the next action within reach.

Starting friction

1 open one file the night before and write the next step at the top;

1 sort materials into “today”, “backup”, and “archive” so the collection does not choose the task;

1 prepare one fixed entrance for a 25-minute task: the same card, pen, or terminal command;

1 write your own judgment before using AI, so opening a chat window is not mistaken for beginning to learn.

Closing friction

A system needs an ending as well. Save a version, write one error, close the tabs, and record tomorrow's first step. An unfinished task with no closing action keeps occupying the mind and makes the next start harder.

Environment design is not turning life into a barracks. It makes important work easier to start and unimportant input require one more deliberate choice.

4. Attach Learning to Existing Life

New habits often fail because they require a blank period that never existed. A steadier approach attaches an action to something that already happens:

Existing anchor	Action to attach	Evidence
Opening the computer	Write one sentence about today's question	One line in the Learning State
After lunch	Listen to a short item and record its gist	One Listening Audit entry
Before a meeting	Explain one risk in English	A 60-second recording
Closing work	Save today's version and next step	An artifact or code commit

Existing anchor	Action to attach	Evidence
A fixed weekend slot	Review the first version and feedback	A Weekly Review

An anchor is not a rigid rule. If a situation is frequently interrupted, choose a more reliable one. The goal is not output every minute; it is to stop renegotiating the important action from scratch.

5. Let Relationships Know Your Boundary

Focus is not disappearance. When you mute notifications, delay a reply, or protect a quiet period, help affected people know when you are reachable, when you will return, and how to reach you in an emergency.

Try a sentence like this:

> I need to finish a piece of work from 19:00 to 19:30, so I will not check instant messages. Unless it is urgent, I will reply by 20:00; if it must be handled today, please tell me the deadline directly.

This does not ask everyone to organise life around your schedule. It turns uncertain waiting into information that can be negotiated. The Relationships chapter discusses listening, conflict, and leaving; this chapter adds the daily execution of saying a boundary out loud.

If a boundary can be maintained only through threats, humiliation, or prolonged disappearance, it is not yet a reliable system. Safety and respect come before task completion.

6. Restart Only the Next Step

After an interruption, people often do one of two things: stay up late to compensate, or declare the entire cycle ruined. Both make the cost of returning larger.

Write four lines:

```
What happened (facts only):
Which condition changed: time / capacity / difficulty / environment / responsibility
Smallest output possible within 24 hours:
Work I explicitly will not repay:
```

Then choose an action small enough to complete: reread one section, re-record 60 seconds, fix one test, answer one essential email, or prepare tomorrow's file. Do not immediately raise the difficulty after the first return. Let the system succeed twice in a row first.

When the same resistance appears three times, it is probably more than one bad mood. Return to the Life Practice Toolkit and Weekly Review. Change time, environment, task size, or support network instead of adding blame.

7. Judge the System with Evidence, Not Mood

The quality of a life system is not decided by one excited day. Keep five pieces of evidence each week:

1. Did I leave an output even on a compressed day?
2. Did I know what to do when I opened the file next time?
3. Did I remove one entry point that repeatedly interrupted me?
4. Did I state time and boundaries clearly to the people involved?
5. After an interruption, how long did it take to return to one executable action?

There is no universal score. These questions turn “I seem more disciplined” into observable change. When the evidence worsens, adjust the system conditions before judging personal will.

8. Seven-Day Daily-System Practice

Do not rebuild every habit at once. Make one change each day:

1 **Day 1:** write the minimum version of a full, compressed, and recovery day;

1 **Day 2:** find one reliable 25-minute time box;

1 **Day 3:** close one mindless input and record what changes;

1 **Day 4:** tell one person exactly when you will reply;

1 **Day 5:** make one small output without AI, then decide whether to request feedback;

1 **Day 6:** simulate an interruption and write the 24-hour return action;

1 **Day 7:** use the Weekly Review Template to keep one useful design and delete one unnecessary demand.

After seven days, you do not need a beautiful timetable. You need to know when starting is easier, what event makes the system lose its weight, and which small window deserves protection next week.

Closing: Leave a Way Back

A mature system does not turn a person into someone who is always on time, focused, and energetic. It leaves a way back that does not require humiliation after you drift.

Learning needs time, artifacts need delivery, relationships need presence, and the body needs care. These are not competing projects; they are simultaneous facts about one life. Make the goal smaller, reduce the entrances, state the boundary, keep the evidence, and continue tomorrow.

That is what it means to put change into the day: do not wait for an ideal life to appear. Use the weight you can carry today to build one small piece of ground.

Rhythm: Let Small Things Travel Through Time

Some changes make almost no sound on the day they happen. You open the same file after work, explain one paragraph more clearly for the second time, or turn off the light when you want to stay up. They do not look like victories. They look like fine lines left by water on stone.

As time moves, those lines meet. A more familiar action removes tomorrow's hesitation. One honest piece of feedback prevents another round of rework. A protected night of sleep means the next day does not have to begin from the ruins. Compounding does not mean becoming larger every day. It means today's choice makes tomorrow a little less expensive.

This chapter is a bridge between the Daily System and the 90-Day Action Plan. It does not ask you to seal every hour of life. It asks you to notice which small things deserve to remain, and how they can return after an interruption. When terms such as “variation”, “compounding”, or “minimum contract” become unclear, return to the Glossary of Terms and Methods for definitions and next steps.

Quick Overview

1 distinguish invisible accumulation from temporary excitement instead of judging a season by one day;

1 give repetition a response so mechanical counts do not impersonate ability;

1 recognize four kinds of compounding: ability, trust, judgment, and recovery;

1 design one rhythm that can survive full, compressed, and recovery days;

1 use a one-page rhythm ledger and a 14-day experiment to find a speed that fits;

1 check whether the system gives life more room instead of giving you better ways to blame yourself.

1. Progress Is Not a Straight Line

We easily imagine progress as an upward line: ten more words today, two more tasks next week, more discipline and confidence next month. Real learning is closer to a tide. It rises and falls, and sometimes it seems still while strength is being rearranged underneath.

If you use one day's result to judge yourself, you will promise too much at the high point and deny too much at the low point. A better unit of observation is not “did I win today?” but “did I preserve a way back this week?” One missed practice may mean sleep was interrupted. Several weeks without a first version, feedback, or retest suggest that the system needs to change.

Separate change into three layers:

Layer	What you can see	What not to conclude too quickly
Same-day performance	Whether you completed one action	Ability is not stable yet
Retention	Whether you can still do it independently later	Transfer to a new situation is not proven
Long-term transfer	Whether you can use it with a new topic or listener	Future setbacks have not been eliminated

These layers are not competing scores. They are echoes at different distances: “I can do it now”, “it remains after a while”, and “it travels somewhere new”. The Evidence chapter shows how to record them. For now, do not let a recent success certify the whole road.

2. Repetition Needs an Echo

Repetition is the material of ability, not its proof. Looking at the same answer ten times makes the page familiar. Closing the material and explaining it again reveals what actually stayed with you.

Each repetition should bring back at least one kind of echo:

1. **Recall**: What can I say without looking?
2. **Discrimination**: Can I name the error rather than only feeling “not good enough”?
3. **Variation**: Can I use it with a different topic, listener, or constraint?
4. **Feedback**: Did an outside person or result change what I will do next time?

If four repetitions produce no new information, more repetitions may only increase familiarity. Change one variable instead: shorten the prompt, use a new example, add a follow-up question, impose a time limit, or ask a real reader to try it. Good practice does not copy one day many times. It lets each similar attempt carry a slightly new question.

3. Four Things That Compound

Growth does not only accumulate knowledge. Over time, at least four things influence one another:

Compounding asset	How it grows	How it is spent
Ability	Recall, output, feedback, and variation make an action more reliable	Looking only at answers, long disuse, or a mismatched difficulty
Trust	Keeping promises, delivering checkable work, and naming errors early	Overpromising, hiding costs, and making others clean up the result
Judgment	Recording facts, comparing outcomes, and allowing evidence to revise a view	Protecting a conclusion with emotion or identity, and seeking only support
Recovery	Sleep, boundaries, help, and return after interruption keep the system alive	Chronic depletion, treating rest as a reward, and paying every cost with shame

They are not four separate accounts. Better ability makes delivery more reliable, which can build trust. Trust allows more honest feedback, which improves judgment. Better judgment makes it easier to stop when stopping is responsible, so recovery can begin before collapse.

The reverse is also true. A single account under long-term strain can pull down the others. A person may know a great deal yet be unable to turn it into an artifact when sleep is broken. A person may work very hard yet lose trust by hiding risk. Progress is not pushing one account to its limit. It is giving all four enough support to hold one another up.

4. Design a Rhythm That Can Stay Alive

Rhythm is not a fixed frequency. It is an action you can still recognize at different levels of capacity. Design three versions of one line of work:

Capacity	What remains	Example
Full day	Input, output, and a record	Study a short passage, record an explanation, and note one error
Compressed day	A minimum output and the next step	Explain it for 60 seconds with the material closed, then write tomorrow's first step
Recovery day	Safety, care, and a cue for return	Eat, rest, contact support, and put the file somewhere tomorrow's self can find it

The three versions serve one direction. They are not three goals that cancel one another. A full day deepens ability, a compressed day keeps the chain from disappearing, and a recovery day means you do not need a breakdown to earn permission to begin again.

Write the rhythm as an if-then agreement:

```
If I have 45 minutes and usable capacity:
Then recall first, take input, and submit a first version.

If I have 10 minutes or fragmented attention:
Then recall once, produce once, and record the next step.

If I have two nights of poor sleep or clear physical distress:
Then pause high-risk decisions, care for myself, seek help, and decide when to return.
```

The agreement cannot predict every situation. Its value is reducing the argument you have to hold in the moment. On difficult days, a simpler system is easier to use.

5. Feedback Is Not a Verdict

Feedback matters because it gives the next action more information, not because it proves whether you are good enough. Split feedback into three parts:

1. **Observation**: What did someone actually see, hear, or measure?
1. **Impact**: How did it affect understanding, use, or the result?
1. **Adjustment**: Which one important variable will change next time?

Do not write “my presentation was bad” as a review. Write: “The listener asked what problem I was solving in minute two. They restated the completion standard incorrectly at the end. Next time I will give the situation and outcome first, and remove one background section.” The feedback has returned from a judgment about character to work that can be changed.

The same boundary applies when asking AI for feedback: submit your own version first, ask for no more than three issues that affect the result, require a distinction between observation, inference, and suggestion, then decide what to accept. More feedback is not automatically better. Ten pages of comments without a next action are another form of collection.

6. A Minimum Contract for Bad Days

A rhythm is mature not when it produces the most on good days, but when bad days do not eject you from the system. Write a minimum contract that answers three questions:

1. Under what conditions will I downgrade the task rather than force it?
2. After downgrading, what smallest action is still worth keeping?
3. When should I ask for help or hand a professional question to a qualified professional?

This is not permission to avoid effort. It protects judgment. When health, money, safety, or relationships carry a serious risk, completing the plan may not be brave. Pausing, explaining, asking for help, and rescheduling can also be responsibility toward the long term.

After each interruption, write four lines:

```
What happened, as facts:
Which condition changed: time / capacity / difficulty / environment / responsibility
The smallest return action within 24 hours:
What I will explicitly not make up this time:
```

If the same resistance appears three times, do not call it only a discipline problem. The time box may be unrealistic, the task may not be split, a boundary may be unspoken, or the support network may be too thin. Return to the Life Practice Toolkit and let the system do the work it was meant to do.

7. A One-Page Rhythm Ledger

The ledger is not for monitoring your character. It helps you see which designs deserve to stay. Keep one page each week:

```
# Rhythm Ledger — YYYY-MM-DD

The one question this week:
The smallest action I protected:
One piece of feedback that created new information:
One resistance that repeated:
One condition I will change next week:
One number I will stop tracking:
```

The last line matters. Every record costs attention; removing a number that cannot guide a decision is part of rhythm design. If you update a table every day but have no first version, feedback, or retest, shorten the record and return the time to action. For a copy-ready version, open the Rhythm Ledger Template.

8. A 14-Day Rhythm Experiment

Do not redesign your whole life at once. Test one hypothesis for fourteen days:

1. **Day 1:** write the current question, a baseline sample, and the minimum contract;
2. **Days 2–4:** use the rhythm on at least one full and one compressed day; record starting and stopping friction;
3. **Day 5:** ask a real person or a reproducible result for feedback;
4. **Days 6–7:** remove one step that produces no information and keep one useful anchor;

5. **Days 8–10:** change one variable such as time limit, listener, topic, or tool permission;
6. **Day 11:** simulate an interruption and test whether the return protocol is small enough;
7. **Days 12–13:** complete one independent version and one revised version without rereading the original explanation;
8. **Day 14:** use the Weekly Review Template to continue, downgrade, change the question, or stop the experiment.

At the end, do not ask only how many days you persisted. Compare the first and last versions: Did completion time change? Did errors decrease? Was it easier for another person to understand? Do you know more clearly when to stop? A clearer next decision is already a return on the experiment.

9. Stage Standards

A rhythm worth continuing usually has these qualities:

1. it works at least at two levels of capacity, not only on ideal days;
1. each repetition creates new information through recall, feedback, or variation;
1. it has a real first version, revision, and retest rather than only completion records;
1. after an interruption, it returns to a small action within a reasonable time without compensatory depletion;
1. it can say what to continue, what to remove, and which risks require escalation or help;
1. it leaves protected boundaries for relationships, the body, and attention.

If a rhythm makes you increasingly afraid to open the record, or requires chronic sacrifice of sleep, honesty, and relationships, it has not produced reliable progress even if the numbers rise. Change the system. That is not abandoning the goal; it is returning the goal to a weight you can carry.

Closing: Let Time Become a Companion

We often want one large decision to prove that we have become a different person. Life tends to trust another kind of evidence: you open the file without being reminded, keep listening when feedback stings, and do not exile yourself from life after an interruption.

Small things are not powerless because they are small. Their strength comes from being repeated, revised, carried into new situations, and sometimes allowed to pause. Time is not only a river that makes us older. When we place choices, work, boundaries, and care into it, time also keeps some of the effort that would otherwise disappear.

The next step does not need to be larger. It needs to be clearer. Return to the Daily System and adjust your three capacity versions, then enter Part V: Long-Term Action and let one rhythm meet a real problem and real time.

Part V: Long-Term Action

By this point, the reader has several things with which to begin: a baseline, a new reading of an old story, an artifact that can be delivered, and a rhythm that can return after interruption.

The most dangerous next step is to place all of them inside an oversized wish. Once direction appears, we easily demand ninety perfect days. At the first loss of pace in week three, we may decide that the whole plan has failed.

Long-term change is not enthusiasm stretched across a calendar. It is the same real question meeting different phases, capacities, feedback, forgetting, and new situations while remaining visible enough to revise.

This part contains two core chapters. The first gives one real problem ninety days. The second asks how day ninety-one closes the books, transfers what worked, and chooses continuation or closure. Action must leave the page and enter your calendar, artifacts, relationships, and life. It must also complete a handover instead of using the next burst of excitement to cover the previous season.

Questions for This Part

1. What must I complete in a real situation after ninety days, rather than merely “become better”?
1. What evidence is required before entering the next phase?
1. Which one main question belongs to each week, and which work will not be repaid?
1. How does the plan change weight when health, money, relationships, or responsibility change?
1. Which result means continue, and which means shrink, pause, or stop?

A plan without a stopping condition can easily rename sunk cost as persistence. A real commitment states not only what it will do, but which costs it will no longer use as payment.

Reading Path

Phase	Time	Core work
Calibrate	Days 1–14	Preserve a baseline, locate the bottleneck, and confirm one stable entry point
Stack	Days 15–56	Produce comparable outputs, obtain feedback, and change one variable
Ship	Days 57–90	Change audience, topic, or environment, then complete real delivery and transfer
Hand over	After day 90	Close the books, transfer, repair, or stop so the result enters the next part of life

Use the 90-Day Action Plan: Return Your Life to Yourself to place the first three phases into the 90-Day Cycle Map, then use After Ninety Days: Let Change Remain in Life to close and hand over the cycle. The map owns direction and gates, the Evidence Chain explains results, and the Rhythm Ledger maintains weekly capacity. Do not ask one record to own every job or one cycle to decide an entire life.

What to Carry Forward

After ninety days and its handover, leave three things that can continue serving life:

1. One artifact seen, used, or reviewed by a real audience;
2. One map of errors that still recur;
3. One rhythm that can return without ideal conditions.

If the direction no longer deserves continuation, stopping can also be a valid delivery. Record the evidence, cost, and completed closure so past investment does not decide the future.

Enter the Work

Choose one thing worthy of ninety days and also worthy of being released when evidence does not support it.

Do not fill all twelve weeks first. Write the facts of day one, the question for week one, and the evidence required before day fourteen opens the next phase.

90-Day Action Plan: Return Your Life to Yourself

Many people finish one piece of advice and immediately save another. Saving feels like a beginning, but it often moves the beginning somewhere more comfortable.

Progress depends less on a burst of excitement than on a stretch of time that can be inspected. This 90-day plan does not ask you to become a different person. It asks you to collect evidence that, three months from now, you can understand more, express more, and finish more. If you have not yet found a daily rhythm that can survive interruption, read Rhythm: Let Small Things Travel Through Time first, then give one returnable action to these 90 days.

0. Define "Better"

Do not write "improve my English", "learn AI", or "become disciplined". These wishes are fine, but they cannot guide today's choice.

Use this sentence instead:

> Within 90 days, in **a real situation**, I will complete **a deliverable**, and judge it with **three pieces of evidence**.

Examples:

1 In 90 days, I will give a 10-minute product presentation in English. Evidence: a recording, transcript, and feedback from one listener.

1 In 90 days, I will build a small tool that organizes a spreadsheet. Evidence: runnable code, instructions, and one real use.

1 In 90 days, I will publish 12 short industry notes. Evidence: links, reader feedback, and a review of my own decisions.

The closer the goal is to real life, the harder it is to hide behind "I am not ready yet".

Copy the 90-Day Cycle Map first, then fill it with the phases and weekly questions below. It is not another check-in system; it puts the evidence you already collect on one timeline. Use the Evidence Chain Template to explain four time points and the Rhythm Ledger to maintain a weekly rhythm that can return.

1. Take a One-Page Baseline

On day one, spend 30 minutes writing four columns:

Column	Question
Current state	What can I do independently? Where do I stop?
Situation	Where will I use this ability in three months?
Resources	What time, material, tool, and person can I reliably access each week?
Cost	What must I do less of to make room for this goal?

The last column matters most. A plan with no cost is only a wish list. Choosing one main line does not betray every other possibility; it gives one possibility enough light for a while.

How Four Skills Join the Same Cycle

You do not need equal listening, reading, speaking, and writing every week. Choose the skill closest to the real outcome, then use another skill for input or feedback:

Part of the cycle	Role	Evidence to keep
Listening/reading	Gather material, understand the problem, and locate evidence	Listening Resource Audit or Reading Evidence Card
Speaking/writing	Turn understanding into an explanation, decision, or artifact	Speaking Evidence Card or Writing Evidence Card
Feedback/review	Find the largest barrier and choose the next variable	Weekly Review and Learning State
Delivery/transfer	Test the result with a new listener, topic, or real situation	Artifact link, user feedback, or parallel task

If the four activities do not serve one outcome, they become unrelated check-ins again. Keep at least one input, one output, and one transfer test each week; let the rest support the main line.

2. Three Phases

Phase One: Calibrate (days 1–14)

Do not chase speed. Learn what is true.

1. Take a baseline: record an English introduction or complete the smallest task in your field;

1. Find the three errors that appear most often;
1. Establish a fixed slot, even if it is only 25 minutes a day;
1. Keep one main resource, one practice situation, and one place to record results.

At the end of two weeks, you should be able to answer: What exactly am I training? What is my bottleneck? What will I repeat next time? If you cannot answer, do not add more material.

Phase Two: Stack (days 15–56)

Repeat one action until it becomes familiar, then raise the difficulty. Keep four kinds of work each week:

1. **Input**: two or three sessions of listening, reading, or example analysis;
2. **Output**: two sessions of speaking, writing, coding, or presenting;
3. **Feedback**: one concrete revision of a piece of work;
4. **Review**: a 20-minute record of what to keep and what to remove next week.

AI can be a coach, practice partner, reviewer, and tester. Do not let it complete every output. Submit your rough version first, then let the tool identify the most valuable repair. The repair you make yourself is where ability becomes yours.

Phase Three: Ship (days 57–90)

From week eight, stop expanding the course. Concentrate what you have learned into one artifact: a talk, essay, tool, report, interview simulation, or real conversation.

Make three versions:

1. **Independent**: complete it without an answer key under realistic conditions;
1. **Revised**: fix the problems that most affect understanding and results;
1. **Public**: give it to a real person to use, read, or evaluate.

The artifact does not need to win an award. It needs to be real enough to show your next direction.

3. One Main Question per Week

Begin each week with one question, not ten tasks:

> Can I explain my work in English without reading from a script?

Build the week around it:

1. Monday: collect three natural expressions and hear them in context;
1. Tuesday: write a 90-second answer;
1. Wednesday: record it and mark pauses, repetition, and unclear sounds;
1. Thursday: ask AI or a partner to identify three high-value issues;
1. Friday: record a second version with one follow-up question;
1. Weekend: save the recording, revisions, and next week's question together.

At the end of the week you will have a chain of evidence instead of a pile of check-in screenshots. Put the first version, immediate performance, delayed retention, and transfer into the Evidence Chain Template, then write the decision back into the cycle map.

4. The Daily Minimum Loop

When life is fragmented, use this 45-minute version:

1. **Recall for 5 minutes**: write three things you remember without looking;
2. **Input for 15 minutes**: work through a small section and mark only the difficulties that affect meaning;
3. **Output for 15 minutes**: speak, write, build, or demonstrate a visible result;
4. **Feedback for 5 minutes**: record one error and one reusable expression;
5. **Plan for 5 minutes**: write the first action for tomorrow.

If you have ten minutes, keep recall, output, and recording. Shorten the loop, but do not erase it.

5. When You Fail, Restart the Next Step

Plans will be interrupted by illness, overtime, arguments, poor sleep, and unexpected bills. The interruption is not the failure. Turning it into a verdict about your character is what makes it grow.

Use this recovery protocol:

1. Write the fact: I have not practiced for several days. Do not add a personality judgment;
2. Name the resistance: time, difficulty, mood, or an unsupportive environment;

3. Reduce the task to one third of its size;
4. Complete one tiny output within 24 hours;
5. Do not repay missed work by staying up late. Return to today.

Long-term practice does not mean never falling behind. It means not punishing yourself with shame when you do.

6. An Honest Scorecard

Each Sunday, record only “done” or “not done”:

1. Did I complete at least two active outputs?
1. Did I receive one concrete piece of feedback?
1. Did I turn one mistake into the next exercise?
1. Did I leave an artifact I can show or reuse?
1. Did I protect basic sleep, movement, and relationships?

The last item is not a bonus. It is infrastructure. The body is not a container for your goals; it is part of your life. Any plan that requires chronic depletion needs redesign.

7. Leave Three Things After 90 Days

At the end, do not ask only how many days you checked off. Leave:

1. **One artifact** that proves you did more than study;
2. **One error map** showing recurring problems and the next priorities;
3. **One sustainable rhythm** that survives a busy week.

If these three things exist, the 90 days were not wasted. You have built something more reliable than a disciplined-person image: trust that you know how to begin, revise, and finish.

Closing: Return Progress to Ordinary Days

I no longer trust the phrase “change your life completely”. It sounds powerful, but often leads to a larger disappointment. Real change usually has no soundtrack: someone gets up on time and opens yesterday’s file; says the first prepared sentence in a meeting; edits an article until they are willing to sign it; or, when escape feels urgent, looks at the facts first.

May the 90 days give you more than a skill. May they return a little texture to your contact with life. May you know where you are going, while accepting that the road may be quiet for a while.

After Ninety Days: Let Change Remain in Life

The easiest day of a plan to imagine is the first.

The new document contains no mistakes. Twelve tidy weeks wait on the calendar. The goal looks like a road that has finally agreed to move forward. Day ninety-one is harder to picture. The reminders have stopped, the artifact has shipped, excitement and exhaustion are receding together, and you sit beside the records unsure whether to begin something larger or admit that less changed than you hoped.

I used to make the same mistake at this point. As soon as one phase ended, I covered it with another. If something worked, I raised the target. If it did not, I changed the target. Continuing forward kept me from answering what those months had actually left behind.

I eventually understood that the end of a cycle is not a time for another wish. It is a handover. Ability must be handed to a new situation, an artifact to real people, errors to the next practice, and the body and relationships back from temporary conscription. Effort without a handover often exists only while the plan is active. When the reminders stop, change loses its place to live.

This chapter is not about maintaining high intensity forever. A life does not need to become a perpetual-motion machine. It is about letting an effort that has already happened remain useful after enthusiasm recedes.

Chapter at a Glance

After ninety days, do not begin the next cycle immediately. Complete five things first:

1. Close the previous cycle with the first sample, final sample, real feedback, and actual cost;
2. Send each result toward continuation, transfer, repair, or closure;
3. Test whether ability survives outside the original practice conditions;
4. Protect foundational life, one main project, and free margin so no goal consumes the whole person;
5. Work in seasons and give every serious commitment an explicit exit gate.

What you need at the end is not a fuller annual plan. You need a trustworthy handover note: what now belongs to you, what still needs practice, what deserves continuation, and what has gone far enough.

1. On Day Ninety-One, Stop Replacing Judgment with Excitement

Ninety days is an observation container, not a character examination. It gives one undertaking enough time to meet repetition, feedback, and interruption. It has no authority to decide whether you are disciplined, intelligent, or worthy of success.

Two impulses commonly appear when the cycle ends, and neither is reliable.

The first is escalation. After one English presentation, you demand that you chair the whole meeting next quarter. After building one small tool, you imagine a company. After twelve essays, you plan a book. Growth is not the problem. The problem is exchanging a temporary result for a heavier commitment before testing whether the ability is stable, the work is needed, or the body is already paying too much.

The second impulse is dismissal. The artifact missed its target, feedback was quiet, or several weeks broke apart, so the entire period becomes “another failure”. That conclusion is also too quick. A cycle without a successful delivery may still leave a clearer boundary, a more accurate error map, a direction stopped in time, or the first attempt you did not sustain by sacrificing sleep.

On day ninety-one, prove nothing. Set excitement, disappointment, and shame aside long enough to ask a plainer question: **which observable conditions, actions, and outcomes changed during these ninety days?**

2. Close the Books Before Making Another Wish

Closing the books is not giving yourself one final score. It lets what happened stop floating. Place the evidence on one surface: the day-one baseline, the last independently completed sample, at least two pieces of real feedback, the error record, and the costs paid along the way.

Then fill four columns:

Area	Fact to preserve	Do not replace it with
Ability	What you can now complete independently and where prompts remain necessary	“I have learned it”
Artifact	Who saw, used, or reviewed it and which problem it addressed	“I did a lot”

Area	Fact to preserve	Do not replace it with
Cost	Time, money, sleep, relationships, and opportunities spent	"If it mattered, the cost does not count"
Unknowns	Which samples are too small and which causes remain uncertain	"Persistence will eventually answer everything"

Answer at least six questions:

1 What did I initially believe the main difficulty was, and what became the real bottleneck?

1 Which improvement remains when material and immediate prompts are removed?

1 Which result appears only with a familiar task, familiar tool, or ideal conditions?

1 Who actually used the work, and what do their behaviour and feedback show?

1 What did this progress cost, and which costs cannot continue?

1 If I began again today, which half of the activity would I remove?

Use the Evidence Chain Template to compare samples and the Weekly Review to find recurring problems. Conversation logs, study hours, and streaks can show that activity happened. By themselves, they cannot show that transfer happened.

3. Give Every Result One of Four Destinations

Not every goal deserves another quarter. After closing the books, send each result toward one destination:

Destination	When it fits	Next action
Continue	The result has value, evidence supports it, and the cost is bearable	Preserve the main line and raise only one difficulty
Transfer	The foundation exists and needs a new situation	Change the audience, topic, tool, or constraint
Repair	The direction matters, but the system or boundary is damaged	Reduce load and repair health, relationships, or process first
Stop	Value is weak, conditions changed, or cost exceeds return	Complete the handover, preserve the lesson, and release resources

Continuation is not the default, and stopping is not the failure option. The most dangerous state is refusing to stop without having the capacity to continue seriously. The goal then occupies attention indefinitely and uses guilt to maintain a false existence.

When stopping, complete three actions: record the grounds, archive reusable material, and tell the people affected. A project ended honestly does not collect interest from memory every day. It returns time to new responsibilities and releases your past self from endless defence.

4. Ability Must Transfer, and Work Must Be Handed Over

Improving on the same material may mean you memorised the route. An ability that belongs to you must continue working, at least partly, after conditions change.

Design one transfer task for the previous cycle and change one main condition:

1 For English, move from a familiar topic to an unfamiliar one, or from a monologue to questions you cannot predict;

1 For AI use, write your judgment first, then change models or turn the tool off for the critical step;

1 For a project, ask someone outside development to follow the documentation and observe where they stop;

1 For writing, explain the same idea to a different audience and remove the signals only an insider understands;

1 For daily life, test whether the minimum version can return during travel, overtime, or a low-capacity week.

Transfer is not deliberate suffering. Change one condition at a time so you can see which part of the ability travelled with you. If every condition changes at once, failure produces only more confusion.

Artifacts also need a handover. Code needs operating instructions. An essay needs a statement of scope. A workflow needs to be usable by a colleague. A business service needs an owner, failure entry point, and stopping condition. Work that functions only while its author is present has not fully entered the world.

5. Protect the Long Term with Three Layers

Long-term action is not one goal expanded without limit. It gives different responsibilities different places. Arrange the next season in three layers:

Layer	What belongs there	Minimum protection
Foundation	Sleep, health, income floor, important relationships, and necessary duties	Do not fund the goal with chronic depletion
Main project	The one ability, artifact, or real problem most worth advancing	Give it a clear weekly block and one main question
Margin	Curiosity, reading, walking, unproductive interests, and open space	Do not demand immediate return

I once allowed the main project to become the whole of life. A company, product, or direction I wanted to prove gradually gained the power to explain everything. Sleep could be repaid later, relationships repaired after success, and the body ignored as long as it still worked. Such concentration can create short-term speed. It can also let one failed project damage income, identity, relationships, and self-respect at the same time.

Three layers do not require equal effort. A critical season may lean toward the main project, but the lean needs an expiry date, the foundation needs red lines, and the margin needs some air. A life without margin can only repeat known goals. A life without foundation may be unable to hold even the results it earns.

6. Work in Seasons Instead of Swearing by Passion

Long-term change resembles seasons more than a continuously rising line.

1 **Sowing**: explore the problem, encounter material, and allow direction to remain uncertain;

1 **Growing**: reduce choices, repeat the central action, and accept slowness and monotony;

1 **Harvesting**: finish, publish, evaluate, and hand over without endlessly expanding scope;

1 **Resting**: lower the load, repair health and relationships, organise material, and wait for the next question to become visible.

The phases need not last three months each, and life may not present them in perfect order. Their purpose is to stop you demanding the same performance from every period. Do not shame sowing for its low output, use exploration to escape completion during harvest, or quietly rename rest as falling behind.

Keep one main task in each season and write its ending signal in advance. Exploration ends after three recurring user problems appear. Growth moves to delivery after four comparable outputs. Expansion stops after acceptance. The plan immediately shifts down when insomnia, pain, or relationship conflict persists.

Passion helps us leave. A sense of season tells us when to cultivate, when to harvest, and when to put the tools down.

7. Every Goal Needs an Expiry Date and an Exit Gate

A goal without an expiry date quietly becomes an identity. You are no longer “testing a product”; you are “the person whose product cannot fail”. You are no longer “learning English”; you are “the person who must prove those years were not wasted”. Once a goal defends identity, evidence struggles to enter.

Give every long-term direction four exit gates:

1. **Value gate**: Does this problem still deserve solving, and do real people still need it?
2. **Evidence gate**: Which result supports continuation, and how long without it requires reconsideration?
3. **Cost gate**: Which health, financial, relational, and ethical costs will never be crossed?
4. **Responsibility gate**: What refund, explanation, documentation, apology, or handover is required if the work stops?

An exit gate is not an excuse prepared for weakness. It is a boundary prepared for commitment. It prevents the cost already paid from becoming a reason to pay more.

At every expiry date, allow the conclusion to change. A changed direction does not make the past entirely wrong. It may simply mean that new information finally entered the judgment.

8. Let Long-Term Change Enter Relationships and Responsibility

Many self-improvement plans are written as if one person lives in a vacuum: all time is privately owned, emotion affects no one else, and failure has no shared cost. Real life is different. Two more hours of work at night may mean two more hours of care carried by a partner. One investment may change a household's safety boundary. Weeks of mental absence make relationships pay attention on behalf of the goal.

Before the next phase begins, talk with the people affected about four things:

1. What I will invest and how long I expect it to last;

1 Which shared responsibilities will not disappear;

1 Which signals will make me reduce or stop;

1 What support I hope for and which responsibilities I will not place on the other person.

This is not asking someone else to approve your life. It is acknowledging that a choice enters shared life. Mature long-term action is not one person enduring longer. It makes commitments, boundaries, and effects speakable.

If the previous cycle already harmed a relationship, do not replace repair with a promise of future success. Name the specific effect, hear the other person's account, and make the repair you can carry now. Tomorrow's achievement cannot apologise for today.

9. Leave Only Three Lines for the Next Year

The common problem with an annual plan is not that it lacks ambition. It preserves too many competing lives at once. Learn a language, master an AI stack, start a company, become fit, write a book, travel, and improve every relationship: each may be reasonable alone, yet together they can produce only switching and guilt.

Keep three lines for the next year:

1. **One ability**: What do I want to complete more reliably after closing the tools and material?
2. **One artifact**: What will a real person see, use, or review before the year ends?
3. **One life condition**: Which physical, relational, financial, or environmental condition must improve and remain protected?

The three lines should serve one another. English may support a product explanation for international clients instead of becoming a collection of vocabulary. While the artifact advances, the life condition may be stable sleep that no longer uses midnight to repay the day. Ability, work, and life then stop becoming three wars over the same resources.

Put every other wish on a “later is still possible” list. Deferring a wish does not make it unimportant. It simply keeps it outside this year's field of commitment.

10. Once a Quarter, Review Who You Are Becoming

A long-term review that inspects output alone can make the person an accessory to the project again. Every three months, look beyond work and results to four abilities repeated throughout this book:

Ability	Quarterly question
Honesty	Can I distinguish fact, interpretation, and wish more clearly?
Responsibility	Have I seen the effects of my choices on others and carried the part that belongs to me?
Judgment	Has new evidence genuinely changed the plan, or have I only protected the original conclusion?
Return	Do I return earlier after interruption and punish myself less with shame?

These questions do not produce a satisfying total score. They show whether ability grew with judgment, artifacts increased with responsibility, and speed improved with care for life.

Write a short note to the person you will be three months from now. Include only facts, gratitude, and one reminder. Do not predict how powerful you will become. Tell your future self which cost must not be forgotten, which people and responsibilities deserve protection, and where to return the next time the road disappears.

11. Use Thirty Days to Complete the Handover

If the path from ninety days to a year remains unclear, reserve thirty days for handover:

Time	Central action	Evidence of completion
Days 1–7	Close the books and recover	Samples, feedback, costs, and unknowns appear together
Days 8–14	Transfer and hand over	One new-context test is complete, and another person can understand or take over the work
Days 15–21	Choose and stop	Every result moves toward continuation, transfer, repair, or closure
Days 22–30	Establish the next season	One main line, three-layer boundaries, and explicit exit gates are written

These thirty days are not a fourth sprint. They can be slower than the months before and should contain some unclaimed days. Empty space lets exhaustion become visible. It also quiets the goals that survived only through momentum.

After the handover, decide whether to begin another ninety days. You may continue, reduce, turn, or stop. Whatever the choice, the new beginning no longer depends on forgetting the life that came before it.

Closing: Give the Result Somewhere to Live

We often imagine change as leaving an old place: leaving insufficient ability, unimpressive work, or an unstable self. Change that remains is often less a departure than a rearrangement of life.

A new ability enters work and completes a conversation that once stopped. An artifact enters another person's hands and no longer exists only to prove that its author tried. A boundary enters a relationship so love no longer pays for ambition. A stopping decision enters the calendar and returns time to the body, family, and a new question.

Then ninety days is no longer an achievement to display. It is simply a season that happened with care. You cultivated, harvested, and admitted that some seeds did not grow. You carried forward what could travel, returned what had been borrowed, and before the next weather arrived, still knew where you lived.

May you have not only the courage to begin another cycle, but the honesty to end this one. May everything you worked so hard to gain eventually find somewhere to live.

Afterword: Progress Is Not Leaving Yourself Behind

I have returned to that afternoon in July 2017.

My friend `W.` was preparing for the TOEFL and asked, “How can I learn English efficiently?”

At the time, I thought the answer must be hidden in a vocabulary book, a set of grammar rules, or a smarter learning app. I laid out what I knew as if I were spreading a map across a table. I did not first ask where she wanted to go, or how much time she could actually leave each week.

Years later, I can admit that her question may not have been only about English. She was asking how an ordinary person can move life a little forward when time is limited, confidence keeps changing, and life does not cooperate.

Almost every chapter in this book is another echo of that question. English is a concrete door. AI is an increasingly powerful tool. An artifact is an answer that can be delivered. Evidence is a way to reduce self-deception. Rhythm is how a small action travels through time. The door, tool, artifact, evidence, and rhythm all return to the same person in the end.

Return to the First Question

If someone asked me today how to learn English efficiently, I would not begin with a longer resource list. I would ask:

1 In what real situation will you use it?

1 What can you complete independently now, and where do you stop?

1 How much time can you give it without charging sleep, relationships, or health?

1 When the plan breaks, how will you return?

Efficiency that does not bring you closer to a real purpose is only a faster way to do something unrelated to that purpose. More vocabulary and more sounds can help. They begin to belong to you after you close the material and can still explain, complete the task before an unfamiliar listener, and revise when you are wrong.

That is why I trust the phrase “the best method” less and less. A method works inside conditions: for which person, for which task, with which resources, at what cost, and with what stop condition. A method that works only on ideal days is incomplete. A method that makes it frightening to admit exhaustion will eventually turn exhaustion into a moral failure.

Failure Did Not Write the Conclusion for Me

I once imagined life as a route that could keep levelling up. Complete one goal and receive the next piece of equipment. Earn enough money and protect everyone important to me. Build a product and prove that the choices behind it were right.

Then the company failed. My body lost control. My family and relationships carried the weight of choices I had made. For a while I called it “a small episode in life”, because that made it easier to stand up. It was not the whole truth. Failure did not end my life, but it did leave losses, guilt, sleeplessness, arguments, departures, and a long period when I did not know how to continue.

Naming the cost is not an attempt to make the story more tragic, or to assign every responsibility to one person. It gives a review a truthful beginning: what I knew then, what I learned later, which effects I caused, which motives I have no right to explain for others, and which conclusions remain guesses no matter how elegantly they are written.

I keep the failure not because failure is noble by itself, or because every failure automatically teaches a lesson. It can provide information only after it is separated into facts, costs, responsibility, and the next gate. Otherwise it is only a wound played on repeat, or an advertisement dressed up as courage.

In 2026, I returned to practical work with AI and physical industries. I still treat every direction as work under test. My role, company affiliations, and plans belong in public view. Customers, costs, delivery quality, continued use, and risk outcomes can be answered only by real projects and time. I do not want new names to replace old illusions, or one visit or article to stand in for long-term evidence.

What Progress Means

If progress means becoming a completely different person, it becomes another way to run away. We keep rejecting the person we are and imagine that life may begin once we are intelligent enough, wealthy enough, healthy enough, or stable enough.

I would rather define progress as four abilities becoming more dependable:

Ability	What it looks like in life
Honesty	Distinguishing fact, interpretation, and wish, while admitting what remains unknown

Ability	What it looks like in life
Responsibility	Seeing how a choice affects others and repairing what can be repaired
Judgment	Letting sources, feedback, and outcomes change a view instead of protecting a conclusion
Return	Knowing how small the next step can be after interruption, failure, or reduced capacity

English taught me to hear other voices and my own limits. AI taught me that stronger tools require more human judgment. Projects taught me that artifacts must meet users, costs, and failure. Health and relationship lows taught me that a goal without care is not worth calling success.

None of this arrived as one revelation. It usually happened somewhere ordinary: an email I did not answer in time, an explanation I recorded again, a feature I removed, a request for help I finally spoke aloud, or an evening when I stopped trying to repay an interruption with lost sleep.

Small actions matter not because they create legends, but because they can be repeated, revised, and carried into new situations. Evidence of growth is often not “I have become good”. It is “I notice earlier when something is wrong, and I can stop without making the wrongness a verdict on my character”.

From the Afterword to Tomorrow

You do not need to reread the whole book first. Choose an entry point that matches your present condition:

1 If you do not know where to start, open the Toolkit Overview and choose one worksheet by the problem;

1 If you have samples but cannot tell whether anything changed, use the Evidence Chain Template to place baseline, immediate performance, delayed retention, and transfer together;

1 If you want to protect one week's rhythm, copy the Rhythm Ledger and write a full, compressed, and recovery version of the action;

1 If you want to give one task ninety days, use the 90-Day Cycle Map to name the situation, acceptance standard, and cost first;

1 If the plan has already broken, return to Recovery and the Daily System instead of judging yourself at your most exhausted.

Track one main question in week one and change one condition in week two. Three months later, place the first sample, revision record, real feedback, and remaining errors side by side. You do not have to announce that you have changed. If change exists, it will appear in the comparison of conditions, actions, and results.

When evidence does not support continuing, downgrade, change the question, or stop. Stopping an unworthy investment is not a betrayal of your past self. It may be the first time you have placed judgment back in your own hands.

To the Reader Ahead

I do not know who will open this book later. It may be someone preparing for an exam, someone newly unemployed, someone trying to build a product without users, someone repeatedly hurt in a relationship, or someone with five minutes today who only wants life to stop slipping out of control.

I cannot promise that tomorrow will be better, and I cannot decide which road is worth taking for you. I can leave a few quiet wishes:

1. May learning a language make you less eager to prove yourself and more able to hear another person's silence;
1. May building tools bring you closer to real people, real places, and real responsibility rather than farther away;
1. May you keep the ability to review yourself after failure without reducing yourself to the failure;
1. May you ask for help earlier, allow yourself to stop when stopping is responsible, and begin again without waiting for perfect permission.

Progress may not mean moving from a low place to a high one. It may be more like installing a new window in the same house. You still carry old wounds, habits, debts, and awkwardness. You can simply see more kinds of weather now, and know which light should remain on at night.

May progress not mean leaving yourself behind, but finally refusing to despise the person who stumbled all the way here and still did not give up completely.

Thank you for reading this far.

— Han Xiankai

Glossary of Terms and Methods

This is not an attempt to turn life into a vocabulary test. It gives recurring words in *Life Level-up Guide* a stable place to land. Return here when a term is unclear or you do not know which page to open next.

How to Use It

Find the task you are facing, then follow “definition → evidence → next step”. If a term does not help you complete a task, preserve a sample, or make a better decision, you do not need to memorise it for its own sake.

Problems and Goals

Term	Meaning in this guide	Continue here
Real problem	A situation with affected people and an action to complete, not “I want to improve”	Learning Principles
Context	When, where, and for whom a skill will be used	CEFR Goals and Self-check
Acceptance standard	An outcome another person can observe, check, or restate	AI Task Brief
Main question	One answerable question tracked for a week	90-Day Action Plan

Evidence and Judgment

Term	Meaning in this guide	Common trap
Baseline	A raw sample saved before tool support or concentrated training	Replacing the first version with feelings or a polished result
Evidence	A record that returns to work, recording, test, source, or real feedback	Treating hours, saves, or chat logs as proof of ability
Fact	Something with a source, date, sample, or direct observation	Writing an explanation as a proven cause
Interpretation	A reading of the facts that may still need revision	Stopping verification because it sounds plausible
Hypothesis	A judgment waiting for the next action to test it	Writing a wish or model answer as a conclusion
Inference boundary	Separating what a source says, what evidence supports, and what you add	Treating a headline, emotion, or one anecdote as the whole picture
Narrative compression	Turning a complex experience into a shareable sentence or causal chain	Mistaking a shortened story for the whole event after removing chance, others' work, and unknowns
Hindsight bias	Explaining a past choice with outcomes that were known only later	Sending later information backwards into the past

Learning Actions

Term	Meaning in this guide	Related chapter
Retrieval practice	Close the source and answer, retell, write, or perform from memory	Learning Principles
Distributed practice	Return at multiple points instead of cramming once	Vocabulary
Intensive listening/reading	Use short material to check detail, structure, evidence, and language form	Listening · Reading
Parallel material	A different source with similar difficulty and task for testing transfer	Reading Evidence Card
Transfer	Complete a related action after changing topic, listener, time, or task	90-Day Cycle Map
Delayed retention	Complete a similar task after time has passed and recent prompts are removed	Evidence
Evidence chain	One page connecting baseline, immediate performance, delayed retention, transfer, and next step	Evidence Chain Template · Evidence
Variation	Keep the core action while changing the topic, listener, time, or constraint to test whether learning is real	Rhythm

Tools and Delivery

Term	Meaning in this guide	Related chapter
Task brief	A one-page record of context, input, action, boundaries, acceptance, and ownership	AI Task Brief
Case review	A record that separates a public experience into source, facts, judgment, outcome, and transferable principle	AI Case Review
Evidence card	A template for preserving a first take, feedback, and retest for one language skill	Four-skill path
Artifact	An output others can read, use, question, or improve; not necessarily a product	Artifacts
Delivery	Completing work under a real audience, user, or constraint and accepting the result	90-Day Action Plan
Human gate	AI may assist, but a person confirms facts, permissions, privacy, cost, and final judgment	AI Project Development
Rollback	Pause, degrade, switch, or return to a known usable state after failure	AI Learning and Project Practice

Life and Boundaries

Term	Meaning in this guide	Related chapter
Boundary	What I will do to protect myself and state a consequence when something happens	Relationships
Recovery	Restore safety, body, relationships, and agency before efficiency and growth	Recovery
Minimum order	A safe action and visible result that remain repeatable during disorder	Life Practice Toolkit
Minimum viable day	A version of the day that preserves safety, one minimum output, and a cue for the next step at the capacity available	Daily System
Capacity budget	A rough estimate that includes time, attention, body, and responsibility rather than time alone	Daily System
Return action	The smallest output that can be completed within 24 hours and bring the system back after interruption	Daily System
Rhythm	One pattern of action that remains recognisable and executable at different capacities, connecting repetition, feedback, and recovery over time	Rhythm
Compounding	Today's choice reduces tomorrow's hesitation, rework, or recovery cost, allowing ability, trust, judgment, and recovery to support one another	Rhythm
Minimum contract	An agreement for bad days that states when to downgrade, what action to keep, and when to ask for help or escalate risk	Rhythm
Rhythm ledger	One page each week recording the main question, protected action, useful feedback, repeated resistance, and next condition to change	Rhythm Ledger Template · Rhythm
Cost	Time, money, health, relationships, privacy, and responsibility that must be named	Decision-Making
Reversibility	Whether a choice can be paused, undone, or changed back at manageable cost	Decision-Making

One Sentence to Keep

If you keep one sequence: name the problem, save a baseline, use the right tool for one small task, let a real person test it, write the feedback into the next action, and recover before adding pressure.

Related entry points: Prologue: Do Not Rush to Change Your Life | 90-Day Cycle Map

Toolkit Overview: Choose the Problem Before the Tool

Templates are not another course to collect. They are work sheets you can reuse: name the problem in front of you, preserve an unpolished sample, take one action, and let feedback decide what comes next.

If you do not know where to begin, choose one sheet. An incomplete sheet used on a real problem is more valuable than ten blank templates.

First Ask: Where Am I Stuck?

Current block	First tool	Open next	What this tool cannot prove for you
No clear goal or baseline	Learning State	English Diagnostic	It cannot choose a permanently correct direction
Starting a 90-day cycle	90-Day Cycle Map	Rhythm Ledger	It cannot guarantee success or persistence
Weekly rhythm keeps breaking	Rhythm Ledger	Weekly Review	It cannot turn fatigue, illness, or responsibility into laziness
I have samples but cannot tell whether anything really changed	Evidence Chain	Evidence	It cannot turn one smooth performance into stable ability
I recognise words but cannot use them	Vocabulary Audit	Vocabulary	It cannot replace contextual performance with card counts
I cannot hear or explain what I read	Listening Resource Audit or Reading Evidence Card	Listening · Reading	It cannot use minutes played or highlights as proof of understanding
I cannot speak or write with confidence	Speaking Evidence Card or Writing Evidence Card	Speaking · Writing	It cannot speak for you before a real listener
I do not know how to involve AI	AI Task Brief	AI Learning Log	It cannot turn a model response into a fact or final judgment
I have an idea but no deliverable	Artifact Brief and Delivery Card	AI Project Scorecard	It cannot find users, carry responsibility, or prove a commercial result
I want to analyse a person or project story	AI Case Review	Narrative and Evidence	It cannot turn a public narrative into an independent audit
I am handling a decision, attention, relationship, or recovery problem	Life Practice Toolkit	Decision-Making · Attention · Relationships · Recovery	It cannot replace medical, psychological, legal, or financial support

Connect the Tools into One Loop

Do not fill every template at once. Follow this order and keep only the evidence each step needs:

1. **Locate**: use Learning State or English Diagnostic to name the real situation, baseline, and acceptance standard;
2. **Choose**: use the 90-Day Cycle Map for a longer cycle, or the Rhythm Ledger for one week;

3. **Practice**: choose a vocabulary, listening, reading, speaking, or writing evidence card and complete your first version yourself;
4. **Collaborate**: when AI is useful, fill the AI Task Brief, then record the collaboration and your closed-AI performance in the AI Learning Log;
5. **Deliver**: for a real audience, use the Artifact Brief and Delivery Card; after a release or pilot, use the AI Project Scorecard to record quality, cost, risk, and rollback;
6. **Review**: use the Evidence Chain to place the first version, immediate performance, delayed retention, and transfer together, then use the Weekly Review to change one condition.

This is a returnable path. If a step reveals risk, lower capacity, or missing evidence, go back and reduce the task. Going back is not waste; it makes the next action more trustworthy.

Three Rules

Track Only What Can Change a Decision

If a number cannot help you continue, downgrade, change a variable, or stop, you do not need to record it for long. The purpose of a record is not to fill a page. It is to clarify the next step.

A First Version Should Be Human-made

Complete the baseline, first version, and independent retest before AI enters or after it is closed whenever possible. A tool can explain, compare, and point out problems. It cannot manufacture the feeling of having learned.

Records Must Keep Boundaries

Do not paste passwords, identity documents, exact addresses, customer data, medical privacy, or unauthorised third-party content into a template or model. For health, safety, legal, financial, or persistent loss-of-control concerns, contact a qualified professional or trusted support person first.

A Minimum Beginning

Write only four lines today:

```
The real problem I am solving:
The baseline evidence I already have:
The smallest output I will complete in 25–45 minutes:
```

```
Where I will preserve the evidence:
```

When it is done, choose the tool closest to the task, give it a date, and set the next review time. Do not wait for every field to be complete. Starting is what makes the missing information concrete.

Related entry points: Reader's Guide: Put the Book Back into Life | Glossary of Terms and Methods | Rhythm: Let Small Things Travel Through Time

Evidence Chain Template

This worksheet answers one concrete question: **What exactly do I know has changed?**

It does not require every result to improve or turn life into a score. It places samples from the same task under different conditions side by side, so you can distinguish “I can do it now”, “I still can after a few days”, and “I can use it somewhere new”.

Copy it into a private note and use one copy for each main question. Do not record passwords, identity documents, customer data, medical privacy, or unauthorised third-party information. For health, safety, legal, financial, or persistent loss-of-control concerns, contact a trusted person and a qualified professional first.

1. Define the Question

```
Record start date:
Real situation and audience/user:
The one question this record answers:
Acceptance standard:
Possible risks and stop conditions:
```

The question should be observable, such as “Can I explain a project risk in English without a script and answer one follow-up?” Do not write “Am I better now?”

2. Save an Unaided Baseline

The baseline should happen before AI, peer feedback, or concentrated training whenever possible. Record the conditions so tools, extra time, and familiar material do not disappear from the comparison.

Date	Task and constraints	Tool used?	Result/errors	Raw evidence location
		No		

```
What I could complete independently at baseline:
Where I stopped or needed a prompt:
What the baseline cannot prove:
```

3. Record Immediate Performance

Immediate performance says what happened under the current conditions. It does not automatically say that ability is stable.

Date	Conditions and prompts	What I completed	Quality/time/rework	Evidence location

If AI was used, state what it did and what you completed independently after closing it. A chat log is a process trace, not proof of ability by itself.

4. Test Delayed Retention

Wait for a period, remove recent prompts and the original answer, and complete a related task. Choose the interval according to the task and your capacity, but write it down.

```
Retest date:
Time since the last practice:
Prompts removed:
Related task:
Independent result:
Errors that remained:
Evidence location:
```

5. Test Transfer

Keep the core action and change at least one condition: topic, listener, time limit, material, tool permission, or purpose.

Changed condition	New task	Independent result	How did the other person/user understand it?	Evidence location

A failed transfer does not make earlier practice worthless. It shows that the change may be too large, prerequisite knowledge is missing, or the acceptance standard needs revision.

6. Separate Fact, Interpretation, and Hypothesis

```
Fact: I can point to a date, condition, sample, source, or direct observation.
Interpretation: How I understand those facts; it may need revision.
Hypothesis: The judgment I will test in the next action.
Conclusion I cannot draw yet:
```

For example, “the unaided version finished in 90 seconds” is a record. “It was clearer because my sleep improved” is an interpretation. “It may work if I can repeat it with an unfamiliar listener next week” is a hypothesis.

7. Let Evidence Choose the Next Step

```
This evidence most supports: continue / downgrade / change one variable / pause or stop
The one condition I will change:
Smallest next task:
Acceptance standard for the next task:
Support, permission, or professional judgment needed:
Next review date:
```

When evidence conflicts, do not hide the conflict in an average. Write the different conditions first, then decide whether another sample is worth collecting. When evidence is thin, shrinking the question is usually more honest than manufacturing a precise score.

8. Handover Summary

```
Main question and acceptance standard:
Most reliable evidence:
Least reliable or still missing evidence:
Repeated errors/risks:
Smallest next task and stop condition:
Evidence folder or link:
```

When handing this summary to your future self, a peer, or AI, ask them to work only from this record. They should not pretend to remember another session or fill in facts that are not present.

Related chapters: Evidence: How Change Becomes Visible | Toolkit Overview | Rhythm Ledger | Glossary of Terms and Methods

Learning State Template

Copy this into a private note. It is a cross-session source of truth, not a performance diary. Do not include passwords, government IDs, exact addresses, sensitive health data, or third-party information without permission.

```
# Learning State

State version: v1
Updated: YYYY-MM-DD
Owner:
Primary file location:

## Goal
- Real context:
- Current main task:
- 12-week outcome:
- This week's focus:
- Acceptance criteria:
- Deadline:

## Constraints and Boundaries
- Weekly time/energy available:
- Materials and tools allowed:
- Content that must not be uploaded or published:
- AI may assist with:
- A person must confirm:

## Current Level and Baseline
- I can currently:
- Baseline sample:
- Latest score/feedback:

| Sample | Conditions | Location | Date | What it does not show yet |
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| | | | | |

## Completed
- [date] task — output/evidence location — result/next step

## Errors, Risks, and Knowledge Gaps
| Error/risk | Evidence | Likely cause/confidence | Next treatment and stop condition |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |

## Methods That Worked
- Method — conditions — evidence

## Hypotheses to Test
- Hypothesis — counterexample — next test — deadline

## Latest Handover
- Completed and evidence:
- Facts still unconfirmed:
- Open decisions:
```

```
- Cost/rework so far:
- First action when reopening:
- People to notify or consult:

## Next Action
1. Smallest next task:
2. Expected time:
3. Material needed:
4. Evidence to save:
5. Next review date:
```

Cross-session Recovery Prompt

```
Below is my learning-state file. In no more than six bullets, restate the state version

[paste Learning State]
```

An AI summary is not the source of truth. Resume from the file, saved work, sources, and version number; after a weekly review, update the Weekly Review, Evidence Chain, and 90-Day Cycle Map by their separate jobs instead of copying the same record.

Rhythm Ledger Template

Copy this ledger into a private note and use one page each week. It is not a streak table or a dashboard for scoring your character. It helps you see what deserves to stay, which condition needs to change, and how to return after an interruption.

Do not write passwords, identity documents, customer data, medical privacy, or unauthorised third-party information. When safety, health, money, or relationship risks are involved, contact a qualified professional or a trusted support person first.

1. One Main Question

```
Date range:
The one question this week:
Real situation and audience:
Acceptance standard:
Baseline evidence at the start of the week:
```

The question should be observable, such as “Can I explain a project risk in English without a script and answer a follow-up?” Do not write “be better this week”.

2. Three Capacity Versions

Capacity	When to use it	Minimum action	Evidence that must remain	Stop or downgrade condition
Full day	Time and capacity are relatively stable			
Compressed day	Time is short or attention is fragmented			
Recovery day	Illness, sleeplessness, grief, or responsibility rises sharply			

The three versions serve one direction. A recovery day is not a failure. When safety, sleep, the body, or relationships are clearly affected, protect those limits before completing the plan.

3. Give Repetition an Echo

Date	Action	Recall / variation / output / feedback	What new information appeared?	Which variable changes next time?

If four repetitions produce no new information, change the topic, listener, time limit, number of prompts, or tool permission before simply adding more repetitions.

4. Record One Useful Piece of Feedback

```
Who or what provided the feedback:
Observation: What did the person actually see, hear, or measure?
Impact: How did it affect understanding, use, or the result?
Next adjustment: Which one important variable will I change?
Evidence location:
```

When asking AI for feedback, submit your own version first. Ask for no more than three issues that affect the result, and require a distinction between observation, inference, and suggestion. A person decides what to accept.

5. Interruption and Return

```
What happened, as facts (no character judgment):
Which condition changed: time / capacity / difficulty / environment / responsibility
The smallest return action within 24 hours:
What I will explicitly not make up:
Who I need to contact or which risk needs escalation:
```

If the same resistance appears three times, change the time box, task size, environment, boundary, or support network. Do not repay an interruption with sleep deprivation or shame.

6. This Week's Decision

```
One design I will keep:
One demand or entry point I will remove:
One condition I will change next week:
One number I will stop tracking:
Next review date:
First action when I open the file next time:
```

7. Handover and Evidence Locations

```
First version:
Revised version:
Feedback or retest:
Next task: owner / date:
```

Related chapters: Rhythm: Let Small Things Travel Through Time | Daily System: Put Change into the Day | Weekly Review Template

Weekly Review Template

A review is not a verdict. It gives next week a more accurate starting point. Reserve 20 minutes, inspect evidence before explaining causes, and change one variable only. Do not include passwords, client data, sensitive health information, or unauthorised third-party details.

```
# Weekly Review — YYYY-Www

## Main Question
- Goal:
- One question this week:
- Acceptance criteria:
- Constraints (time, energy, responsibility):

## Evidence Inventory
- Completed:
- Work/recording/test location:
- First, assisted, and delayed-retest locations:
- External reader/user feedback:

| Evidence | What it shows | What it does not show yet |
| --- | --- | --- |
| | | |

## Four Checks (0–2)
| Item | Score | Reason and evidence |
| --- | ---: | --- |
| Completion: was the task done? | | |
| Quality: did it meet the standard? | | |
| Retention: can it be reproduced days later? | | |
| Transfer: does it work under changed conditions? | | |

## Errors and Causes
| Error/barrier | Evidence | Likely cause | Next test |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| | | | |

## Energy and Recovery
- Effect of sleep/stress on performance:
- Unsustainable arrangement:
- What needs pausing or support:

## Change One Variable
- Keep:
- Stop:
- Adjust:
- Most important task and acceptance criteria:
- Next review date:

## Write Back Without Duplicating Records

Write back only what can change a decision. Do not copy the same paragraph into four fi
```

````
- [Evidence Chain Template](evidence-chain.md): compare baseline, immediate performance
- [Rhythm Ledger](rhythm-ledger.md): keep this week's rhythm, capacity versions, repeat
- [Learning State](learning-state.md): keep cross-session handover, unconfirmed facts,
- [90-Day Cycle Map](90-day-cycle.md): keep phase gates, twelve weekly questions, and t

```markdown
Evidence Chain updated: yes / no / not applicable
Rhythm Ledger updated: yes / no / not applicable
Learning State updated: yes / no
90-Day Cycle Map updated: yes / no / not applicable
Evidence location for the smallest next task:
````

Handover Links

After the review, open only the files whose jobs apply: the Evidence Chain Template compares four time points; the Rhythm Ledger records this week's rhythm; Learning State carries cross-session handover; the 90-Day Cycle Map carries cycle gates.

Do not redesign the whole system after one poor week. Separate random variation from a pattern repeated at least three times; when a pattern persists, change the environment, task size, or support network first.
````

English Diagnostic Template

Read CEFR Goals and Self-check, then complete all four tasks under the same topic, similar time, and explicit restrictions. Do not look up language or ask AI to rewrite the first version; use a skill card when you need finer diagnosis.

```
# English Diagnostic — YYYY-MM-DD

Real use context:
Topic and source:
Restrictions (time, captions, dictionary, AI):
Day-30 retest date:
Week-12 retest date:

| Skill | Conditions | First sample | Delayed/parallel sample | Evidence card |
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| Listening | | | | [Listening Resource Audit](listening-audit.md) |
| Reading | | | | [Reading Evidence Card](reading-evidence.md) |
| Speaking | | | | [Speaking Evidence Card](speaking-evidence.md) |
| Writing | | | | [Writing Evidence Card](writing-evidence.md) |

| Skill | Task 0–2 | Comprehensibility 0–2 | Accuracy/range 0–2 | Organisation/fluency
| --- | ---: | ---: | ---: | ---: | ---: |
| Listening | | | | | |
| Reading | | | | | |
| Speaking | | | | | |
| Writing | | | | | |

Strongest evidence:
Weakest evidence:
Repeated errors:
Provisional CEFR by skill:
12-week real task:
Smallest next exercise:
Parts requiring a professional or primary-source check:
One variable to change next cycle:
```

Scoring reference: `0=not completed`, `1=partial or cue-dependent`, `2=stable under the stated conditions`. Record the reason for each score, not only the number.

Repeat under the same conditions or a close parallel task on day 30 and week 12. Keep the raw sample, assisted version, delayed performance, and scoring reasons instead of comparing only polished products. Put the next variable into the 90-Day Cycle Map.

Vocabulary Audit Template

Vocabulary is not a leaderboard that must grow forever. Record which items recur in your real situation, which are only familiar on a card, and which you can retrieve in a new sentence.

Copy this into a private note. Do not include customer records, medical privacy, identity documents, or unauthorised third-party material. Audit one topic or source at a time, and keep the unaided sample and delayed retest.

1. Define the Situation

```
# Vocabulary Audit — YYYY-MM-DD

Real situation:
Topic and source:
Task: listening / reading / speaking / writing / exam
Acceptance criteria:
Retest date:
```

2. Record Words or Chunks

Word/chunk	Source sentence	Listening	Reading	Speaking	Writing	Register/collocation	Next step
		0–2	0–2	0–2	0–2		

Scoring guide:

1 `0`: no evidence, or entirely dependent on a cue;

1 `1`: recognisable in familiar material but unstable in a new context;

1 `2`: understood or produced without a cue, with common collocation and register.

3. Name the Error

Do not label every problem “forgotten”. Choose the closest category:

1 **unrecognised in text**: spelling or form is not identified;

1 **unheard**: meaning is known, but connected or natural speech is not segmented;

1 **sense confusion**: one meaning is applied to the wrong context;

1 **unnatural collocation**: the word is correct but the combination is uncommon;

1 **wrong register**: formality, technicality, or politeness does not fit;

1 **slow retrieval**: understood but unavailable in timed speech or writing;

1 **transfer failure**: the original sentence works, but a changed task does not.

4. Design One Transfer

Choose 3–5 high-value chunks and complete at least two:

1. change the people, time, domain, or situation in the source sentence;
2. write one natural use and one typical misuse;
3. retell for 60–90 seconds without the list;
4. find two different collocations in an independent reliable source;
5. use the chunks in a short email, explanation, or log.

Record the result:

```
Chunk:
My new situation:
Sentence or recording:
What remains uncertain:
Condition to change next time:
```

5. Delayed Retest

Correct answers on the same day do not prove mastery. Schedule two closed-book retests:

Date	Conditions	Result	Error type	Transfer worked?
First	Original topic, no cue			
Days 3–7	Related topic, limited cue			
Day 30	New topic, real task			

If a card is correct but the item cannot be used in a new task, stop adding volume. Switch to chunks, retelling, and writing. The goal is not a longer table; it is retrieval when the word is needed.

6. Weekly Summary

1 Five highest-value chunks:

1. Sounds I still cannot recognise:
1. Senses or collocations I still confuse:
1. Chunks I can now retrieve naturally:
1. Low-value cards to remove:
1. One real output for next week:

Related chapter: Vocabulary: From Recognition to Contextual Use

Listening Resource Audit

A resource earns its place by supporting your current task, not by being popular. Copy this card into a private note and audit one main source at a time. Do not record passwords, client data, unauthorised third-party information, or unnecessary personal details.

1. Define the task

```
# Listening Resource Audit — YYYY-MM-DD

Title and source:
Link:
Access date:
Task: hear sounds / catch gist / adjust to speed / build stamina (choose any)
Current CEFR reference:
Completion standard:
Planned use: seven-day main source / parallel test only
```

2. Check the conditions

Condition	Notes	Decision
Length and segments		Can it become a 30-second–5-minute practice unit?
Transcript quality		Human transcript / auto-captions / none; what needs checking?
Speed and accent		Slightly hard but repeatable, or beyond useful repetition?
Topic and motivation		Will I return to it during the next seven days?
Access and rights		Is it stable, lawful, and appropriate for personal study?
Privacy and safety		Should I avoid comments, live chat, or personal data?

Without a transcript, downgrade a resource to extensive listening or a parallel test. Do not use it for precise dictation scores.

3. Capture first-pass evidence

```
First-pass conditions (captions, pauses):
First-pass gist:
Three details heard:
Uncertain timestamps:
First retelling or three-point note:
```

Do not label every problem “I forgot it.” Choose the closest category:

1 unknown vocabulary or syntax;

1 known words that were not segmented from sound;

1 linking, reduction, stress, or accent;

1 missing background knowledge;

1 attention, fatigue, or playback environment.

4. Run a seven-day loop

Day	Action	Output	Result
1	Listen without captions; write gist and details	First note	
2	Check the transcript and repair 2–3 key segments	Error categories	
3	Listen without text; shadow useful chunks	Recording or annotation	
5	Change one condition: fewer captions or faster speed	New retelling	
7	Test transfer with a parallel source on a similar topic	Delayed score	

Score 0–2 for gist, key detail, segmentation, retelling comprehensibility, and parallel-source transfer. If there is no progress twice in a row, lower the difficulty or shorten the clip before replacing the resource.

5. Decide whether to keep it

```
The skill this material supports best:
The error it exposes most often:
Did I leave at least two kinds of output in seven days?
Keep it for another seven days: yes / no / downgrade to extensive listening
Next parallel source:
Reason for keeping or replacing it:
Next review date:
```

Related chapter: Listening: From Sound Recognition to Real Understanding

Reading Evidence Card

Finishing a text is an action, not proof of comprehension. Copy this card into a private note for one article, chapter, or source set at a time. Do not record passwords, client data, unauthorised third-party information, or unnecessary personal details.

1. Define the task

```
# Reading Evidence — YYYY-MM-DD

Real context:
Task: locate information / follow an argument / build stamina / synthesise sources
Completion standard:
Time limit:
```

2. Record source and version

Item	Notes
Author, title, and link	
Edition, publication date, or chapter	
Access date	
Length and reading time	
Author position or conflict of interest	
Quotation, image, and copyright boundary	

Web pages can change, become paid, or disappear. Keep the citation details you need; do not copy an entire article without permission.

3. Capture first-pass evidence

```
One-sentence gist:
Order of the article or chapter:
Three details remembered after the first pass:
Words or sentences that truly blocked meaning:
First-pass time:
```

Finish the first pass before looking things up. Unknown-word count diagnoses material difficulty; it does not directly set a proficiency level.

4. Rebuild claims and evidence

Paragraph/page	Function	Author claim	Evidence or example	Limitation or question

Separate “what the author says” from “whether I agree”. For technical, health, legal, or financial claims, return to reliable primary sources or qualified professional advice.

5. Mark the inference boundary

```
Facts stated directly in the source:
Inference supported by the source:
My own judgment or association:
Evidence still missing:
One example that could disconfirm my current judgment:
```

If a conclusion rests only on emotion, a headline, or one anecdote, mark it as a hypothesis rather than a fact.

6. Test transfer

Date	Condition	Output	Score/feedback
Day 1	Close the source and rebuild the structure in five sentences	Summary and one inference	
Days 3–7	Read a parallel text on a related topic	Gist, evidence, and differences	
Day 30	Use a new topic or real task	One-page report, explanation, or retelling	

Score 0–2 for gist, structure, evidence, inference boundary, and delayed retelling. Reading faster without explaining the evidence is not complete progress.

7. Choose the next step

```
The skill this material trains best:
The largest barrier it exposed:
One variable to lower or raise next time:
Keep as the main source: yes / no / downgrade to extensive reading
Next parallel source:
Next review date:
```

Related chapter: Reading: From Word-by-word Translation to Claims and Evidence

Speaking Evidence Card

Speaking ability has to be heard in a real task. Copy this card into a private note for one explanation, interaction, or repair task at a time. Do not record passwords, client data, unauthorised third-party information, or unnecessary personal details.

1. Define the task and boundary

```
# Speaking Evidence — YYYY-MM-DD

Real context:
Task: explain / interact / repair / transfer
Listener and relationship:
Time limit:
Completion standard:
Content that must stay private:
```

Decide what may be recorded or shared first. For client, family, or colleague content, get necessary consent or use fictional details.

2. Save an unaided first take

```
Recording location:
First-take length:
One-sentence message I want to deliver:
Two details the listener should remember:
First pause or restart:
```

Do not ask AI to rewrite or script the first take. Its value is showing what you can do without scaffolding.

3. Classify problems by impact

Segment/time	Problem	Does it affect understanding?	One repair for next time
	chunk / pronunciation / grammar / organisation / pause / interaction	yes / no	

Repair errors that change meaning, block the task, or recur. An accent difference is not automatically an error; do not sacrifice clarity and naturalness to imitate one speaker.

4. Record interaction repair

```
What I did not hear or express clearly:
Repair line I used:
How the other person responded:
How I confirmed shared understanding:
Chunk to prepare next time:
```

Repair actions include asking for repetition, confirming a keyword, rephrasing, requesting thinking time, and summarising agreement. They are part of communication, not proof of failure.

5. Retake and listener feedback

Version	Conditions	Task 0–2	Comprehensibility 0–2	Organisation 0–2	Interaction/repair 0–2	Feedback
First take						
Retake						

Ask the listener to answer from the recording alone:

1. What was the main point?
2. Which two details were clearest?
3. Which sentence required guessing?
4. What would you ask next?

6. Test delayed transfer

Date	Changed condition	Output	Result
Day 1	Original situation, unscripted	First take and retake	
Days 3–7	Related situation or new listener	60–120 second retelling/dialogue	
Day 30	New topic, time pressure, or real task	Five-minute explanation/ meeting/interview	

If fluency appears only with a familiar script, but disappears after the condition changes, make chunk retrieval and interaction repair the next focus instead of memorising more scripts.

Related chapter: Speaking: Make Meaning Arrive

Writing Evidence Card

Good writing is not only attractive sentences. It completes a task that can be explained, checked, and answered. Copy this card into a private note and keep the draft, revision record, and delivered version. Do not record passwords, client data, unauthorised third-party information, or unnecessary personal details.

1. Define the task and boundary

```
# Writing Evidence — YYYY-MM-DD

Real context:
Task: explain / decide / narrate / reflect
Audience and existing context:
Delivery channel and deadline:
Action the reader must be able to take:
Content that must stay private:
```

Acceptance condition	How to check
Reader understands the point	Ask one reader to restate it in one sentence
Information can be checked	Mark numbers, dates, quotations, and sources
Structure is usable	Reader can find conclusion, reasons, and next step
Boundaries are respected	Check privacy, copyright, conflicts, and necessary disclosure

2. Save an unaided draft

```
Draft location:
Start and finish time:
Sentence I most want to keep:
Place I am least certain about:
Draft completion standard:
```

Write the first version yourself without AI writing it. It is the comparison sample for future growth.

3. Log four revision passes

Version	Revision layer	What I changed only	Why	Evidence/feedback
v1	Purpose and facts			
v2	Structure and evidence			
v3	Sentences and voice			
v4	Delivery and boundaries			

Keep the order: purpose and facts → structure and evidence → sentences and voice → delivery and boundaries. Address the highest-impact problem in each pass instead of treating edit count as quality.

4. Record AI and tool involvement

```
Tool/model and date:
Task I gave it:
Three problems it raised:
What I accepted/rejected, and why:
How I checked facts, citations, privacy, and copyright:
What I can still explain independently after closing the tool:
```

AI can diagnose structure, simulate a reader, or generate parallel exercises. The author remains responsible for facts, tone, permission, and final judgment.

5. Ask for specific feedback

Ask readers questions tied to the task:

1. What did you think the piece wanted you to understand, decide, or do?
2. Where did you pause or have to guess?
3. Which fact, quotation, or link needs checking?
4. Which sentence would you delete, and why?

Reader	Restated gist	Largest barrier	Change I will test

6. Test delayed transfer and delivery

Date	Changed condition	Output	Result
Day 1	Original task, timed, unaided draft	Draft and four revision passes	
Days 3–7	Related topic or new audience	200–300 word parallel text	
Day 30	New topic or real delivery	Email, report, explanation, or long-form piece	

Score 0–2 for purpose, structure, evidence/detail, accuracy/range, and revision transfer. Strong performance only on a familiar topic or after tool polishing is not full transfer.

7. Decide the next step

```
The strongest part of this piece:
The largest remaining task barrier:
One variable I will practise next:
Delivery link or archive location:
Next review date:
```

Related chapter: Writing: From Draft to Verifiable Revision

90-Day Cycle Map

This sheet manages one cycle; it is not a test of daily discipline. Keep one main question each week, one input, one output, and one transfer test. When health, work, or relationships change, adjust the plan's weight first. Do not include passwords, IDs, client data, sensitive health information, or unauthorised third-party details.

This sheet owns cycle direction and phase gates, not every detail: the Evidence Chain Template explains results, the Rhythm Ledger maintains weekly rhythm, and Learning State carries cross-session handover.

1. Cycle commitment

```
# 90-Day Cycle — YYYY-MM-DD to YYYY-MM-DD

Real context:
Deliverable by day 90:
Completion standard:
Three core pieces of evidence:
Weekly time and boundaries:
What must be reduced or paused:
```

2. Day-one baseline

Item	Current evidence	Largest barrier	Planned treatment
What I can do independently			
Situation where I will use it			
Materials, tools, and people available			
Sleep, energy, and responsibility boundaries			

Keep one sample made without AI doing the task: a recording, short text, reading reconstruction, code, presentation, or real conversation note.

3. Gates for three phases

Phase	Dates	Question to answer	Evidence to enter the next phase
Calibrate	Days 1–14	What exactly am I training, and what is the bottleneck?	Baseline, three error categories, one stable time slot
Stack	Days 15–56	Which action is becoming stable under which conditions?	At least four comparable outputs and one external feedback
Ship	Days 57–90	Can a new listener, topic, or user still use the result?	Independent, revised, and real-delivery versions

Without evidence for a gate, do not raise difficulty automatically. Shrink the task or repair prerequisites first.

4. Twelve weekly questions

Week	One question only	Input evidence	Output evidence	Feedback/transfer
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				
8				
9				
10				
11				
12				

Write an observable question such as “Can I explain project risk in English without a script and handle one follow-up?” Do not write “be better this week”.

5. Evidence chain

Date	Evidence card/tool	Location kept	Result or error	Next variable
	Listening / Reading / Speaking / Writing / Life Practice			

Chat logs, playback time, and check-in screenshots are process traces. Key judgments should return to artifacts, recordings, reader/user feedback, and performance under a new condition; use the Evidence Chain Template when comparing all four time points.

6. Interruption and recovery

```
Interruption fact (no character judgment):
Main resistance: time / difficulty / energy / environment / responsibility
Task reduced to:
Smallest output possible within 24 hours:
Work I will not repay:
Review date:
```

Do not stay up late to repay missed work or rewrite the 90 days after one failure. When the same barrier appears three times, record capacity and resistance in the Rhythm Ledger, then change the system condition instead of demanding more force.

7. Day-ninety review

```
Final delivery:
What genuinely changed from the baseline:
Errors that still recur:
What a real reader/user said:
Cost that proved unsustainable:
One habit to keep next cycle:
One entry point to stop next cycle:
```

Related chapters: 90-Day Action Plan: Return Your Life to Yourself | Evidence Chain Template | Rhythm Ledger

Artifact Brief and Delivery Card

An artifact does not need to be complete on day one, but it needs boundaries on day one. Copy this card into a private project directory and keep the independent, revised, reviewed, and delivered versions. Do not include passwords, client data, unauthorised third-party information, or unnecessary personal details.

1. Artifact boundary

```
# Artifact Brief — YYYY-MM-DD

Artifact name:
Real situation:
Audience/user:
One problem to solve:

Inputs and sources:
My current baseline:
Key assumptions:

Smallest deliverable:
Format, time, and other constraints:
Acceptance criteria:
What this will not include:

First-version deadline:
Who will give feedback:
Evidence to preserve:
How to shrink, pause, or roll back:
Next review date:
```

2. Four versions

Version	Completion condition	What to keep
Independent	Complete the smallest action without an answer key or AI writing it	Original file, time, bottlenecks
Structure	Audience can find the problem, conclusion, and next step	Structural diff, fact/guess marks
Review	A real reader, user, peer, or defined AI reviewer completes a review	Feedback, error categories, accept/reject reasons
Delivery	Another person can begin without your oral explanation	Version, limits, sources, known issues, handover record

3. Quality gates

Gate	Check	Evidence location	Owner/date
Clear	Does the audience know the problem and next action?		
Accurate	Do facts, citations, code, and numbers return to a source or test?		
Usable	Can the main action work under real constraints?		
Maintainable	Are version, dependencies, limits, and owner visible?		
Responsible	Are privacy, copyright, permissions, and error consequences handled?		

Write “unverified” when there is no evidence for a pass. Speed, word count, and feature count are proxy measures, not quality gates.

4. AI and feedback record

```
AI/tool and date:
Work it was allowed to do:
Human judgments I kept:
Three highest-impact issues it raised:
What I accepted/rejected, and why:
Main point restated by a real reader/user:
Most important repair:
```

Save your version first, then use AI to diagnose, simulate an audience, or generate a parallel task. A person confirms critical facts, permissions, privacy, cost, and final authorship.

5. Delivery and rollback

```
Delivery audience and permission scope:
Delivery date and version:
Instructions:
Known limits:
Support owner/contact:
Cost and retention period:
Pause/degrade/rollback trigger:
Who must be notified after a problem:
Next review date:
```

Delivery is not the end. After 3–7 days, run a parallel test and record whether another person can start independently, what still needs explanation, and the one change for the next version.

Related chapters: Artifacts: Turn Learning into Something Made | 90-Day Cycle Map

AI Task Brief Template

Copy this into a private project directory. Do not include passwords, identity documents, precise addresses, medical privacy, customer records, or unauthorised third-party information.

```
# AI Task Brief

Updated: YYYY-MM-DD

## Task
- Real situation:
- User/audience:
- Decision or action to complete:
- Deadline:

## Inputs and boundaries
- Known facts and sources:
- Files allowed:
- Data sensitivity: public / internal / confidential / restricted
- Material deliberately withheld:
- Copyright or permission limits:

## Output and acceptance
- Final deliverable:
- Format and length:
- Observable definition of done:
- Items a person must confirm:

## Working rules
- AI may:
- AI may not:
- Human reviewer:
- How work pauses, rolls back, or notifies on failure:

## Evidence locations
- Unaided baseline:
- Primary sources:
- Tests/feedback:
- Final version:
```

Write acceptance as an action, such as “a user can import a file in ten minutes and see an explainable error report”, not “the experience is good” or “the system is intelligent enough”.

AI Learning Log Template

Record one inspectable learning slice at a time. An AI-generated summary is not a source of truth; original work and primary sources are.

```
# AI Learning Log — YYYY-MM-DD

## Task
- Real problem:
- Acceptance criteria:
- Smallest slice:

## Baseline
- Unaided attempt:
- Gaps exposed:
- Material and sources:

## AI collaboration
- What AI did:
- Judgments I kept:
- Answers that require verification:

## Active production
- Work completed after closing AI:
- Independent time:
- Tests, feedback, or score:

## Three comparisons
| Sample | Conditions | Task/quality | Time/rework | Confidence | Evidence location |
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| Unaided baseline | | | | | |
| Assisted version | | | | | |
| Delayed independent (after 3–7 days) | | | | | |

## Errors and transfer
| Error/gap | Evidence | Possible cause | Parallel-task result |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| | | | |

## Next step
- Smallest next task:
- Acceptance criteria:
- Required material:
- Evidence to preserve:
- Handover owner/date:
- Stop or rollback condition:
```

AI Case Review Template

Use the author's public writing, official pages, or clearly authorised material only. A third-party narrative cannot independently prove capability, revenue, or project impact.

```
# AI Case Review — YYYY-MM-DD

## Source and facts
- Experience/project:
- Primary source and publication date:
- Access/check date:
- What may be public:
- What must be removed or redacted:

## Judgment
- Problem at the time:
- Facts known then:
- Assumptions:
- Choice made:

## Outcome
- What happened:
- Evidence location:
- What remains unknown:
- Failure or cost:

## Transferable principle
- Principle that still holds:
- Part that depended on the old conditions:
- Small exercise for a reader:
- How to test it next:
```

AI Project Scorecard Template

Complete this after each release or pilot. Every number should lead back to a test, ledger, feedback record, or operations log.

```
# AI Project Scorecard — YYYY-MM-DD

Project/version:
Owner:
User and situation:
Test conditions and sample scope:
Locations of baseline, assisted, and delayed independent retest:

| Metric | Result | Evidence location | Change from last time |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| Task completion | | | |
| First-pass acceptance | | | |
| Average/high-percentile latency | | | |
| Human time and rework | | | |
| Model/infrastructure cost | | | |
| Delayed independent performance | | | |
| Security/privacy issues | | | |
| User feedback | | | |

## Gates
- Facts and sources checked: yes / no
- Tests and edge cases covered: yes / no
- Permissions and data scope confirmed: yes / no
- Pause/degrade/rollback path works: yes / no
- Owner can explain critical decisions without the chat: yes / no

## Release Gates

| Gate | Evidence location | Owner | Date | Pass |
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| Requirements and acceptance criteria | | | | yes / no |
| Real samples and boundary tests | | | | yes / no |
| Permissions, privacy, and retention | | | | yes / no |
| Cost ceiling and monitoring | | | | yes / no |
| Pause, degrade, rollback, and notice | | | | yes / no |

## Decision
- Keep:
- Adjust:
- Stop:
- Smallest next experiment:
```

Life Practice Toolkit

This is not a perfect daily streak. It is a private record for seeing reality again. When you face an important choice, scattered attention, relationship conflict, or prolonged exhaustion, copy the relevant section and write facts and a next step.

Keep the file in a private notes or project directory. Do not include passwords, identity numbers, precise addresses, medical privacy, customer records, or unauthorised third-party information. When there is immediate danger, persistent insomnia, severe low mood, violence, debt, or legal responsibility, contact qualified professional support first.

How to Use It

1. Write the date and current problem before interpreting yourself;
2. complete only the worksheet relevant to the current problem;
3. leave one executable action and one evidence location;
4. return on the agreed review date; do not turn the result into a personality verdict;
5. remove records that no longer help and keep facts that improve the next decision.

1. Decision Brief

```
# Decision Brief — YYYY-MM-DD

Problem to solve:
Decision deadline:

Known facts and sources:
My interpretation:
Still unknown:

Option A:
Option B:
Do nothing for now:

Benefits of each option:
Money cost of each option:
Health cost of each option:
Impact on relationships and responsibility:
What is reversible:

Smallest experiment:
Stop or rollback condition:
Whose advice is relevant:
Current decision:
Review date:
Evidence to preserve:
```

Related chapter: Decision-Making: Choosing Under Uncertainty

2. Attention Audit

```
# Attention Audit — YYYY-MM-DD to YYYY-MM-DD

Most important question this week:

| Area | Facts this week | Result | Adjustment next week |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| Input: reading, video, meetings, chat | | | |
| Switching: notifications, interruptions, browsing | | | |
| Output: work, decisions, retelling, delivery | | | |
| Relationships: conversations where I was present | | | |
| Body: sleep, movement, energy | | | |

One entrance to close:
One 25–45 minute time box to protect:
What I know before using AI:
What I can still do after closing AI:
One experiment for next week:
```

Related chapter: Attention: Return Your Attention to Yourself

3. Relationship Conversation Card

```
# Relationship Conversation Card — YYYY-MM-DD

Relationship and situation:
What I want this conversation to accomplish:

Specific facts I observed:
Impact and feelings:
What I actually need:
One concrete request:
Boundary I can enforce:
If the conversation becomes unsafe, I will contact:

After the conversation:
- What did the other person actually say?
- Did I really listen?
- What remains unresolved?
- When will we review it?
```

Related chapter: Relationships: Becoming an Adult in Connection

4. Recovery Reset

```
# Recovery Reset — YYYY-MM-DD

Safety issue to protect today:
People I can contact:
High-risk decision to pause:

Body:
- Sleep:
- Food:
- Light activity I can tolerate:
- Professional support to consult:

One smallest task today:
Evidence of completion:
What I am allowed not to do today:
First action after opening the file tomorrow:
```

Related chapter: Recovery: Catch Yourself Before You Push Forward

5. Weekly Review

Answer five questions each week:

1. Which fact changed my judgment?
2. Which action left an inspectable result?
3. Which error repeated, and what might cause it?

4. Which boundary needs clearer language or firmer follow-through?
5. Which single smallest experiment will I keep next week?

Keep this toolkit beside the Weekly Review template in the same private directory. The purpose is not to turn life into a spreadsheet. It is to leave one small piece of fact standing when emotion becomes loud.